# ‘EVERYWHERE I GO NO MATTER WHERE, IF IT'S AROUND NON-INDIGENOUS PEOPLE I FEEL A HATE VIBE. IT FEELS LIKE I'M BEING WATCHED.’

## THE CALL IT OUT RACISM REGISTER 2024-2025



FIONA ALLISON, CHRIS CUNNEEN, BECK LEWIS, AYSE SELCUK

INTRODUCTION BY AMELIA WHYMAN

ARTWORK BY YULUWIRRIBAA

Jumbunna Institute for Indigenous Education and Research,
University of Technology Sydney

**CONTENT WARNING:**

This report contains content that is confronting and distressing. Please take care when reading.

**REPORT TITLE:**

‘Everywhere I go no matter where, if it's around non-Indigenous people I feel a hate vibe. It feels like I'm being watched’ is from a comment shared on the Call It Out Register by an Aboriginal young person.

**ARTWORK CREDIT:**

Special thanks to Kirsten Gray at Yuluwirribaa for the cover artwork. Kirsten is a Muruwari/Yuwalaraay woman, mother, artist, and advocate. <https://yuluwirribaa.myshopify.com/>

**Artwork title and description:** This piece is entitled ‘Country, Culture, Community’ and references the strength of our people and our interconnectedness with each other and our lands, skies, plants and waterways for millennia. You can see mob coming together for ceremony, travelling to hunt and to fish and to camp by our rivers. The stars guide our way as we travel across country. The boomerangs represent our strength and our survival while many of the shields speak to our warriors past and present.

**PUBLICATION DETAILS:**

Published by Jumbunna Institute for Indigenous Education and Research, University of Technology, Sydney.

Year of Publication: 2025

**ISBN:** 978-0-6454699-6-7

This report is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International licence. You are free to copy, communicate and adapt this work, providing you attribute the authors.

Suggested citation: Allison, F., Cunneen, C., Whyman, A., Lewis, B. and Selcuk, A. (2025) ‘Everywhere I go no matter where, if it's around non-Indigenous people I feel a hate vibe. It feels like I'm being watched’. The Call It Out Racism Register 2024-2025, Sydney: Jumbunna Institute for Indigenous Education and Research, University of Technology Sydney. Available at: <https://callitout.com.au/resources/>.

# ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The authors of this report acknowledge all Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people across Australia, the traditional custodians of the lands on which we work and live, and pay our respects to Elders, past, present and emerging. We acknowledge the ongoing connections that all Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people have to land, sea and community.

The Jumbunna Institute for Indigenous Education and Research, UTS (Jumbunna Research) and the National Justice Project acknowledge those Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people who have reported incidents of racism to Call It Out, and those who have reported on behalf of or as witnesses of racism against Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people. This Report would not have been possible without their courage, and we are honoured to hear and hold the experiences shared with us through the Call It Out Register (the Register).

The stories shared on the Register confirm how difficult it can be to call racism out, evidencing the significant emotional and other impacts of racism and of speaking out about it. While we have not been able to include all experiences shared to the Register in this report, all those who have reported incidents to Call It Out are contributing to the telling of a larger story about racism against Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people in this place. All reports made to the Register have been listened to and heard, whether or not they are explicitly referenced in our reports.

The Call It Out Register, and our reporting on stories of racism shared to it, are both made possible with the generous support of volunteers, donors and pro bono services that have helped bring this project to life, with special thanks to The Big Smoke, eLearn Australia, Virgin Unite and Hao Ran.

We would like to acknowledge Islamophobia Australia, Council for Intellectual Disability, Kirsten Gray, Uncle Dale Ruska, Nareen Young, Leanne Liddle, Dr Eddie Cubillo, Hodaka Shibata, Mariam Veiszadeh, Larissa Behrendt, Lindon Coombes, Jacinta Wright, Ariane Dozer and George Newhouse, and all the individuals and organisations involved in the ongoing development of Call It Out.

We would like to acknowledge all the individuals, communities and organisations who have logged reports, helped to advocate Call It Out since its inception, and who continue to take steps to create change in their communities.

We would also like to specifically acknowledge new and ongoing partners and collaborators during this current reporting period 21 March 2024 to 20 March 2025, including the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Social Justice Commissioner, Aboriginal Legal Service NSW/ACT, ACT Public Sector Culture and Pathways Team, Anti-Discrimination NSW, Attorney-General's Department (National Hate Crimes and

Incidents Database), Australian Human Rights Commission, Australian Red Cross, Cape York Institute, Blaksiders, Centre for Indigenous People and Work (UTS), Centre for Social Justice and Inclusion (UTS), Carumba Institute (QUT), Deakin University and NSW Premiers Department (Mapping Online Hate in Australia), GO Foundation, Indigenous Literacy Foundation, Middle Stump Initiative, Reconciliation NSW, Reconciliation South Australia, Speaking Out (ABC), Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies Unit (UQ), Victorian Equal Opportunity and Human Rights Commission (Anti-Racism Strategy), Victorian Government (Anti-Racism Taskforce), Wellmob, and Yardhura Walani (ANU).

Call It Out is primarily delivered through pro bono partner support and resources allocated by the National Justice Project and Jumbunna Research.

# TABLE OF CONTENTS

**ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS** ..... **3**
**TABLE OF CONTENTS** ..... **5**
**INTRODUCTION BY AMELIA WHYMAN** ..... **7**
**1. Introduction** ..... **12**
1.1 About the Call It Out Register ..... 12
1.2 Aim of the Register ..... 12
1.3 About this Report ..... 13
**2. What the Register Reveals About Racism** ..... **16**
2.1 Who reported the incident and where they reported ..... 16
2.2 How the incident was experienced or witnessed ..... 18
2.3 Type of racism ..... 20
*2.3.1 Racist stereotyping* ..... *21*
*2.3.2 Aggressive racism* ..... *24*
*2.3.3 Laws, policies, practice* ..... *27*
*2.3.4 Cultural and other Indigenous rights* ..... *34*
2.4 Where the racism happened ..... 37
*2.4.1 Racism online and in the media* ..... *38*
*2.4.2 Racism in public spaces, commercial places and transport* ..... *40*
*2.4.3 Racism in the workplace* ..... *43*
*2.4.4 Criminal legal system* ..... *47*
2.5 When the racism was experienced or witnessed ..... 51
*2.5.1 Single and multiple incidents of racism* ..... *51*
*2.5.2 When the racism happened* ..... *52*
*2.5.3 Incidence of racism – general comments* ..... *52*
2.6 Perpetrators of racism ..... 54
*2.6.1 Gender of the perpetrator* ..... *56*
*2.6.2 Age of the perpetrator* ..... *57*
2.7 The victim of the incident ..... 58
*2.7.1 Gender of the victim* ..... *58*
*2.7.2 Age of the victim* ..... *59*
2.8 Self-reports of racism by gender ..... 60
*3. Responses to Racism* ..... *64*
3.1 Impacts of racism ..... 64
*3.1.1 Emotional impacts* ..... *65*

*3.1.2 Other impacts of racism* ..... *69*
*3.1.3 Emotional and other impacts of racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender* ..... *71*
3.2 Responding to racism ..... 72
*3.2.1 Responding to racism* ..... *73*
*3.2.2 Responses to the incident for those who self-reported racism, by gender* ..... *77*
3.3 Barriers to calling out racism ..... 78
*3.3.1 Nothing to be done about racism* ..... *79*
*3.3.2 Barriers to calling out racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender* ..... *83*
3.4 What needs to be done to combat racism ..... 83
*3.4.1 What needs to be done to combat racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender* ..... *84*
*3.4.2 Strategies to combat racism* ..... *85*
**4. Children and young people ..... 91**
4.1 Racism experienced by children and young people ..... 91
4.2 School-based racism ..... 91
4.3 Other racism targeting children and young people ..... 96
4.4 Emotional and other impacts ..... 101
4.5 Responding to racism ..... 104
**5. Conclusion ..... 108**
**6. Appendices ..... 115**
6.1 Appendix A: Data Tables 2024 –2025 ..... 115
6.2 Appendix B: Children and Young People Data Tables 2024-25 ..... 136

# INTRODUCTION BY AMELIA WHYMAN

My name is Amelia Whyman, I'm 17 years old. I'm a proud Malyangapa and Wankumarra woman. I grew up in a small regional town called Wilcanna, in far Western NSW, where I dance with the Barkinji Baaka dance group and speak up as a young leader for my community and surrounds as a voice to empower future generations. I moved to Sydney to build connections and get my voice out there to be more known. I started doing dance with a well known dance group called 'Bujja Bujja butterfly Dancers'. I'm working as a Youth Ambassador with Mounty Aboriginal Youth and Community Services, building an Aboriginal Youth Peak for NSW, so young people can have more of a voice in decisions that affect their lives and have a place to be themselves.

***What racism have you seen or experienced?***

I came to Sydney from Wilcannia in search of better education opportunities that aren't available in my hometown. I started at a boarding school in Sydney. I would say there's a big racism problem within the boarding community at the school but also throughout all schools. When I started there, there were problems with feeling culturally involved. It's the same for other students. Issues came up for First Nations students in the boarding house where it's supposed to be home away from home. How can they feel comfortable there? It gets hard for them.

I have had racist run-ins. While I was waiting at [the station], this man walked past me, and he sat this piece of paper on the pole in front of me. This is my spot, this is my paper, he was calling me the N word, and racially profiling me. That guy was still slinging racial words to me, while I was walking off. I was only 15 years old. The bystanders all just watched. It made me feel like shit. I gave him the rude finger while walking off.

***What do you do about racism?***

I'm one of those people who will call racism out as it happens - if I can. Sometimes I call it out, and sometimes I don't because I get really scared. Even online.

It's not always worth taking someone on who is a racist, you can't really change their thoughts. It can bring back all that trauma from generations - because stories get passed down, especially the racist incidents. You can experience pain that is passed down from your ancestors, you can get scared for your cultural safety, for your physical safety - you feel it.

Sometimes when I'm doing cultural dance I feel a bit judged, people whisper. We might not say anything while we're dancing as it's about culture. Other times we have to call it out.

You can see when you should call it out. Sometimes you know culturally or spiritually that people need to be called out.

My ancestors connect to me spiritually. There have been so many things over the years that we as First Nations people weren't allowed to do, through the stolen generations and other racist policies. We couldn't stand up back then but you can now. Sometimes my ancestors will say this isn't a safe space for you. Other times they're saying you should stand your ground.

A fair few adults and young people want to take action against racism. But some people would be scared or clueless about how to do it. Some people will walk away and some people will stand up because they won't let anyone talk about their culture, others will go the legal route. A lot of people don't know the ways to go about it legally - and how they can get help and handle it.

I help other young people with racism. If they contact me for help, I do some thinking, then I talk to them and plan with them. So they don't get in more trouble in how they respond to racism – whether that happens in their community, in public spaces or wherever.

At the school I just graduated from, a lot of the girls look up to me as a big sister or leader, and when they have problems they get in touch with me and ask for advice and guidance. A fair bit of the advice I give is about racism and how to solve it without making a bigger problem. They are only young and I talk to them like I am their big sister. I have five younger siblings. I help them understand the things they can and can't do and how they can work around issues to make it a more comfortable space, especially while boarding at school.

While I was still at school I saw a young First Nations girl in Year 8 standing there crying and talking to a teacher who wasn't First Nations. I asked if she was okay. She said she felt culturally unsafe, uncomfortable and that the school was 'whitewashed'. I come from a very cultural community so I knew how she felt. I gave her some support. I didn't walk past. I stopped and helped her with her feelings. She liked that I was talking to her, rather than the teacher. She didn't feel so alone. It was that connection with me that was important.

Also, calling racism out is sometimes effective and sometimes not. When we complained before about racism at school the principal didn't do much about it. I think they were blindsided by their relationships with the staff we were complaining about. But when we have good leadership, like now, I encourage the other students to write down when something happens. When you feel culturally unsafe, then take it to the principal. She will listen.

***How does racism affect young people?***

Racism can affect the mindset of young people and how they see the world. A kid can grow up in a happy family and then they experience racism and they get confused about their place in the world. You don't feel a sense of community. You feel isolated.

Everyone has been told about it. But it affects everyone differently when you experience it.

It can make some people get depressed and separate themselves from society. It can lead to people feeling like suicide. It can affect their mental state, their physical state - stop them from eating, drinking - to get skinny, sick.

***What needs to be done about racism?***

The solutions can come through culture and from First Nations people themselves, but everyone has a role in addressing racism, recognising and responding to it. Everyone needs to have an understanding of racism and its effects.

Sometimes at school they do Koori lunch meetings, there's cultural dancing too, but there is really nothing else for First Nations students and after these activities, they go back into a school community where they don't feel culturally safe. In communities we exchange cultural stories, learn how to use clapsticks, didgeridoos, boondis and make spears. We need consistent workshops and whole days in schools around cultural activities like making clapsticks, learning language, how to do yarning circles and weaving. This would better connect us with community and help us to feel culturally connected in a school setting.

There's Aboriginal Studies at school, but there's only Indigenous history, rather than culture. Students could learn weaving, artworks, the stories of the 7 sisters, artefacts and other things. The First Nations students could come up with murals and explain it to the non-First Nations students to help them understand cultural connection, and why it's needed, why it's important to keep First Nations students spiritually connected when they are away from their community.

Young First Nations people definitely need a voice on these issues.

A lot of kids don't have a voice. I'm a young leader back home, and here I'm also doing this.

Kids need to stop being shut down. I don't get why young people are ignored and neglected all the time. Young people can give a lot of valuable insights, and can help other people understand how young people work. Our voice is very valuable and very much needed.

There's also solutions in coming together. Since I came to Sydney to go to school, and became independent, I've become more confident and had to stand up for myself more. With some young people from Mt Druitt, I'm helping with creating an Aboriginal Youth Peak for NSW. In that space, I can just be me, I can be comfortable and talk up. It's useful to come together with other young Aboriginal people.

There should be other groups like this, where we all learn together as a community by talking about what each of us have learned - where there's no conflict and everyone can be equally understood. We need to create spaces for us to come together in this way, for culture and safety.

And we also need more safe spaces. A community group where we can talk or write about racism would be good, and in the corner there's a box where you can write down how it's affected you and put what you write in the box - keep it private. People have different ways of experiencing racism and this is one way to respond to this.

There are lots of supports out there, but people don't know about them. If I got a really, really bad experience of racism, let's say there was a youth program, I might not feel comfortable talking about this experience. Maybe I might prefer to put it into a song, a poem or rhymes, a journal. I've experienced racism. I don't want my kids or their kids to experience it growing up. Someone might set up a program that people will trust that can make it safer for First Nations people to grow up.

We need accountability and more education. At school, one student was suspended after a racist incident against a First Nations student who was affected emotionally, who didn't feel safe. Part of me thinks that's good - they then understand that racism isn't the right thing. But sending them back to their family, they're probably not going to be pulled up at home.

While they're suspended I think they should be required to learn about cultural and spiritual connection, how racism impacts First Nations people - to write an essay about these things, about why racism shouldn't exist, why it's bad. Then they can think about how to apologise when the First Nations student feels safe enough to hear this. The school needs to play a role in this, but it would be helpful to have a community member come in and help navigate.

Police can be corrupt if they arrest someone who is Indigenous or has a cultural background. Police can be racist too. Just because they're part of the law doesn't mean they're not racist. Someone can be arrested but not know their rights. Police can hurt that person physically, and treat them badly. Give them a bad experience. Because that person doesn't understand the law they wouldn't know what actions to take to stop that corrupt cop.

There's a lot of racism in the justice system. Not everyone is up for taking action on it. We need a support system for those treated badly by police - where they can learn what their rights are and how to uphold them. Maybe a community support program where young people can access legal information and advice before they are likely to get targeted by police. Things that they can do to support themselves, how to speak, so they won't be clueless and all alone when they are in the justice system.

***Where do you get your strength from?***

I draw my strength from my Elders, my ancestors, especially my dad. He is very strong minded. We used to do marches across the bridge to have our voice heard. When I was 11, I designed the logo for the Indigenous Party of Australia. We put together the party because of the issues, because we were being ignored, so we decided to have a voice in parliament. I learnt my strength from my dad, because he taught me the rights and wrongs, same as his father did. Same as his nan. They taught me what's respectful and what's not, and as you get older you keep learning.

I had a lot of messages around being 'staunch' growing up. I still get those messages.

I cried when I got accepted into school in Sydney as I didn't want to leave home, leave my community and make new friends. My dad and brother brought me here. 'Keep your head down and focus, don't look back, you can make changes a lot of kids in Wilcannia don't have the chance to do.'

I struggled with the culture shock when I got here. I was really culturally connected back home but was new to town and there was less culture all around me. Then I started doing cultural dancing, which helped me a lot. That's why I think that there should be more that schools do to help young people with culture shock, to stay connected and not be overwhelmed by not being around community and culture anymore. It hits them hard.

When I graduated from school, my Uncle said 'We're proud of you, you have to keep going.' When I graduated, they all congratulated me, but my father had a talk with me. 'You've made us proud. You can't come back home, you have to stay down there and make a change.'

I do want to make a change. In a workspace or school area or in any social interactions, I want for people to look at another person and think they are just another person, I don't need to say anything about their cultural background. And that people don't offend each other, where they see each other as equals.

# 1. Introduction

## 1.1 About the Call It Out Register

The Jumbunna Institute for Education and Research (Jumbunna Research), in collaboration with the National Justice Project (NJP), developed Call It Out as an online register (the Register) to record all forms and levels of racism and discrimination experienced by First Nations peoples.[1] Call It Out was officially launched on 21 March 2022 to coincide with the International Day for the Elimination of Racial Discrimination.

Call It Out provides a simple and secure online reporting mechanism without the usual barriers which often inhibit reports of racism. It is intended to provide First Nations peoples who have experienced racism in all forms and witnesses to such racism with an accessible platform on which to share their experiences.

The Register is an independent, Indigenous-controlled reporting mechanism which is distinct from traditional complaints and legal processes. Reports of racist issues and incidents to complaints bodies, for instance, may be restricted or limited to specific forms of racism, and responding to racism through antidiscrimination and other laws and complaints mechanisms can be difficult to initiate and navigate, with often fairly prescribed remedies available. In contrast, Call It Out is an ongoing, respondent generated initiative with a national focus. The Register provides the opportunity to identify patterns of racism at institutional and structural levels, including to inform evidence-based advocacy and campaigning initiatives that proactively strive towards eliminating racism and discrimination towards First Nations peoples in this country.

We encourage anyone who experiences or witnesses racism against Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people to make a report using the Call It Out mobile or web app (for more information visit callitout.com.au). You can also make a report using the print and digital questions forms, including in Easy Read, available for download on the Call It Out Resources page.

## 1.2 Aim of the Register

A key objective of Call It Out is to generate evidence to support First Nations leaders, organisations and advocates in garnering support and resources to develop further tools

[1] We have used the terms Aboriginal, First Nations and Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander people interchangeably. The term Indigenous is used where it is in the narrative recorded on the database. We only use the term Indigenous when describing a 'non-Indigenous' person. We recognise that this approach does not reflect the diversity of, and that there is no consensus amongst First Nations peoples in Australia about how to be described. We apologise if this approach causes offence or misrepresentation. This is not our intention.

and strategies to address racism and discrimination, including through systemic and cultural change.

Racism and discrimination take many forms. They can be direct and indirect, interpersonal, online and institutional, for instance. Unlike other mechanisms that are limited by distinct parameters, Call It Out is designed to allow respondents the freedom to share any experiences they consider relevant to shape a comprehensive representation of First Nations peoples' lived experiences of racism and discrimination.

By using the Register to call out racism, First Nations peoples and their allies help to tell the true story of racism in this country. Collecting, analysing and reporting on First Nations peoples' experiences of racism enables us and community leaders to continue the fight against racism and protect future generations.

Reports made to Call It Out enable Jumbunna Research together with National Justice Project to:

- Develop comprehensive reports on racism and discrimination experienced by First Nations peoples
- Support First Nations organisations and leaders to identify problem areas and to respond to racism and discrimination
- Explore measures to counter racism and discrimination against First Nations peoples
- Educate the community about racism and discrimination against First Nations peoples
- Support appropriate investment in Indigenous-led anti-racism activities and initiatives
- Analyse the actions and demographics of perpetrators to better understand how to counter the behaviours of individuals and characteristics of systems that manifest as racism
- Measure patterns in the circumstances, nature, frequency and geographic spread of discrimination and racism; and
- Advocate for law reform and social change.

## 1.3 About this Report

This is the fourth report published on the information recorded in the Call It Out Register.[2] This report provides analysis of the incidents of racism recorded in the Register for the

[2] Our interim first report released in 2022, providing analysis of incidents recorded on the Register during the first six months of its operation until 20 September 2022. The second report analysed incidents recorded over the twelve month period 21 March 2022 to 20 March 2023. A third report covered the period 21 March 2023 to 20 March 2024. We will continue to produce Call It Out reports annually over coming years to enable analysis of the changing nature and extent of racism over time.

12-month period covering 21 March 2024 to 20 March 2025. It also includes an introduction by a young person, Amelia Whyman, a proud Malyangapa and Wankumarra woman, speaking about issues of racism, given themes arising in this year's report.

The Call It Out Register contains 20 questions covering the nature of the incident, details of where and when the incident took place and who was involved, as well as possible responses to racism. Questions ask for multiple choice and/or free text answers. To be recorded as an incident there is a minimum threshold of recorded answers which must be met. Questions asking for confidential information on the person completing the report (which includes their name, email/phone number and background) and their agreement to the use of anonymised information, along with an additional five questions on the nature of the incident must be completed for a response to be counted as a registration of an incident on the Register.

In March 2024, the Register was updated to better address some gaps arising from our previous analysis and reporting. These changes are summarised below and detailed at the relevant sections throughout this Report.

- Four new questions were added to record:
    - the background of the person making a report, including those by friends/family and witnesses (required)[3]
    - multiple incidents of racism (optional)
    - the age of the perpetrator (optional), and
    - barriers to standing up against racism (optional).
- Two previously optional questions were added to the minimum threshold of recorded answers: where the racism happened; and who was the perpetrator.
- The multiple-choice answers were revised for nine questions (both required and optional): how the racism was experienced or witnessed; the type of racism experienced or witnessed; where the racism happened; who perpetrated the racism; emotional responses to racism; other responses to racism; and strategies for combatting racism.
- Three optional questions were revised to limit the number of multiple-choice answers a respondent can select to a maximum of three answers: emotional responses to racism; other responses to racism; and strategies for combatting racism. (This limit was also applied to the new question on barriers to standing up against racism mentioned above.)

[3] Prior to 21 March 2024, the Register did not record the Aboriginality of third parties (witnesses, family members or friends).

Over the twelve-month period 21 March 2024 to 20 March 2025, there were 458 registrations of incidents on the database which fulfilled these criteria. From the 458 registrations we removed 15 reports which were made by individuals who used the platform to promote racism. We removed a further registration which was a valid report of racism that targeted persons who were not Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander. The total number of validated reports used for the analysis in this report is **442**. It should be noted that this is a count of *registrations* rather than incidents and a single registration can cover ongoing or multiple events, incidents or issues, including those that are structural, rather than occurring at a single point in time. We note that in this report we have used the term 'racism' to describe it in all its forms, along with discrimination based on race, racial vilification and racist violence.[4]

There are two Appendices incorporating all data tables utilised in this report. **Appendix A** includes data tables from all 442 registrations. **Appendix B** includes data tables relating to the section on children and young people at [4].

The quotations used in this report are drawn from the narratives shared to the Register. Throughout this report the quotations which are identified as **'Self-report'** are drawn from reports entered into the Register by First Nations people who directly experienced the racism reported. The quotations by someone reporting racism on behalf of their First Nations friends or family are identified as **'Friend or relative report'**. All other witnesses of racism are identified as **'Witness report'**.

Quotations are also identified by the person's background, where they have chosen to share this information in their report. A person's background is identified as **'Aboriginal'**, **'Torres Strait Islander'**, **'Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander'** or **'non-Indigenous'**.

Quotations which are identified as 'Self-report' are also identified by the person's gender, where they have chosen to share this information. A person's gender is identified as **'female'**, **'male'** or '**non-binary'**. In this report, 'witness' and 'friend or relative' reports are not identified by gender as Call It Out records the gender of the person experiencing racism, which is not always the person reporting it.

We have also removed any identifying details about victims or perpetrators from all quotations to maintain privacy, except in some cases where these are already in the public domain.

[4] We also note that although our focus in this report is on race-based issues, we acknowledge that individuals may experience these issues alongside other forms of discrimination (based on disability, age, etc.).

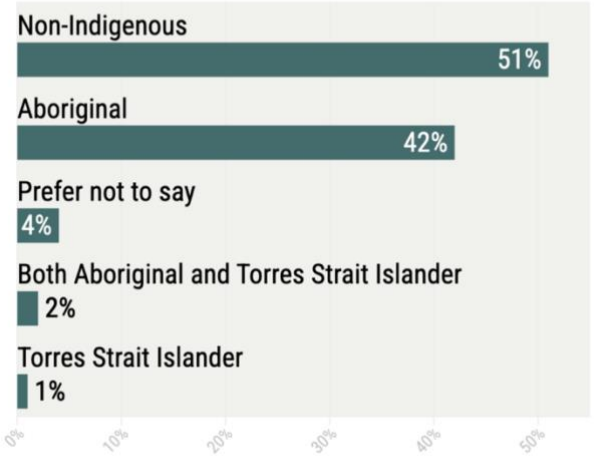
# 2. What the Register Reveals About Racism

## 2.1 Who reported the incident and where they reported

Individuals completing the Register were asked to identify whether they are Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander or non-Indigenous. This was a new compulsory question for a registration to be accepted.

As shown in Figure 1, almost half of all respondents (199/442 or 45%) identified as either Aboriginal (42%), Torres Strait Islander (1%) or both Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander (2%). Just over half identified as non-Indigenous (51%). The remainder chose not to provide this information (4%). (See also Table 1 in Appendix A).

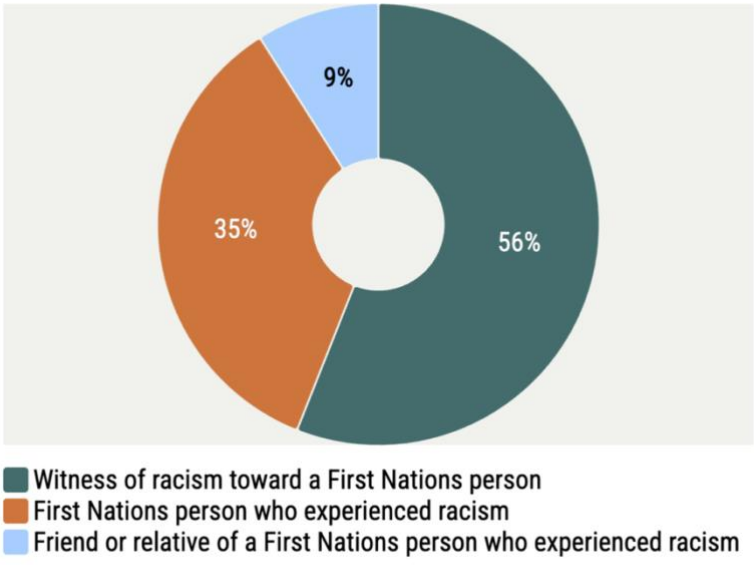
**Figure 1 Background of the person who reported the incident**




Source: Table 1 Background of the person who reported the incident

Individuals completing the Register were also asked to identify whether they were a 'First Nations person who experienced racism', a 'friend or relative of a First Nations person who experienced racism' or a 'witness of racism towards a First Nations person'. This was a compulsory question for a registration to be accepted.

**Figure 2 Who reported the incident**




Source: Table 2 Who reported the incident by background of the person who reported the racism

Figure 2 indicates more than half of all reports (56%) were made by witnesses. More than a third were reported by a First Nations person who directly experienced racism (35%) and the remainder by a friend or relative of the person who experienced racism (9%). (See also Table 2 in Appendix A).

The number of reports lodged in 2024-25 by witnesses was lower than those of the previous year (down six percentage points).

Alongside this change we have had a slight increase in reports by a First Nations person directly experiencing racism (up four percentage points) compared with 2023-24.[5] We note too that 36% of those reporting as a friend/relative, and 15% of witnesses, identified as Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander (see Table 2 in Appendix A).[6]

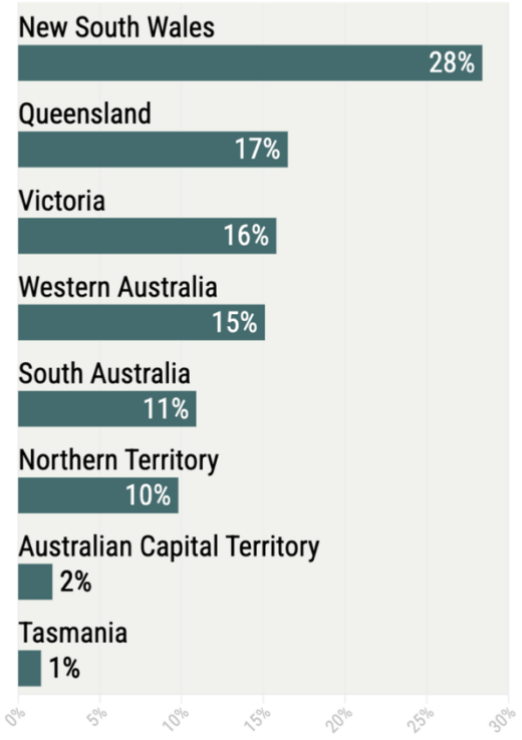
Individuals completing the Register were also asked to indicate in which Australian state or territory the incident occurred or was observed.

More than two thirds of people filling in the Register answered this optional question (308/442 or 70%). Of those 308 responses, some 21 people (7%) indicated that the racism occurred nationally or online. A further two individuals reported that the racism occurred internationally: one in the United Kingdom and the other in New Zealand.

Almost two thirds of respondents (285/442 or 64%) identified that the racism occurred in a specific state or territory. As shown in Figure 3, of these, there were reports from every state and territory in Australia. Some 28% of racist incidents were recorded as occurring in New South Wales, followed by Queensland and Victoria (both 16%) and Western Australia (15%).

According to the ABS 2021 Census, the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander population distribution nationally was, in order of size, New South Wales 34.5%, Queensland 27.8%, Western Australia 12.2%, Victoria 8%, Northern Territory 7.8%, South Australia 5.3%, Tasmania 3.4% and Australian Capital Territory 1%.[7] While the registrations broadly mirrored the relative Aboriginal population distribution nationally, Victoria was over-represented and Queensland was under-represented.

**Figure 3 Geographic location of reported incidents**




Source: Table 3 Geographic location of reported incidents

[5] Further, reports by friends or relatives increased by two percentage points compared with 2023-24.
[6] Further, 59% of those reporting as a friend/relative identified as non-Indigenous and the remaining 5% preferred to not identify.
[7] See Australian Bureau of Statistics. Estimates and projections of the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander population for 2011 to 2031. (<https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/aboriginal-and-torres-strait-islander-peoples/estimates-and-projections-aboriginal-and-torres-strait-islander-australians/2011-2031#methodology>). Released 24/07/2024.

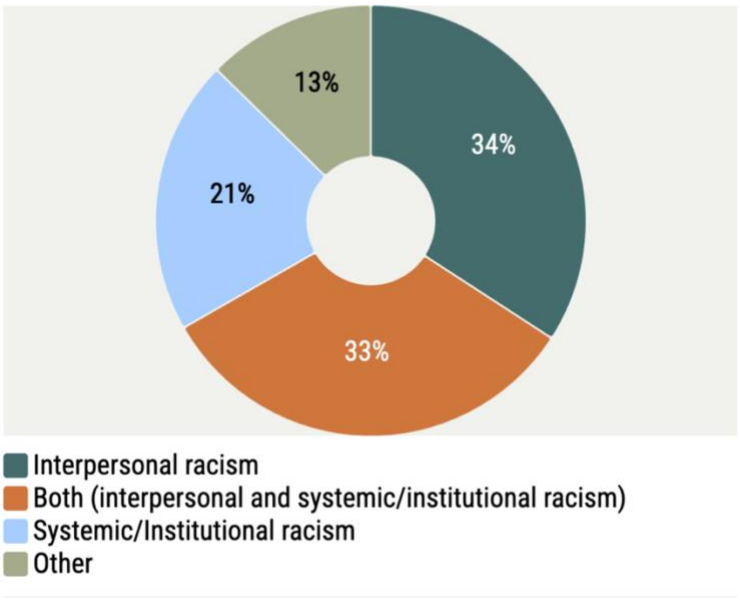
## 2.2 How the incident was experienced or witnessed

Individuals completing the Register were asked how the incident was experienced or witnessed. This was a compulsory question for a registration to be accepted.

The categories for selection were ‘interpersonal racism’, ‘systemic/institutional racism’, ‘both interpersonal and systemic/institutional racism’, and 'other’. The Register defines ‘interpersonal’ racism as 'person to person' racism. ‘Systemic/Institutional’ racism is defined as occurring 'where system, organisation or institutional policies systematically treat First Nations people unfairly'.

As shown in Figure 4, just over a third of all incidents were witnessed or experienced as interpersonal racism (34%). A third of incidents were witnessed or experienced as *both* interpersonal and systemic/institutional racism (33%). More than one in five incidents were witnessed or experienced as systemic/ institutional racism (21%). (See also Table 4 in Appendix A).

**Figure 4 How the incident was experienced or witnessed**




Source: Table 4 How the incident was experienced or witnessed by who reported the racism

First Nations people reporting direct experiences of racism were more likely to categorise incidents as both interpersonal and systemic/institutional, while third parties (friends/relatives and witnesses) were more likely to identify incidents as interpersonal racism (Table 4, Appendix A). For those who responded ‘other’, most incidents recorded occurred within social media, or witnessed online.[8] It may be that for those selecting ‘other’, these types of incidents are difficult to categorise as interpersonal, systemic/institutional racism or both.

We note too that there is not always consistency in how individuals are categorising their reports across these different categories, meaning that the statistics set out above need to be interpreted alongside accounts shared as qualitative data. Categorisation can be subjective.

[8] These reports commonly referred to skits of a particular female comedian, see below at [2.3.1]. We note too that witnesses of racism were proportionately more likely to select ‘other’ (42/56 or 75%) than those who self-reported (14/56 or 25%) (Table 4, Appendix A).

As an example, racist incidents identified as ‘interpersonal’ were sometimes but not always also categorised as ‘systemic/institutional’ where racism perpetrated by an individual was clearly connected with broader historical, cultural and other contexts or systems. For example, this was the approach taken by one witness reporting an incident involving a Church Dean who had replaced the Aboriginal flag outside his cathedral with the church’s ensign.

> The decision to remove the Aboriginal flag was challenged by an older lady who has been very involved in justice activism for many years, to which the Dean responded by shutting the conversation down. What stands out to me is the dynamic of contempt and erasure of present-day understandings of the questions being broached. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

The report goes on to set out in full a message from the Church Dean, published with a print of the 1908 Commonwealth coat of arms and interpreted by the witness as being dismissive of negative perceptions of Australia Day celebrations (arising because of the day’s association with colonisation, discussed in our last annual report). The Dean wrote, ‘It is sad though that some strident voices seem to want to erase the presence and legitimacy of people other than Indigenous people in this land.’ The witness places this incident in wider context and also notes that raising the issue with the Bishop (as a representative of the Church more senior than the Dean) would be pointless. ‘The person least likely to be receptive to feedback is the bishop. This fellow is his man.’

> Since this message was published a number of parishioners have remarked that the atmosphere of the cathedral has become much more adversarial. There are broader psycho-social safety dynamics to this situation that make it an inherently unsafe place for Aboriginal people. In a church that has prided itself on being open to everyone without judgement, this represents a major degradation of the culture. On the next [Call It Out Register] question I'm ticking ‘multiple incidents’ because this is something that is wider than a ‘single incident’. This is an instance of a culture shift that allows bigger forms of race-based contempt to be displayed. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

As a further example of the way in which different forms of racism interact, an incident occurring in a university setting was also identified as both interpersonal (racism perpetrated by an individual student) and systemic (where the institution responded poorly).

> Interpersonal racism came from university student against me … verbally in class with an audience, privately via emails, and via the media … Institutional racism came from university 'support' services, university executive and university legal team in the way they handled my reporting of the student's behaviour in class and via work email. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

And finally, we received multiple reports about a mainstream media interview in which the non-Indigenous interviewer raised (completely irrelevant) past actions of a young First Nations man being interviewed about his win in a fishing competition. [9]

> A young Aboriginal man was publicly humiliated and shamed by a well-known Caucasian television journalist in an 'interview' about catching a prize-winning barramundi. The presenter/journalist used the interview as an opportunity to discriminate against the young man, raising the issue of criminal behaviour in the young man's past which had absolutely nothing to do with catching the barramundi, thereby vilifying the young man and reinforcing negative stereotypes about Aboriginal people. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

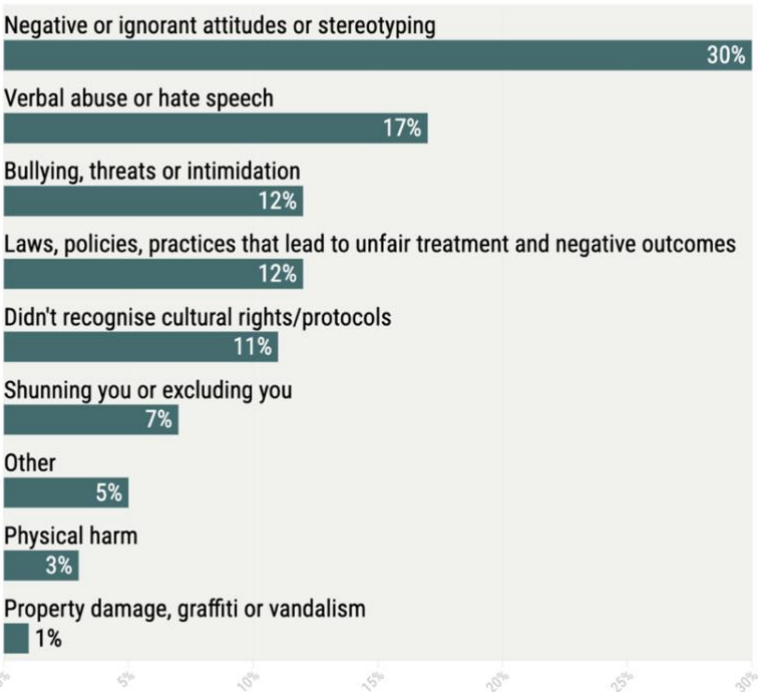
As the report states, the actions of a single journalist, in this case, tipped over into systemic racism as the media company in question saw no issue with the question being asked and the interview being broadcast.

> It is completely unacceptable journalism and representative of the systemic racism within the news organisation that this was allowed to occur and air on national television. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

## 2.3 Type of racism

Individuals were asked to classify the type of racism being reported from a choice of 9 options. This was a compulsory question for a registration to be accepted. Those completing a report could identify more than one type of racism, with more than half of all respondents (253/442 or 57%) providing multiple responses (n=1005, see Table 5 in Appendix A). This demonstrates the multi-layered nature of racism, discussed further at [2.5.1].

**Figure 5 Type of racism experienced or witnessed**




Source: Table 5 Type of racism experienced or witnessed* by who reported the racism

As shown in Figure 5, 'negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping' was the most common type of racism

[9] See video of interview uploaded to TikTok (shared to the Register) here: <https://www.tiktok.com/@tattoodesigner0/video/7364409753423957266?_r=1&_t=8m2HF8MKXV2>

identified (30%), followed by 'verbal abuse or hate speech' (17%), 'bullying, threats or intimidation' (12%), 'laws policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes' (12%) and 'didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols (11%) (see also Table 5 in Appendix A).[10]

Racist attitudes or stereotyping was the most common type of racism identified by *all* groups using the Register.[11] However, there are some notable differences between groups in the type of racism identified (Table 5, Appendix A).[12]

- Witness reports were proportionately more likely to identify racist attitudes/ stereotyping (37%) than either self-reports (24%) or friend/relative reports (25%).
- Self-reports and friend/relative reports were more likely to identify shunning/excluding the person (11% and 10%, respectively) than witness reports (4%).
- Friend/relative reports were more likely to identify the type of racism as verbal abuse or hate speech (22%) than either self-reports (14%) or witness reports (20%).

### 2.3.1 Racist stereotyping

Racist attitudes or stereotyping is the predominant type of racism identified in the Register (30%). The pervasive nature of stereotyping is also indicated by the extent to which it is identified as 'ongoing' by those using the Register (25%) (see Table 12 in Appendix A and [2.5] below). As highlighted in our earlier reporting, racist attitudes and stereotyping underpin racism in most or all contexts in which it arises.

We saw the same types of stereotyping/racist attitudes reported this year as in previous years. Common examples describe First Nations people as law breakers or as otherwise engaging in anti-social or negative behaviour, misusing alcohol/drugs, seeking or receiving financial benefits or 'hand-outs' they don't deserve (and related to this, also avoiding taxes or employment) and not looking or acting 'Black' enough to be Indigenous.

The following reports detail instances of stereotyping. Note the reference in the first report below to the term 'natives', relevant to discussion below of links between present-day and historical racism.

> I was travelling from [named town in NSW] airport to a hotel for a work conference and was talking to the driver. The conversation started out fine. We discussed the

[10] Overall, these statistics are similar to those recorded in 2023-24. Note that the list of available answers for this question was changed in 2024-25, and while some were simply combined/merged (e.g., verbal abuse and hate speech), discriminatory laws/policies/practices was added as a category and discrimination and institutional racism were both removed because they are recorded elsewhere.

[11] Racist attitudes or stereotyping was also the most common type of racism identified in both 2022-23 and 2023-24.

[12] All groups reported bullying, threats and intimidation and discriminatory laws, policies and practices at a similar frequency.

weather, the traffic … eventually he asked the purpose of my travel. I explained it was for work and that I worked for a First Nations legal provider so he asked my thoughts on the referendum and CTG (Closing the Gap) which I gave. He then asked if I would hear him out to which I agreed. He was telling me how every time he sees a homeless person or a drunk person they were "natives", anyone that's ever abused him or run from him were "natives", and how he wished the government would stop throwing money at the problem and educate the "natives". When I asked if by "Native" he meant First Nations peoples, he replied "yes, they all are problematic and it will only get better if we stop throwing money at them and educate them." … He then decided to tell me I was too fair to be a “native”. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

I was attending an appointment and the person who was providing a beauty service made a comment that was racist toward Aboriginal workers. I'm very fair skinned so will often hear things not said around other mob. I had made a comment about my workplace currently looking for employees. The person said, "but they're unreliable workers, aren't they?" I stated no, that's not my experience at all, in fact everyone I worked with were professional and hard working. That Aboriginal staff have skills that can't be taught and that is highly valued. The person then said that wasn’t their experience. I felt saddened that people felt so comfortable making such comments without understanding it was hurtful and untrue. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

[At] the [named social club, QLD] … I was having a bet on the pokie machines to relax and was not drinking any alcohol at all. Behind where I was seated was a white male whom I have now found out to be [non-Indigenous musician named]. I overheard [him] say in his words "my taxes pay for community". I took no notice as he could be meaning any community. A few minutes passed and I noticed one of the clubs employees and another female chatting to him. I got up to collect my winnings from the cash dispenser machine and it was then I overheard him say "My taxes pay for her to play pokies" and he was looking at me! I said to him "excuse me you don't know me from a bar of soap what gives you the right to judge me for the colour of my skin and for your information I work two jobs and own 3 businesses and I pay well over $200,000 in taxes!" (Self-report, Aboriginal)

This incident happened in the local … sauna of all places. I very rarely treat myself to some ‘me’ time. I was sitting in the sauna and there were about 2 older men and 2 men about my age in the sauna. The men then all of a sudden started talking about how Aboriginal people get so much stuff for free. They did not know I was Koori as I can obviously pass as a non-Koori person. The said men were all clearly of European descent. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Other incidents involved stereotyping arose in a **health setting**. For instance,

> My dad had been admitted to a [named hospital, NSW] Emergency Department. It was getting late in the evening and he'd been there all day. He was walking down the ward to the bathroom and his gait was wide and unsteady. The nurse who was looking after him and the night shift nurse were handing over and one joked to the other that he was "pissed" so no wonder he fell over. They both laughed. He had had a mini stroke. Both my mum and I heard this comment, thankfully dad is a bit deaf. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

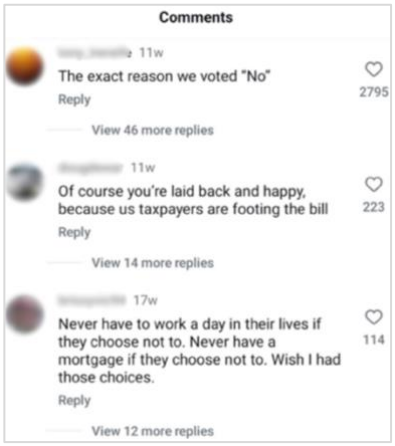
> I have recently started work at a new country hospital. There is also a student registered nurse who previously worked at this hospital as an enrolled nurse … Whilst discussing her experience working in [named town, WA] she made some derogatory comments towards Aboriginal people. When asked what she thought of working in [named town, WA] she stated with a negative infliction that "you will only be nursing Aboriginal people". She then continued to explain how she wouldn't live [there] permanently because there is "just Aboriginal people there" and "they break in". (Witness report, Aboriginal)




Based on reporting to Call It Out, stereotyping and racist attitudes are hugely common issues in **online settings**, including on social media (see [2.4.1]). The image to the left, reported by an Aboriginal witness, is one example of this.

For the image below, the following context was also provided.

> A woman interviewed an Aboriginal man on the street about his views on Australia. He answered it was messed up because Aboriginal people are not recognised. The comments section was filled with stereotypes about Aboriginal people not working, getting free housing and never paying tax. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)




There were *multiple* reports too about racist stereotyping by comedians – frequently about one comedian in particular. Witness reports described a 'Racist comedian on Instagram being extremely derogatory towards First Nations People' and 'Attempt at comedy by a person who thinks ugly racism is funny'[13] (witness reports, non-Indigenous). Other relevant reports are as follows.

[13] See video uploaded to Instagram (shared to the Register) here <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DEHOsoIzL0P/?utm_source=ig_web_copy_link&igsh=MzRlODBiNWFlZA==>.

> A comedian perpetuated harmful stereotypes of First Nations peoples in her comedy set, mocking the use of traditional place names, as well as trauma (substance abuse issues). She has also shared a video of this on her social media and continues to create new content around these destructive ideals. (Witness report, Aboriginal)
>
> [Named comedian] posted a video of her comedy show where she perpetuated stereotypes of Aboriginal women as alcoholics, mocked their accents and said they were metho drinkers. She then abused Aboriginal people who called her out and said they were hurt and offended by the stereotypes and asked her to remove the video she was sharing [and she responded] by saying they had no sense of humour. She then went on to post another meme mocking the Aboriginal accent. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

### 2.3.2 Aggressive racism

Verbal abuse/hate speech was the second most common type of racism disclosed (17%). This and other forms of what we have termed 'aggressive racism' are evidenced in many reports, however. We identify bullying, threats, intimidation (12%), physical harm (3%) and damage to property (1%) as 'aggressive racism'. Taken together, these types of aggressive racism comprised a relatively high 33% of all responses (see Figure 5 above, and Table 5 in Appendix A). Aggressive racism also constituted 35% of all incidents reported as ongoing (see Table 12 in Appendix A and below at [2.5]).

Reports of verbal abuse and hate speech may link to other forms of racism, including stereotyping (for example, related to criminality of First Nations people). Incidents may be private (for example, in family conversations) and/or public in nature.

> Someone put [up] a video of people in their yard trespassing and a guy commented "uncivilised koons (sic) at it again". (Witness report, Aboriginal)
>
> I tried to talk to my father about why Australia day (Invasion day) is harmful to the First Nations peoples and he called me a "<n word> lover." (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Reports describing more **public incidents** described use of hate speech or symbols in the workplace and online social media posts, including comments referencing the Klu Klux Klan (KKK) or lynching of First Nations people, for instance.






The guy [shared social media profile] promotes lynching of First Nations people. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

I work in a drug and alcohol rehabilitation program and a coworker said she was 'sweating like a nigger at a KKK meeting', which made the rest of the staff that were present burst out laughing. Once they saw that I was not laughing, she tried to excuse her language/comment by saying she "says it in front of her Aboriginal friend all the time". (Witness report, Aboriginal)

While travelling in [named town, QLD] to visit family I stumbled on a property with Nazi symbols. I have researched online and found this place and the Nazi symbols have been there for a number of years. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

Aggressive racism incidents described *in-person* physical harm, also raised in other sections of this report (for example, police assaults at [2.4.4]).

> [Named individuals x 3] always call my Torres Strait Islander mate a petrol sniffer and always exclude him from things and make him really upset and depressed. They also call him a dumb abo and always physically attack him with kicks and punches singling him out because of his race. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> I was serving a customer who disclosed to me that they (or their partner?) had 'drove over an Aboriginal'. This dehumanising language was both shocking and upsetting. Prior to disclosing this information, they were looking at my Blak Pride pin from Clothing the Gaps which has the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander flag connected by a rainbow. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Threats or incitement to inflict physical harm were also reported – arising both online and in-person. An Aboriginal witness reported as 'Threats of genocide' the online post to the right. Note the KKK symbol used as the social media profile identifier. Other reports include the following.




> While I was waiting in line at the bakery at [named town, NT] ... one recent morning, a man behind me was loudly talking to another man about how his neighbour's house was broken into, and their car was stolen and crashed. What made it worse was how he kept referring to the perpetrators as "black fellas,"

saying they were "scum" and "should be shot," repeatedly, loud enough for everyone to hear. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

[An Aboriginal man] was undertaking his tertiary course and bullied for his wardrobe but then escalated into threats of violence due to his Aboriginal background. A man came up to him with a deodorant can and lighter in class and asked [this man] if he wanted to "get burnt". (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

A witness reported multiple posts by an individual on Facebook, one of which called for the restoration of past policy 'permitting' the shooting of Aboriginal people (witness report, non-Indigenous).




**Online incidents** were sometimes reported as provoking and encouraging real-life incidents of violence - and First Nations young people are a common target in this context (see further below [4.3]).

Aboriginal family in a home targeted by white person because of racism and hate. The white man targeted the home and went to "confront" the family and then returned setting the house alight with a Molotov cocktail. The man has since been charged by [police] but the build-up to the incident included online hate and community members of the Facebook group encouraging the racialised violence. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Incidents involving harassment and intimidation included the **mainstream media** interview conducted with a First Nations young person who won a fishing competition, referred to in [2.2].

[Named journalist] harassed and intimidated a young Black man on public television. Blatantly racist attitude and stereotyping. This is racist and it's defamation. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Online incidents also included targeted intimidation and harassment of First Nations individuals, including those seen as 'activist' or as having an opinion (for example, if commenting on racist content).

It has come to my attention my [Facebook] profile is being shared onto racists' pages. These people also send me messages, saying "they don't like Aboriginal activists." Sharing my profile pic again and again. [This particular person is] online speaking of creating an army and he has people who follow him and participate in the harassment and my profile shares. Go to these peoples' pages and you will see the extremism of this. I have not spoken to these people. They are sharing a

> profile pic of mine from the Referendum last year. I perform in a band for a living, I'm a little worried I'm being targeted. (Self-report, Aboriginal)
>
> After engaging in a public commentary on Facebook, a user decided [to] message me directly to carry on with their views regarding the superiority of white Australians and compare with First Nations peoples in a direct attempt to assert superiority. The same user has now decided to post passive derogatory comments about [First Nations peoples] on my personal page which is public. (Self-report, not identified)

Again, harassment and intimidation also occurred **in-person** or as 'real-life' incidents, including as follows.

> Non Aboriginal neighbour of Aunt is racially abusing her and forcing her to leave her public housing unit where she was so happy and safe. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)
>
> We had just finished watching State of Origin and a white male was coming home across the street - this time he gave us the finger, the second time he came onto my property and threw an egg at the window, the third time he came around and moved the mirrors on the car. Believe this was racially motivated as an act of racial hate against Aboriginals. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

### 2.3.3 Laws, policies, practice

Systemic or institutional racism has again been reported with relative frequency to Call It Out. As discussed earlier, when describing how the incident was experienced or witnessed, reports of systemic/institutional racism on its own constituted 21% of all reports, while experiences of both interpersonal and systemic/institutional were identified in 33% of all reports.[14] Thus, taken together, 54% of people described experiencing the incident as systemic/institutional racism.

As noted above, the Register defines 'systemic/institutional' racism as occurring 'where system, organisation or institutional policies systematically treat First Nations people unfairly'. Related to this, this year we included 'law, policies and practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes' as one category of 'type of racism'. Just over one in ten (12%) of all reports were identified as falling into this category (Figure 5 above). In the discussion below we draw some links between this type of racism and systemic/institutional racism, as reported to the Register.

[14] See above at [2.2] and Figure 4, and Table 4 in Appendix A. See also the discussion of location and perpetrator of incidents below at [2.3], [2.4], [2.5.3] and [2.6], and of racism specifically related to the criminal legal system below at [2.4.4].

As a starting point, failure to adequately provide for First Nations-led decision-making at both a policy and legislative level on issues impacting First Nations people was raised as an issue of broad relevance.

> Government institutions know what the F they need to do! They even say they are going to do it or already are. But they are appalling in their omission-to pass control and decision making back to First Nations people – in justice, health education and really – everywhere. Why is this so hard!!? (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

More specifically, one report spoke of legislation impacting decision-making of First Nations people in the NT. This report relates to the Territory Coordinator Bill, which bestowed substantive powers on a government appointed 'Territory Coordinator'. The bill is identified as permitting the NT Government 'to override dozens of laws relevant to projects of "economic significance"'. It passed into law in 2025, 'despite strong opposition from leading Indigenous groups and legal experts' (witness report, non-Indigenous). Aboriginal Land Councils in the NT identified the bill as excluding 'Aboriginal people from involvement in development decisions on their traditional lands' and preventing them from 'protecting their land and culture'.[15] The Territory Coordinator, for instance, is granted powers to declare a Territory Development or Infrastructure Coordination Area on Aboriginal land and Native Title areas without consent or consultation with Traditional Owners, as examples.[16]

Laws, policies and practices that appear neutral (do not single out First Nations people for negative treatment intentionally or at all) may have disproportionately negative impacts on this group in their application. Criminal laws which may not explicitly target but have reasonably foreseeable negative impacts on First Nations people were called out in this context, including Victorian bail laws.[17]

> The Bail Amendment (Stage One) Act (Vic) 2017 and Bail Amendment (Stage Two) Act (Vic) 2018 saw changes to the Bail Act (Vic) 1977. There amendments had a discriminatory effect on First Nations People - especially those in incarceration awaiting trial or a hearing. While the Bail Amendment Act (Vic) 2023 addressed/repealed some of these discriminatory amendments, there is still a discriminatory foundation to the Bail Act (Vic) 1977 that needs to be addressed so as to make the Act more equitable for all communities. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

---

[15] See: <https://irp.cdnwebsite.com/98b48721/files/uploaded/JOINT_RELEASE_Land_Councils_Call_for_Territory_Coordinator_To_Be_Dumped.pdf>.

[16] See: <https://www.nlc.org.au/joint-media-release-nt-land-councils-call-on-nt-government-to-bin-territory-coordinator-bill>.

[17] See discussions at: <https://www.abc.net.au/news/2025-03-13/victoria-bail-law-reform-explainer/105042562>.

Related to this, also described was the way in which different institutions or systems come together to discriminate against First Nations people. This occurs, for instance, where criminal legislation or policy (again, in this instance, Victorian bail laws) are introduced by government in part as a reaction to perceived threats to law and order so often a focus for the media. This year we once again received reports of the deliberate targeting of First Nations people in media reporting.

> Knee-jerk and racist bail reforms announced by Victoria last week, including removal of the principle of detention as a last resort for children and young people. … Plus, the accompanying fear mongering by certain media outlets, e.g. [named media outlet] ran 21 stories and launched a petition pushing for reforms in the week before the reforms were unveiled by [named non-Indigenous female politician in Victoria]. Examples of titles include crap like "Suburbs under siege", "Taking back our streets". Sorry but whose land is it, White mate? (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Zoning laws that prohibited public drinking were identified as more likely to negatively impact Aboriginal people (and as being intended to do so). Police discretion in implementing these and other laws (for example, move-on laws) were also reported – with police-based racial profiling of First Nations young people singled out in some instances (see [4.3]).

> Drinking laws in the NT … exclude areas such as [named town, NT] and [named town, NT] where white people drink [and] … discriminate solely against Aboriginal people drinking in public. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

> Increased police numbers and increased powers to keep First Nations away from CBD. Law and Order response to social problems. Strongly supported by the general population. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

As this last report indicates, racism within government systems can be linked to community-embedded racist attitudes. These attitudes create the conditions in which the justice system perpetrates racism.

> Society is the perpetrator – the justice system is the mechanism through which we continue to colonise and keep Aboriginal people in their place. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

In terms of neutral but discriminatory policy, the following incident relates to First Nations' access to services that fail to meet their needs.

> As the majority of people I look after are Aboriginal, I regularly see and hear of local businesses and attitudes negatively treat[ing] the locals [sic]. There is so much red tape that gets in the way of assisting my [clients] as the standards of servicing DO NOT CATER for common local Aboriginal circumstances such as: Lack of

> community or personal transport, No ID, No Phone, homelessness, Drug and Alcohol etc... (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Education-related policy in the NT was also reported; specifically, that schools record Aboriginal student absences in ways that fail to account for cultural reasons for non-attendance. The negative consequences of this for Aboriginal education are also highlighted (that is, reduced funding).[18]

> Students attending NT Dept Ed Schools are classed as having 'unacceptable absence' for periods of time spent at an outstation, being cultural homelands located far from the school they're enrolled at. Outstations provide important connections to country, to family, to lore, to ceremony, to language, to all things that embody identity. When students are classed as having 'unacceptable attendance' the student is then removed from the census of the school. Census data informs funding for each school. So remote schools suffer when students are unable to 'attend' their enrolled setting due to travel to outstations and their parents don't provide 'acceptable' reasons for the students absence. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

As discussed earlier, interpersonal racism may interconnect with institutional racism. This includes where is is perpetrated by individuals as a pattern of behaviour. The following examples report such a pattern, in this case involving multiple staff perpetrating racism within health services. The incidents impact First Nations patients and their families, staff and the local First Nations community.

> Bullying and harassment of Aboriginal staff. Poor treatment of patients in Aboriginal health service. Turning patients away from service, speaking down to and dismissing Aboriginal patients. Treating local people badly. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Aboriginal man dying of renal failure was treated in an appalling way at a major western Sydney hospital. He was left in the hallway, ignored and when he did get a room after a few days he was not cleaned or given appropriate food. I observed

[18] Also relevant in this instance is location. Submissions made to reviews of human rights and anti-discrimination laws (in NT, QLD) have recommended inclusion of location (remoteness) as a ground for discrimination – likely to have particular application to First Nations people given that while they are more likely to live in cities and regional areas than remote areas, the proportion of First Nations people relative to the total population is generally higher in more remote areas. See for instance 2024 Community Legal Centre submission to review of the QLD *Human Rights Act* (2019) at: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1I0NhyIUuu_2z1tk-n7xoKQdnHVS3wU-U/view>; <https://clcs.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2024/07/21-June-24-4Rs-submisison-review-of-the-Qld-Human-Rights-Act.pdf>. Based on 2021 Census-based estimates, a higher proportion Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people (15.4%) live in remote and very remote regions (compared to 1.4% non-Indigenous) (see ABS 2023 at: <https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/people/aboriginal-and-torres-strait-islander-peoples/estimates-aboriginal-and-torres-strait-islander-australians/latest-release#remoteness-areas>).

> very negative comments about him from staff. The family was very distressed and no one cared. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

The behaviour of individuals, whether or not it occurs as a pattern, may also constitute institutional racism where incidents go unchecked or are otherwise poorly addressed (including preventatively). There are *multiple* reports to Call It Out describing institutional failure to avoid or eliminate racism impacting First Nations people (see also [3.3], [3.4]). Linking in with the category of racism 'law, policy or practice', appropriate procedures and policies that might check racist 'practice' on the part of individuals may be absent or just poorly implemented, as the following education related example suggests.

> Institution not adhering to their own policies. Choosing to treat an Aboriginal student by not following specific wording in their own policies and disadvantaging the student unfairly. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Other reports referred to tokenistic efforts of organisations to set up Reconciliation Action Plans (RAPs), cultural safety frameworks or similar. Health was again highlighted in this respect.

> There are too many incidences and experiences of racism to list. Health organisation health equity strategy / framework does not align with what is required to address or eliminate racial discrimination and institutional racism. The proposed strategies are influenced by Western ideologies, systems and structures. Health organisations lack understanding and respect on community engagement and consultation. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

Some reported RAPs or similar policy being developed without any real substance and in some cases, apparently in order to derive a commercial or financial benefit. The following incident identifies this as occurring in a corporate mining context.

> The discriminatory practices within [named company] extend beyond individual interactions to systemic issues such as the misuse of the Reconciliation Action Plan (RAP). It is deeply concerning to learn that the company may have entered into RAP agreements solely for the purpose of securing business, rather than genuinely committing to reconciliation and addressing issues of Indigenous inequality. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

'Black cladding' was also called out - arising where a largely non-Indigenous controlled organisation presents itself to be Indigenous controlled or led in order to win tenders or otherwise derive benefit.

> Our business [named company] (100% Indigenous owned) was exploited and defrauded by [named charity] and [named not for profit]. We were in a consortium led by [named charity] that won a $5m federal government grant. We were excluded from consultations, denied transparency or viewing the grant

> application and denied appropriate funding. When the grant was won, we were pressured to step down from the consortium, placed on a 12month contract, denied reasonable funding, forced into involuntary servitude and paid $23,000 for 14 months of work, co-design, content design and workshop planning, development, marketing and delivery. When we complained about the injustice of being severely financially discriminated against, our contract was terminated because of "lacking capacity to deliver the five year program we co-designed" ... The entire process was co-designed by white women charity leaders to significantly disadvantage the only Indigenous business in the consortium ... This process indicates how charity leaders intentionally co-design disadvantage in federal government grants to benefit their organisations and cause profound financial detriment to Indigenous businesses. (Self-report, Torres Strait Islander female)

As a related incident of racism, a councillor was reported as publicly questioning payment to First Nations people for their expertise in guiding local government policy.

> A councillor on [named town] Council made derogatory commentary about the procurement of Aboriginal people to consult and engage [named town] City Council and Aboriginal people in developing a commitment and action plan for the council. The councillor named the advisors, criticised their integrity, publicised the fee, questioned the value of the service, criticised the cultural safety training and expertise of the cultural safety practitioner. The post was put on Facebook and people commented with racist, uninformed, derogatory comments. This councillor of [named town] incited that racism. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

As some of the above examples indicate, laws, policies and practices developed or implemented within government systems and institutions may be identified as institutionally racist. We discuss below in detail at [2.4.4] reports about the criminal legal system, as a specific example of this. The child protection system was also called out. Incidents were raised about its systemic failure to work culturally and otherwise appropriately with First Nations families and communities. This includes failure to adhere to government policy designed to protect the rights of Aboriginal people interacting with this system (note the overlap with non-recognition of cultural rights, discussed below at [2.3.4]).

> [Named government agency/service] treated a family in a racist manner by not recognising that mob is important in Aboriginal families. Young mother was targeted to have non Aboriginal respite care while [named government agency/service] ignored the many female family members who wanted to assist her. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> [Named government agency/service] worker did not allow Aboriginal parent to express their views. Allowed a non-Aboriginal support person (asked for by the Aboriginal parent) to be told that 'we are not interested in your white views'. Used threatening language to suggest their child would not ever be returned. Shamed the parent by reminding them they were the 'problem'. Did not follow the [Aboriginal case management policy]. Allowed Aboriginal workers to support the humiliation. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> Child removed from Aboriginal parent under ROSH (Risk of Significant Harm). Aboriginal grandmother and great grandmother were refused their care. Child went to non-Aboriginal non-related person and remains there after 18 months despite grandmother being a very suitable person to care for them. Report made on grandmother contained false and racist comments. Report was compiled by agency employed by [named government agency/service]. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

The above reports and the one that follows point to poor accountability within the child protection system for non-compliance with policy, including for NGOs funded to support Aboriginal families interacting with this system.

The above incidents describe limited accountability on the part of government. The following report identifies that NGOs funded to support Aboriginal families interacting with this system are similarly not held accountable for failure to comply with relevant policy.

> An NGO organisation worker allowed the OOHC carer to be abusive to the Aboriginal family by telling them that the children belonged to her not them. She was given their address so then intervened on monthly visits causing distress and humiliation. Aboriginal family rights/complaints were ignored. Cultural practices of the family were trivialised. Family now do not see their children … I am saddened and shocked by the [Aboriginal case management policy] being ignored and the ferocity of the racist attitude towards the family. The NGO receives over $5,000,000 of govt funding. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Finally, racism can be seen as political in nature and as situated within our political system. A number of reports referred to incidents that they felt reflected racism as 'right-wing', for instance (including when referring to the racist skit of the comedian discussed above) or as emanating from politicians and media personalities who are 'far-right populist and conservative' commentating on 'identitity politics' (witness report, non-Indigenous).[19]

[19] See link shared to the Register here: <https://www.facebook.com/watch/?mibextid=wwXIfr&v=854655483449198&rdid=H78QT4HqDelC0RCV>.

### 2.3.4 Cultural and other Indigenous rights

Those using the Call It Out Register have the option to select 'Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols (e.g. Kinship, Sorry Business, Acknowledgement of Country)' to describe the incident reported. Multiple reports did so (11% of all reports, see Figure 5 above and Table 5 in Appendix A). As was the case in previous years, reports described non-recognition of Indigenous sovereign, cultural and spiritual connections to land and country.

> Multiple comments [online] on marine park and First Nations people having special privileges with Cultural fishing practices. Non- Aboriginal people feel like it's reverse racism and we have special privileges. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

> A non-Indigenous relative (half-sister with a non-Indigenous father) and I got into a discussion about Uluru and how people used to be able to walk up the rock. She said she would walk it if she could. I said that's disrespectful to our Indigenous Australians who had asked that people do not walk on the rock. She said, 'nobody owns a rock'. Then we got into an argument about the politics. She said that I don't understand and it's a complex matter. I tried to tell her she doesn't understand my connection to country and spirit/ancestors and it's about respecting that ... She also said 'she didn't cause what had happened' and 'every country gets invaded'. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Reports called out local government Councillors and once again, health staff.

> During NAIDOC march down main street of [named town, NSW], [a] Shire Council Chamber employee stated, "What a waste of time". This is an Aboriginal community. The Shire Council Chambers have predominately white staff and have regularly displayed disdain and ignorance of the local Aboriginal residents of the Shire. Staff were not even aware of the NAIDOC march taking place today even though they are responsible for the road closures. There was no signage up informing of the local event or decoration celebrating NAIDOC week. Disgusting display today from staff. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> I work for a small country hospital. We had an Aboriginal gentleman transferred from a larger hospital to our site. He had advanced cancer and was under the palliative pathway. His wish was to "die on country" hence he was transferred to our hospital. During shift handover shortly after the patient arrived I was explaining why the patient had transferred to our hospital. One of my coworkers responded "to die on country? ... So, what... We have to lay him on the ground?" Then proceeded to start laughing. My colleagues intercepted and explained the concept of "on country" and she replied that she understood what it meant but just thought that it was "silly". My colleagues also mocked his family members. This patient had some family members who were incarcerated and sought

> permission for compassionate leave from the prison to visit the patient. Some staff commented that they should've thought about their actions more and other derogatory comments regarding Aboriginal people within the justice system. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Dismissal of and push back against an Acknowledgement of/Welcome to Country were reported, as was the case in previous Call It Out reporting.

> I'm a local government worker who responds to an event feedback form on my section of our website. I got a submission ... from someone complaining about an event they attended ... The submission content read: "What a fantastic evening, sadly spoilt by the fact that we had to sit through a lecture from an Indigenous person who put themselves above everyone else, my views were shared by almost all within my seating area! I didn't drive 3.5 hrs & spend $400 on tickets to listen to her misplaced BS! No recognition of my father & grandfather, my mates who fought for our land, sorry but the welcome to country went out the door at the Voice referendum and you should do the same." (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Someone on my local Facebook page wrote "Can you imagine, you're an Aussie. You was born and lived and worked your entire life in Australia and you are now in your 80s. And you have to listen to a 19 year old girl tell you to make acknowledgement of country ... what a load of crap." And comments followed being completely ignorant about the history of Australia. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

As noted below in [2.4], education was one of the more commonly identified locations where racism occurs. We set out education related incidents throughout this report, one of which is as follows.

> I have been working with [this student] for the past semester on a project about Indigenous literacy in remote Australia. Throughout this subject he has been awfully racist, taking any chance to undermine the struggles of First Nations people and promote a colonial mindset. When I said we need an acknowledgement of country before our presentation, he said "we don't need that *face palm emoji*". When I made a comment he didn't fully agree with he (a white boy) sent a black thumbs-down emoji. Unprompted he went on a rant about how voting Yes in last year's referendum would mean [named beach, NSW] would lose a car park (wtf?? like okay????). Finally, when I asked what custodial lands does he live on (in reference to writing an acknowledgment of country for the beginning of our report) he said "as far as I'm concerned, I live in [(colonially) named town, NSW] on the land of the [(colonially) named town, NSW] people". (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

A further report about local government was also shared in this same context.

> An Elected Council Member of [named town] Council has posted misinformation on their personal page in relation to Welcome ceremony. It's deeply concerning to see an elected official from [named town] Council spreading misinformation about Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultural practices. Recently, [they] publicly claimed that the Welcome to Country and Smoking Ceremonies are a "recent concoction" with no basis in Indigenous culture. This is factually incorrect and dismisses the deep historical significance of these traditions .... We need to call this behaviour out. (Witness report, not identified)

Further targets of non-recognition of cultural and Indigenous rights were the Aboriginal flag and First Nations author, Bruce Pascoe.

> A Twitter X user stated that the Aboriginal flag represents "a nation that never existed". And that it is a "disgusting abuse" of "everything" Australia "is about." (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> Giving blood: I was reading Dark Emu, and the nurse asked what I was reading. I said, "Dark Emu. A book about Australian Indigenous farming and culture. " To which she replied, "Oh, fiction." (Witness report, non-Indigenous)




The image to the right was part of an additional report about Bruce Pascoe and other First Nations people being targeted on social media.

> Numerous comments about First Nations Peoples clearly breaching [the] definition of dehumanising material and Australia's racial hatred laws. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Reports identifying that First Nations people receive only a very small percentage of monies derived from the Indigenous native food industry in Australia (1%) was also called out as cultural appropriation[20] (witness report, non-Indigenous). Denigration of culture was highlighted in reports, in addition - including the following about a Facebook post made during NAIDOC week.

> The post was around celebrating NAIDOC Week with a guided Aboriginal whale watching experience with an Elder. The comment posted by [named individual]

[20] Reported at <https://www.killyourdarlings.com.au/article/native-foods-and-white-australia/>. This media statement also reports that the industry is worth $50 billion nationally and that less than 2% of the profits go to First Nations people: <https://statements.qld.gov.au/statements/98129>.

> read "FFS... are we doing it in a bark canoe". [This individual] shows on his Facebook profile that he is an employee of [named security company], a branch of [named engineering company], who have a Reconciliation Action Plan and make various claims about wanting to work towards reconciliation. [His] LinkedIn profile shows that he is also a JP. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

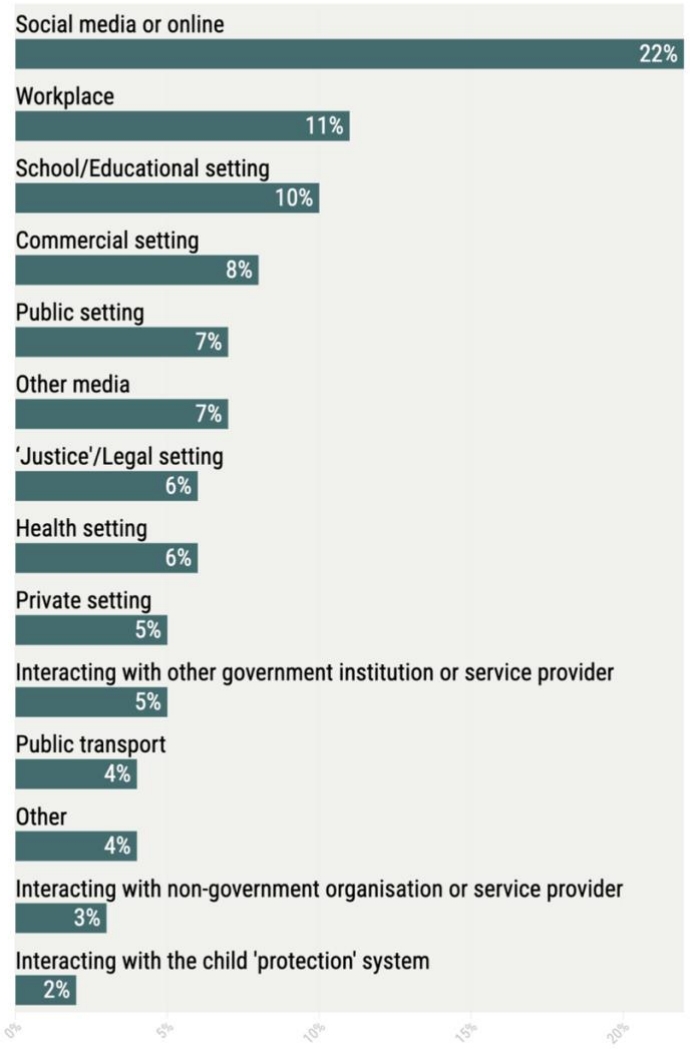
A report related to police attendance at Camp Sovereignty in Melbourne is also relevant. Police extinguished ceremonial fire at the site, amongst other actions detailed further below at [2.4.4], but we note here that Camp Sovereignty has been identified as a culturally significant place and 'a place of peace where community members can gather, yarn and reflect. It is also the resting place for the repatriated remains of 38 Aboriginal Victorians'.[21]

## 2.4 Where the racism happened

Individuals were asked to indicate where the incident reported occurred from a choice of 14 options. This was a compulsory question, answered by all the respondents. Of the 442 respondents, 120 people (or slightly more than one in four people) indicated multiple places (see Table 6 in Appendix A, n=120). We note that this may be because people are reporting multiple incidents or a single incident may have involved multiple places.

As shown in Figure 6, the most common location reported by all respondents was 'social media or online' (22%). This was followed by the 'workplace' (11%) and a 'school/educational setting' (10%). (See also Table 6 in Appendix A).

**Figure 6 Location where the incident happened**




Source: Table 6 Location where the incident happened* by who reported the racism

[21] See: <https://nit.com.au/10-09-2025/20181/victorian-police-admit-being-caught-off-guard-by-camp-sovereignty-attack>.

There was an increase of five percentage points in reports of incidents occurring in a school/educational setting compared with 2023-24. Related to this was an increase in reports of racism against children and young people aged 10-19 years (see below at [2.7.2]). We discuss school-based incidents in a stand-alone section focused on children and young people at [4.2]. Incidents related to other educational settings (including TAFE, university) are discussed throughout the report (for example, as workplace racism at [2.4.3]).

As another notable difference in the data, in 2024-25 there was a decrease in reports of racism occurring in a public setting (down 6 percentage points from last year), perhaps reflecting that in our 2023-24 reporting we recorded a spike in public incidents of racism occurring during the 2023 Referendum period.

There was some variation in locations identified by different groups reporting to the Register, as follows (see Table 6, Appendix A).

- For First Nations people reporting experiences of racism, the more common location of incidents was the workplace (15%), followed by social media (13%) and educational settings (12%).
- For friends/relatives, the more common location identified was educational settings (22%) (10-15 percentage points higher compared with other groups). This group also more frequently reported racism in a private setting (by 7-8 percentage points, compared with other groups).

### 2.4.1 Racism online and in the media

Overall, social media/online racism (22%) in combination with other media (7%) constituted nearly one in three of all locations identified (29%). There were differences across groups, however – with witnesses, for instance, proportionately more frequently identifying these as the location of racism reported (43%)[22] (see Table 6 in Appendix A).

Similar to last year, many online/media incidents demonstrated racist attitudes, including about the so-called 'criminality' of First Nations people.

> Member of various local Facebook groups where individuals constantly post racist remarks about [First Nations' people] perpetuating crime within the area, I always report to have them removed. One example was when [a] stolen car crashed killing 4 of the teenage FN (First Nations) occupants. The comments online were absolutely disgusting. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

The media interview that raised the past criminal history of the young fishing competition winner is also relevant in this context (see [2.2]). This interview was identified as both

[22] This compares with 17% of reports from First Nations people directly experiencing racism and just 8% of reports from friends/relatives. These statistics are similar to those reported in our 2023-24 Annual Report.

drawing on *and* perpetuating negative stereotypes about criminality. As a further report identifies, media reporting based on this same stereotype feeds into racist content online.

> Biased reports on mainstream media about violence in the Northern Territory TV news services ... systematically and overtly report on Aboriginal people perpetrating violence. There is never any coverage of the inflicted pain and trauma from predominantly white, affluent Australians towards Aboriginal people in the community. Immediately after these news reports, I often witness a dramatic increase in racially based venomous language generally directed towards Aboriginal people. Comments include statements to the effect that "they are just black bastards" or "they should all be locked up". These are indiscriminate comments and are not based on any idea of justice but focus on the idea of inflicting punishment upon the whole community in a violent way. This occurs every time such a news broadcast occurs without referencing the repression already imposed on Aboriginal people from institutions and businesses throughout Australia. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

It is worth pointing out too that we again received reports identifying social media/the media as spaces in which racism may be 'made visible' or called out. These reports describe published media articles that deal with racist incidents/issues or people challenging racism on social media, for example. One relevant report concerns a TikTok video made by a First Nations person calling out the above fishing competition interview. This report identifies that members of the public are posting racist comments in response to the TikTok video and that other members of the public are calling out the interview, alongside the TikTok video creator.

> There's a bunch of racist commenters on an Indigenous person's video regarding the interaction between the new Indigenous teenager millionaire and the [named] interviewer. This particular racist commenter kept on saying that Indigenous people are criminals and using racial slurs. They were basically harassing them and they won't back down. I'm about to report them as I write this. I hope TikTok holds them accountable and removes their content and account. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

All other types of racism discussed in [2.3] are evident in online/media related reports, including hate speech/verbal abuse, bullying, harassment and other forms of aggressive racism (see [2.3.2]).

> [Named social media account] runs a page that systematically attacks and racially abuses anyone or anything associated with mob. He is a proud ex-military veteran. And has images of [Indigenous] inmates directly taken from inside [prison] ... he shames them publicly, names, family details, crimes with images of them inside unit blocks ... His abuse is tormenting and has a group of other racist

> minions also systematically abusing anyone in comments sections of Indigenous promoting sites. (Witness report, Aboriginal)
>
> The [named Aboriginal TV/Radio journalist/presenter] was subjected to racist posts on Instagram and X today. With people taunting him using fake Aboriginal sentence construction and others saying pass the goon boss and other offensive and racist remarks. Instagram and X did not moderate these offensive comments. (Self-report, non-identified male)

As a further example, the following report relates to a Facebook post about claims to native title and as such, potentially also constitutes non-recognition of cultural and Indigenous rights.

> There is a publican that owns [named pub/hotel, QLD]. He has just said to get ready for a race war. He is inciting people to join and fight against Indigenous people … The whole comment section is vile! People are threatening to cull us Indigenous people. (Self-report, Aboriginal, female)

### 2.4.2 Racism in public spaces, commercial places and transport

Racism was identified as occurring in a public setting in 7% of reports and in a commercial setting in 8% of reports. Public transport was identified as the location for racism in 4% of reports (see Figure 6 above and Table 6 in Appendix A).

We note the cross-over in incidents occurring in these three locations with certain forms of racism.

- Shunning or excluding was identified in 7% of all reports. While less frequently reported overall, this type of racism was relatively frequently identified as the type of racism occurring in commercial locations (14%) and on public transport (15%).
- The combined incidents of aggressive racism (verbal abuse, bullying, threats, intimidation, physical harm and damage to property) accounted for 42% of all public setting incidents reported, 32% of all commercial places incidents reported and 45% of all public transport incident reported. (See Table 7 in Appendix A).

This cross-over is evident in the reports shared on the Register. For example, reports identified transport operators as refusing to carry Indigenous passengers.

> I am from Whadjuk Country and couldn't even get a taxi in my own Country. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)
>
> Bus driver failed to pick up 3 Aboriginal passengers in the CBD who were waiting at bus stop and had waved for bus to stop. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> The bus driver stopped the bus ... and asked the four passengers to get off the bus. After they told the driver that they needed to travel further along the route, the driver called over two security guards who were at the transfer station, who then got on the bus and started interrogating the four passengers about 'what was going on, why won't you get off, and where are you going'. The security guards were being extremely abusive and intimidating. The driver then drove off towards the city with the security guards still on board. Two or three stops along ... the driver pulled over and told the four passengers to get off the bus. The passengers left the bus, along with one of the security guards. The other security guard got off the bus at one or two more stops along [named street]. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Other passengers can also shun or exclude First Nations people.

> Myself and my daughter in law's mother [named individual, Aboriginal] (my grandchildren's maternal grandmother) were waiting for the train in [named town, WA] Underground after going to the Royal Show. We were loaded up with show bags and gifts for our grandchildren and [my daughter in law's mother] needed to sit and rest, and there was a spare seat next to a white woman available near us. [She] walked over to sit down and the woman began blocking the seat and trying to force her teenaged son standing nearby to sit in the seat and prevented [her] from sitting there. It was obvious the woman was intentionally blocking her, the gestures she was making were exaggerated and dramatic. We tried to be polite and acknowledged she might have legitimately wanted her son to have a seat so just politely nodded and (moved/walked) away. A few minutes later a white man came and sat in the [same] seat ... and she didn't even lift her head or try and prevent him sitting. She made it openly clear that it was just our Aboriginality that was the issue. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

As reports above and those that follow indicate, First Nations people travelling on public transport are subjected to over-surveillance and other forms of discriminatory behaviour. These incidents may arise due to stereotyping – once again, including stereotypes related to so-called criminality (see [2.3.1]).

> I was approached by a [tram] ticket inspector, before I could take my headphones out of my ear she started saying "if you don't have a ticket, you'll have to get off at the next stop". I didn't even get time to pull my ticket out when she started saying "we all know you don't have a ticket". I asked her if she could step back from me because she was intimidating me & I've also been diagnosed with social anxiety disorder which she was triggering. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> Every month, [First Nations people contributing to a research project] experience racism by taxi drivers when attending [the workplace], although a staff member of the [workplace] arranges the taxi pick up and drop off. Examples of racist behaviour; demanding payment before taxi leaves, place of pick up, constantly

> arriving late e.g. by 30-40mins, not listening to passenger ... the important work they do, disrespectful behaviour. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

The reports related to transport portray this as an unsafe (public) space for First Nations people – where racism might be perpetrated by transport providers (see other examples in this report of racist conversations held with providers), the public or perhaps experienced as images left on public transport.

> Sitting in [named airline] business lounge, and had a gentleman openly say "fucking Abos, wish we should have never voted for the 68 Referendum (in response to [named First Nations female senator]). (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

> Me and my siblings booked a ride ... through [named ride service], the driver initiated a conversation about the history of Australia. They recommended a book which supposedly details what happened, and when I asked whether the author is Indigenous, she said, 'well he's a 6th generation Aussie so he considers himself to be Indigenous' and when I responded, 'so he's not truly Indigenous then' they felt the need to tell me 'there's no true Indigenous'. The driver then proceeded to spew inaccurate information about the history of Tasmania framing the Aboriginal people from that region as savages. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

> I've had many [run-ins] with racism ... On a bus there was Aboriginal flags with knifes and under the flag drawing was a caption saying fuck black people we need to breed it out. So many other experiences. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Very similar incidents to those above are reported in commercial spaces, including exclusion.

> Owner refused to sign up for basics card, stating "it's not the clientele I want in this store". (Witness report, not identified)

Often the same stereotyping is also evident too. There were *numerous* reports. Including the following, about First Nations people being treated like criminals in commercial spaces. See also discussion of barriers to calling racism out at [3.3] and targeting of young people at [4.3] in this location.

> Asking a dark skinned person to pay first before they provide the ice cream while 2 light skinned white fellows got ice cream before they pay in front of the dark skinned person. Called out loudly to ‘pay first’. (Self-report, not identified)

> Shop Assistant rudely asked an Elder if she could pay for her groceries before she unpacked. 'You pay for that'? (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Shop owner instructed staff to "treat every blackfella like a perpetrator" and follow them when entering the shop. (Witness report, not identified)

> During check out at [named supermarket chain] [named town, NT] friend was targeted by the [supermarket] worker and who [also] receipt checked me, asking if I had paid when clearly had. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander)

Being rendered invisible in commercial spaces was also reported; for instance, as follows.

> Walked into [named shop, WA], the worker didn't say anything to me at all, I browsed for a bit as I was looking for a particular handbag and to also see if the worker would assist and do their job. Still didn't get a "hello" or "can I help you with anything" and it made me feel so uncomfortable going in there and I will never walk into that [shop] ever again. I work hard for my money and just wanted to spend it like every other person. I was a customer [and they] treated me like I was invisible. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

As a further example of exclusion from public spaces, see discussion of young Aboriginal people being excluded from a public pool at [2.4.4].[23] At [3] and [4] we describe the impacts of and responses to racism as including avoidance of places/people associated with racism. These are further examples of shunning/exclusion.

### 2.4.3 Racism in the workplace

Racism in the workplace has consistently been identified as a significant issue in our annual reports. For 2024-2025, the workplace is the second most common location for racism overall (11%) and is proportionally higher for self-reports (15%). Further, 11% of ongoing incidents occurred in the workplace (see Table 6 in Appendix A). All types of racism were reported as associated with the workplace (see Table 8 in Appendix A). Negative attitudes and stereotyping, bullying and intimidation, laws, policies and practices, cultural rights, and shunning and exclusing were all frequently mentioned.

Workplace related reports spoke of under-employment of First Nations people. This was called out in the tourism industry, for instance (including where destinations include culturally significant sites).

> There appears to be systematic exclusion of local Aboriginal people from employment in [named town] - with a small number of exceptions, tour guides and hotel staff were from dozens of different countries or European descent Australians from the East Coast ...I spent a week in [named town] recently and completed a number of day tours and attended other local sites, museums etc. With a small number of exceptions, there were almost no Aboriginal Australians employed in any public facing businesses. This included tour guides, hotel staff,

[23] There is discussion in [4] of young people disengaging from school following racism, relevant to shunning/exclusion though not to discussion of the locations that are the focus of [2.4.2].

> taxi drivers, museums, day tours to [named sacred site]. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Many reports, however, focused on racism *during* employment, with a broad range of issues called out - including limited opportunity for promotion.

> A white woman in a position of power denied a First Nations woman a promotion due to jealousy and used racial and gendered stereotypes in her performance report. She then scheduled an HR meeting to de-escalate the situation during NAIDOC week and had no awareness of this being an issue. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

We again see stereotyping and aggressive racism (hate speech, verbal abuse) in workplace incidents. For example,

> My manager is a racist woman that openly discussed me and said, "as she is Aboriginal, we can just expect her to go walkabout even when she should be at work". (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I've always been very open about being very insecure about how white my skin is to my co workers, I work in an Aboriginal Identified position off country and its one of my biggest insecurities. A few weeks ago I dyed my hair and my co-worker mentions almost every day since how I'm really "connecting to my Anglo-Saxon roots" and pointing out how it matches my "Irish skin tone". I've mentioned that it makes me feel more insecure when comments like this are made, but she keeps going and even points it out to other co-workers. I know it sounds silly, but she just doesn't stop. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> When discussing factors that may affect the Aboriginal community we are providing the workplace service to, my non-Indigenous co-worker refers to Aboriginal people as coons, gins, blackfellas, blackies, black cunts. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Other incidents spoke of undermining of the capability of senior First Nations staff, including in terms of leadership. The second quote also speaks to difficulties of challenging racism in the workplace and the likely repercussions of doing so (see further at [3.4]).

> I had a senior position in a corporate and was discussing professional development with my supervisor who denied my request and stated: I know you are seen as a leader in your community but we need to teach you to be a corporate leader. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I was asked to set [a] meeting for Aboriginal staff to look at a new training program and to provide feedback. This happened and racism was raised. The director was so angry when she read the minutes, which [were] not ratified but another non-Aboriginal manager sent them to the director but didn't tell me - so when the director was angry - I was at a loss as to why she sent an email and included extra non-Aboriginal leaders asking for their opinion about 'the leader' in the room and her ability to control. The leader was me. I called the director the next day and told her I didn't appreciate her inferring I wasn't a good leader - she became angry again and started saying I am not operating at a level 5 and went on with a lot more - following that email the other managers started [to] get angry - one non-Aboriginal manager told me what cultural was and both myself and a cultural consultant were put in our place [to not] say anything - this is a small part of the racism I have faced . (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

This last report and the one that follows refer to the silencing of First Nations voices in the workplace. The report below also identifies other forms of shunning and exclusion in this setting, including as loss of work. Indeed the workplace was the most commonly reported location for shunning/exclusion (15%, Table 8 in Appendix A).

> White collar exclusion from team meetings ... As a contractor to the [named federal government agency/service], my supervisor and reporting line learned of my background. Since the Voice referendum, I have been excluded from all team meetings and input to the function of the team, while other contractors were allowed to participate. In those meetings, the team structures and budgets were decided, ultimately resulting in the termination of my contract. I have viewed the team documents that confirm the push out of my position but will get punished if I leak internal documents. (Self-report, Torres Strait Islander male)

Reports indicate that First Nations employees may be targeted by other employees, but may also witness racism targeting other First Nations people, evidenced in reports above regarding the racist behaviour of health staff towards First Nations patients (see [2.3.3]). Non-Indigenous third party reports also identified incidents witnessed in a workplace setting.

> I work as a psychologist, and I opened a discussion with my clinical supervisor (also a psychologist) about culturally appropriate psychometric measures to use with First Nations clients. My supervisor stated, "don't worry about that, you won't get many of them here". (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> [We] are conducting [an AI program] pilot at our workplace. We have a site to share learnings. One of the pilot participants posted that he asked [the AI program] a question about alcoholism in Indigenous communities and that it wouldn't answer the question (including the screen shots of his prompt and the responses). It is not related to our workplace, or the reasons we are running a 3

> month pilot program to understand how our workplace can utilise AI to improve efficiency. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

School/educational settings were one of the more commonly identified locations for racism reported to the Register (10%, see Figure 6), including reports about university employment such as the following.

> Racism toward me as someone with mixed heritage. Believes in a caste system and treated me as inferior and even questioned my race and cultural authority ... My employer treated me poorly based on my race and spread rumours about my Aboriginal identity to damage my career and reputation as he was in competition with me in academia and worked actively to keep me behind in my career. casualised me and then re-advertised my position despite high performance and student satisfaction and research outputs. Excluded me from important cultural and social and research events where I continue to take a lead. Made jokes about my private life and continued to harass me in the roles I took on in other organisations. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

As a further example, one First Nations woman reported starting work at a university in a professorial and managerial position, successfully bringing in grant monies and staff and working collaboratively with colleagues. She was told to surrender some of her funding as the university was 'in trouble' and was also prevented from backfilling a staff position. Other events followed.

> I then started to notice that each time I organised a meeting with a senior bureaucrat that my EA had notified senior people who arranged for particular white folk or staff to turn up to my meetings without my knowledge. I do not understand why. I travelled interstate to attend a meeting with the Premier's chief of staff to discuss curriculum for First Nations Youth in Detention. I was asked by my supervisor why he had not been included. I told him he had not been invited. He then notified me that he believed I was not there for University work when [he] knew I was. After taking my funding and policing my movements I realised that I was being discriminated against. He had arranged meetings with my staff (all white) without my knowledge. I thought up until then that I had enjoyed a good working relationship with all my staff and am an experienced manager and know that staff are my most important asset. Sadly, my boss had convinced them to turn on me. Comments were made about the inadequacies of local Aboriginal people (compared to those in traditional communities) which made it clear that Eastern side Aboriginal people are not as 'real' as those in traditional communities. I found that confronting. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

### 2.4.4 Criminal legal system

The Register received multiple reports this year about racism within the criminal legal system. Racism occurring in a '"justice"/legal setting (e.g. policing, court or prison)' accounted for 6% of all reports made to the Register in 2024-25 (see Figure 6 above and Table 6 in Appendix A).[24] Incidents occurring in a legal setting are discussed in other sections of the report (for example, [2.3.3]) and as they relate to young people, at [4.3].

A particular focus this year is on incidents involving police responses to First Nations peoples as victims of crime. A self-report received from an Aboriginal man who was a victim of an assault recounted one such incident, describing police failure to investigate the crime in question.

> I am 66 years of age, as is my cousin. We were attacked in public hotel by an intoxicated person (non-Indigenous stranger); security asked *us* to leave. We asked them to call the police; we asked police to check cameras of the incident. There has been no follow up of the incident despite us asking for the camera to be checked and that we wanted to press charges. The police were very dismissive, and we felt we were stereotyped as being the "Aboriginal problem". Rang to request incident event number the next day, text to me 2 days after. I again asked if the cameras had been checked, no response or contact has been made to me. I had bruising on both arms and my leg where the intoxicated person man handled me and pushed me. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

This incident, including failure to investigate, clearly resulted in both physical and psychological harm, and created another layer of victimisation. The victim already had issues with policing in his local area and now has lost all confidence in police (see also below at [3.2]).

> Depressed, and sore and bruised where I was manhandled. I'm extra cautious of my surroundings … Local police often harass and over police Aboriginal people in my locale, I have lost all confidence in them. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

A further report was made by a First Nations victim of a serious assault by an intoxicated non-Indigenous male on a licenced premises, leading to the loss of his front teeth. His report addressed police failure to investigate the assault, with police refusing to differentiate between victim and perpetrator. Systemic racial bias and presumption of guilt were evident in his report.

[24] While only two percentage points higher compared to 2023-24, the actual number of reports indicating racism in a legal setting almost doubled – increasing from 23/573 (or 4%) in 2023-24 to 45/703 (or 6%) in 2024-25.

> A white man was racially taunting a [European] man and made a derogatory remark about black people knowing I would hear it. I stepped in and said "There's no need for racist remarks" to which the white man suddenly and unexpectedly hit me in the mouth loosening my four front teeth. The security officer called the police. When the police arrived the white man and I were both fined for violence in a licensed premises and public nuisance. I informed the police that I had been the victim and to check the CCTV footage as I had not touched the man at all. The police refused to check the footage or investigate further. I am now taking the matter to court. The police automatically assumed I must have instigated the incident or retaliated. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

The immediate assumption made by police – that the victim was in fact the instigator – demonstrates clearly the stereotype that First Nations people are inherently violent or confrontational, subsequently resulting in the victim being criminalised. He further described how the incident has impacted him both physically and financially.

> I have seen the dentist who cannot save my front teeth and I am wearing the cost of dentures now and legal fees to go to court. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

One detailed report provided by an Aboriginal woman, which may be difficult to read, provides essential insight into how racism and police practices still cause harm for First Nations people. The detailed incident describes the use of excessive force on a young child by a security guard and police at a shopping centre. The woman filmed the incident, highlighting her resilience and advocacy to hold police and security accountable for their actions towards a young child in a public place.

> This morning at [the] shopping centre there was a security guard abusing a 9 year old child. The main female abuser who was assaulting the child, did not have her badge number displayed and refused to show identification. They did not like [that] I was filming. Every living man/woman has the duty to help their fellow humans and has a right to film a crime happening. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Her action of filming the incident subsequently led to the attention of police and she was arrested. She shared further the trauma she experienced of her arrest and in police custody of physical harm and verbal abuse.

> When 6ft police officer came. He also assaulted the child. The child was crying and he was twisting his arm. The child was screaming and asking him to stop. The officer stated he did not consent to being filmed and was extremely intimidating. He then went on a crazy tirade of abuse and stated I was trespassing and he would sort me out. He would have me banned and then forcefully removed my phone from me stating he was taking it for evidence and then he said I was under arrest and then bent my arm back and took me to the police beat. He then continued his

> abuse and yelling, stating things like, he was going to make my life hell and he would be taking me to court to make me pay. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

She further recounts police failure to follow protocol when First Nations people are in custody and describes institutional neglect of duty of care, failure to appropriately respond to medical needs, and dehumanising police practices of invasive searching and physical harm.

> I have complex PTSD and I had a panic attack and asthma attack [in custody]. [Police officer] refused to call an ambulance. I threw up whilst laying on the floor where he then kicked me and said stop being aggressive. His female colleague then came who searched me and my belongings and laughed and joked about woman going through DV and PTSD. And woman being murdered. They did call an ambulance. I asked the officers to write their names down and they refused. I asked them to call the officer in charge as I did not feel safe. They refused. I asked them to call the Aboriginal liaison officer and they refused. They then said they weren't waiting for the ambulance and were taking me to the watch house. They assaulted me again, hitting my arm and pushing me into the van. The female officer searched me in front of male officers. She put her hand inside my bra and underpants. They turned the air conditioning off and laughed when I said I couldn't breathe. And they joked that maybe I will die. They did not take me to the watch house. The left me in the van for what felt like 15-20 minutes. When the ambulance arrived, I was dehydrated as the police refused to give me water and I had a very high temperature as well as very high heart rate. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

This same woman describes what happened when she made a complaint about the incident.

> I still have zero help with this racist cop and police are ignoring my complaints as usual. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Another report by an Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander man identified systemic racial bias cycling across generations as well as the psychological impact and the provocation for his family of over-policing when responding to minor matters.

> Living in a small community there is always a risk of running into the police. My wife was chased in our car and pulled over; the police thought it was me. Because I had no licence, she took the car to work. They question her about me? Five police officers came to my house to talk to my son about trafficking a couple of grams of pot. 5 of them just to talk to him. Talk about provocation. Made my stomach churn, felt distressed. (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander male)

Another non-Indigenous witness report addressed racism where police extinguished ceremonial fire and removed tools at Camp Sovereignty. Police actions, from the witness account, were culturally insensitive in misunderstanding the importance of the camp and disregarding cultural protocols attached to sacred practices. The report again captures the systemic actions of racism and bias in law enforcement. [25]

> I first heard of this matter when I attended a public hearing at the Federal Court between an Indigenous activist and the State over claims that a sacred fire in Kings Domain, where Indigenous activists gather as part of 'Camp Sovereignty', had been extinguished. The police had supposedly entered Camp Sovereignty and extinguished the fire, whilst also confiscating numerous fire tools from the site. These items were allegedly returned, however the principal of the matter demonstrates the misunderstanding and inherent bias by the police and the state of Aboriginal culture and the value they place on sacred fires such as this. As the fire is a symbol for a continuing fight against ending genocide, acknowledging sovereignty and a securing a treaty. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

A non-Indigenous witness reported racism at a regional swimming pool – where police actions were influenced by stereotypes, causing the misuse of police powers. Police were called to the pool because of the behaviour of a few children. Instead of the pool staff addressing the specific behaviour of the individual children, police proceeded to remove all Aboriginal children.

> Staff called police because a couple of kids were playing 'unsafe' and were 'rude' to staff. Police forced all Aboriginal people, around 20 and mostly kids, to leave the pool, including by serving move on orders. The remaining White children were not asked to leave or removed. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Of critical importance, according to the witness report, these actions reproduce similar patterns of exclusion – reminding the families connected to this incident that the historical denial of access to public spaces persists and how past exclusions via racist laws are reproduced in present-day police practices.

[25] See media release from Senator Malarndirri McCarthy calling out the recent racist attacks on Camp Sovereignty (in 2025) during the anti-immigration rallies around the country and claims that police did not do enough to protect Aboriginal people: <https://ministers.pmc.gov.au/mccarthy/2025/senate-statement-camp-sovereignty>.

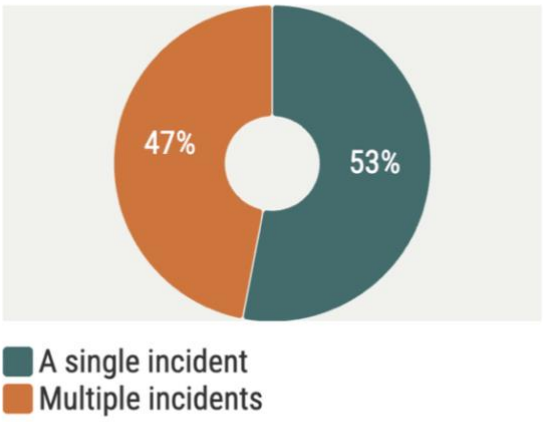
## 2.5 When the racism was experienced or witnessed

### 2.5.1 Single and multiple incidents of racism

Reports to Call It Out often contain multiple incidents of racism experienced or witnessed by the same person – sometimes occurring over many years and across generations. This means that the overall number of reports we identify as having been made to Call It Out are a significant undercount of incidents reported.

This new optional question was answered by most respondents (369/442 or 83%). Of these 369 respondents, just under half indicated that their report included multiple incidents of racism (172/369 or 47%), with the remainder being single incidents (see Figure 7 and Table 9 in Appendix A). Perhaps not surprisingly, First Nations people experiencing racism directly were more likely to report multiple incidents of racism (54%) compared to friends/relatives (44%) and witnesses (43%) (see Table 9 in Appendix A).

**Figure 7 Single and multiple incidents of racism**




Source: Table 9 Single and multiple incidents by who reported the racism

As an example of how people responded to this question, one First Nations woman identified that she was reporting 'multiple incidents' in sport, beginning with the following.

> The Caucasian team manager said so you are a half caste and where do you get your colour from one parent or both. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

She then reports being turned down for a managerial position with her sports team.

> I had a call on the following Monday and was told they made a mistake as League Manager is a paid position and said they will be doing that role and I won't be required. I said I was happy to give back and support women in sport and was not doing it for the money and was happy to volunteer. I told now operations manager about incident but nothing happened she kept her role and I was let go. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

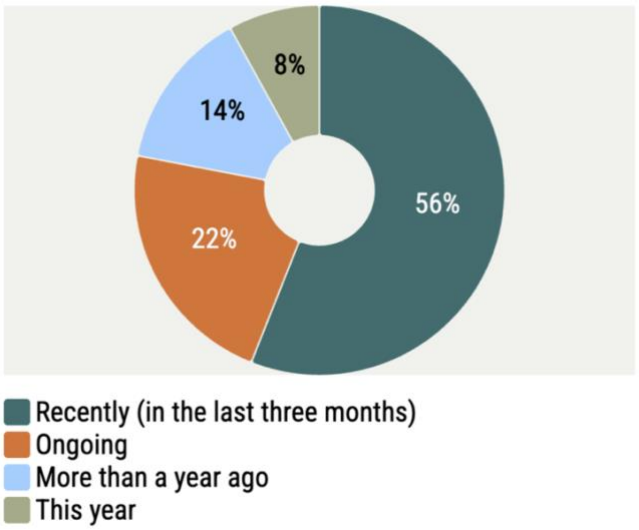
She goes on to state that this is just one incident among many, including others related to education, and describes the repercussions for her children following the above incidents directed at her (see further discussion at [4.5]).

### 2.5.2 When the racism happened

Those completing the Register were also asked to indicate when the incident happened, including whether it was 'ongoing'. This optional question was answered by 79% of all respondents (or 348/442, see Table 10 in Appendix A).

As shown in Figure 8, more than half of all reported incidents occurred 'recently (in the last three months)' (56%). Almost a quarter of incidents were identified as occurring on an ongoing basis (22%). All three groups reporting to the Register were proportionately more likely to identify recent incidents. Friend/relative reports and self-reports were proportionately more likely to identify ongoing racism (33% and 27%, respectively) compared to witness reports (18%). (See Table 10 in Appendix A).

**Figure 8 When the racism happened**




Source: Table 10 When the racism happened by who reported the incident

Further analysis of reports of ongoing racism indicates the following.

- Social media or online incidents were most frequently nominated as the location for ongoing racism (23%), followed by school/educational setting (12%), the workplace (11%) and public setting (10%) (see Table 11 in Appendix A).
- The types of racism most frequently nominated as ongoing were negative attitudes or stereotyping (25%), followed by verbal abuse or hate speech (16%), discriminatory laws, policies and practices and not recognising cultural rights (both 14%), and bullying, threats or intimidation (13%) (see Table 12 in Appendix A). We note that in combination, aggressive racism constitutes 35% of all ongoing racism (see also [2.3.2] above).

### 2.5.3 Incidence of racism – general comments

As we have consistently recorded in previous Call It Out reporting, racism targeting First Nations people is entrenched, endemic and hard to accurately capture statistically - though the Register questions about whether incidents are ongoing or reported as multiple or single incidents go some way to doing this.

We again see reports of single incidents with multiple layers and multiple incidents occurring in different locations.

> I've experienced racism on a daily basis going to a shop or school or getting my hair cut to doing shopping or speaking on phone to Centrelink. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> So, I was walking home … when a guy [drove] past and called me a monkey and other forms of obscenities … I [also] experienced racism about 4 months ago, in [a convenience store] where a [South Asian] guy refused me service even though I had money, but yet? Still refused me service & he only served white people but not people like me who have dark skin. Not only that but this has been an ongoing problem on different occasions, where I experienced racism that includes when I … went for a job interview with the army the guy was being very prejudiced and racist, it also includes in the gyms I go to, & when I go to the shops, or walking on the street minding my own business. It has gotten out of control now where something has to be done! (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

Racism was identified in the Register as tied to history too - again in keeping with previous annual reporting. Reports referencing intergenerational experiences of racism or harmful government policy or stereotyping drawing from the past into the present day are examples. Examples include the incident involving the taxi driver using the term 'natives', references to 'half-castes', how exclusion of young Aboriginal people from a public pool brings up similar past exclusion and the following reports.

> The ongoing colonial loading of a westernised Government workplace is a reminder that daily experiences of racism is an essential [criterion] within your identified … role. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I was in our local [named supermarket chain] yesterday with a gift card, and the employer asked me if it was a Mission Card … I am very angry. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Also demonstrating the multiple layers of discrimination experienced by First Nations people, some reports to the Register identify intersectionality between race and other bases for unequal treatment. One First Nations person reported the following statement '"never met a gay Aboriginal before"' and their response to this comment as 'CUZ GO EDUCATE YOURSELF' (self-report, Aboriginal).

As another example, a First Nations person reported various grounds of discrimination in their employment at a university.

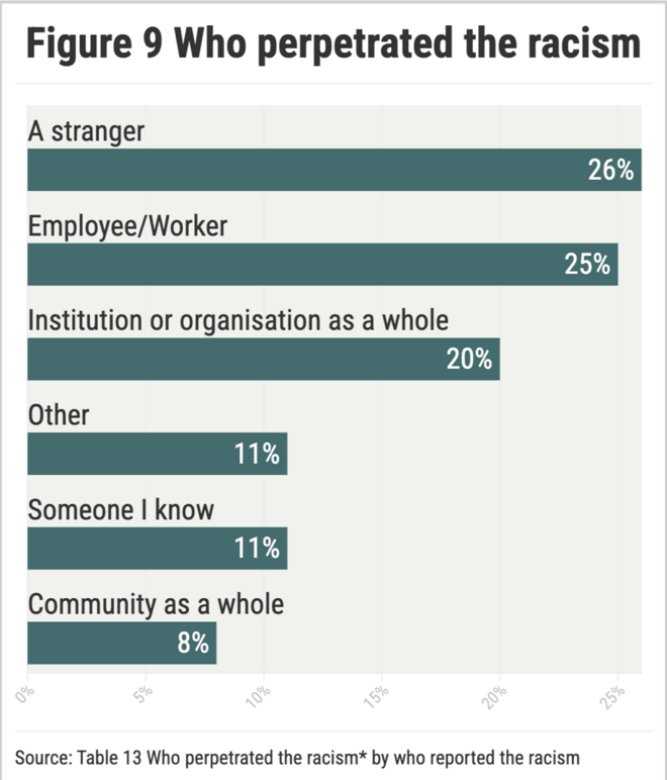
> When I commenced a new role in the university sector, I was treated with prejudice based on my mixed race heritage and my appearance, in the Indigenous space. I was bullied, harassed, and intimidated even in my own home after I left the role after HR got involved, because another Indigenous employee (from a country other than Australia) was a neighbour, and bullied me and intimidated me at work and in my own home. I was also subject to homophobia and political

discrimination for my role in a referendum campaign calling for a First Nations constitutional voice. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

The broad range of perpetrators reported to the Register, to which we turn now, also evidences the multiple levels and contexts in which racism arises for First Nations people.

## 2.6 Perpetrators of racism

Those completing the Register were asked to nominate the type of perpetrator of the racism reported from 6 different options. This was a compulsory question and notably, multiple responses were made by 113 individuals (n=625, see Table 13 in Appendix A).




As Figure 9 shows, the two most commonly identified perpetrators were 'a stranger' (26%) and 'employee/worker' (25%).[26] The third most commonly identified perpetrator was 'institution or organisation as a whole' (20%).[27] (See also Table 13 in Appendix A).[28]

Witnesses most frequently identified the perpetrator as a stranger, and this is likely, as noted above at [2.4.1], because witnesses more frequently reported racism on social media/online – with perpetrators described, for instance as 'just a faceless person online' (self-report, Aboriginal female). All groups reported 'institutions and organisations as a whole' as a perpetrator at a similar frequency. (See Table 13 in Appendix A).

Notably, First Nations people directly experiencing racism and friends/relatives were much more likely than witnesses, comparatively, to identify the perpetrator as an employee/worker (by a difference of 12 and 13 percentage points, respectively) or as

[26] These statistics are similar to those reported in our 2023-24 Annual Report.
[27] Note that 'employee/worker' does not describe only incidents related to the workplace. It could mean an employee perpetrating racism to a First Nations customer in a store, for instance.
[28] Responses identifying the perpetrator of racism as 'someone I know' and 'community as a whole' equated to 11% and 8%, respectively.

someone they know (by a difference of 9 and 12 percentage points, respectively). (See Table 13 in Appendix A).

In terms of 'known' perpetrators, these included neighbours and partners. One First Nations woman reported, 'Having issues with an ex who is Māori decent and is using degrading language in regards to my nationality.'

> My next door neighbour is racist. I'm trying to move out with housing. Its daily racism. Calls me a 'black Indigenous dog'. Called me a 'Muslim dog'. I want to report this person, and I will not stop because she has abused me for the last eight months. Calls me 'black'. (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander female)

Family members were also identified.

> Family member talked about break in at a dwelling where property was damaged and assumed was an Aboriginal person or persons. Proceeded to cast out a million negative stereotypes about Aboriginal people. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> As a white person, I constantly hear racial stereotypes against First Nations Peoples from certain parts of my family all of the time. One of the most recent experiences is about Aboriginal People in [named town, NT]. Certain family members said things like, "they honestly need to be controlled", and "they're like wild animals", alongside some pretty nasty racial insults and slurs. This is such a disgustingly common experience, and it appals me that people feel safe enough to just casually say things like that. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> My grandfather started talking about Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples in a very stereotypical way, using derogatory language such as half-cast, black-fella, Abo and Aborigine, complaining about them. It made me feel physically ill. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

An Aboriginal and Pacific Islander woman reporting racism at a predominantly Pacific Islander school, discussed further at [4.2], spoke of experiencing racism from family members as follows.

> ... as an Indigenous person on my own country...to hear my own people speak down on my other people...I felt so unwanted. I felt so alone. I really always have as a Half Aboriginal Tongan girl. Even in my own family. There have been too many racist moments growing up involving my racist Tongan side. They really always have hated my mum for being a Blak woman. Always treated her like she's worthless because of it. I'm so tired of it. When will we be seen as human beings? (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

As a further example of known perpetrators, one First Nations woman reported a member of her church congregation.

> A member of the parish council of our local church approached myself and my family on several occasions during the lead up to the Referendum. This person made continuous remarks and voiced her opinions about how she felt that the Referendum should not be passed. She wanted my/our opinions a wanted to share her thoughts. I tried to share that my family are from stolen generations and therefore the subject is sensitive. This lady continued and persisted in a barrage of comments such as:
>
> "But white babies were stolen too, why should Aboriginal people be treated any differently".
>
> "If black kids commit crimes they should be in jail".
>
> "Aboriginal people are after money".
>
> "Aboriginal people should stay doing what they are good at and wear the Australian colours in sport".
>
> I asked her to stop and she moved to my husband and started on him with the same. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The significant size and scope of the problem that is racism is again revealed this year by the range of perpetrators reported to the Register, including across different genders, social groups and various ethnicities. A relatively high proportion of responses identified multiple perpetrators, including for single incidents. One witness described perpetrators of an online/media incident related to a hit and run of a young First Nations woman as multi-layered, as but one example.

> Media: Misidentifying a hit and run victim as a 'crash' victim by mainstream media, [named newspaper, QLD] on Facebook. Factually incorrect and implies the victim was involved/to blame somehow. Police: Apparent failure to properly investigate by police. No surprises there. General public: Many responded to the post with laughing emojis. Inciting one person to respond 'why are people laughing at this. shame on you'. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

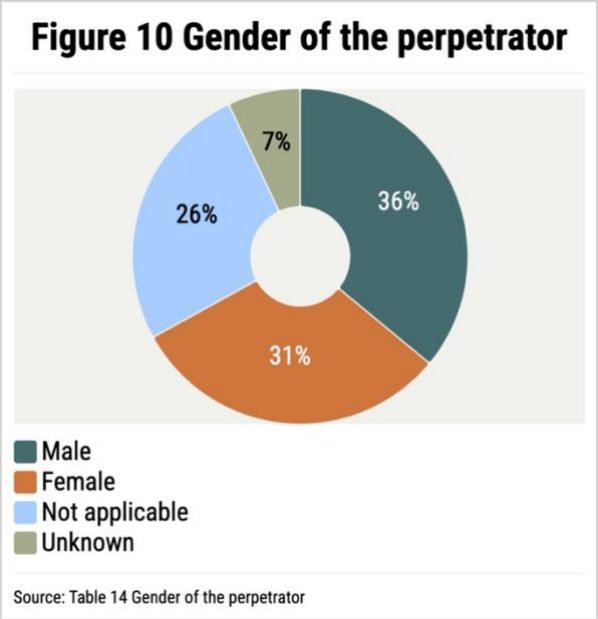
Similarly, perpetrators involved in excluding First Nations children from the NSW pool were identified as ‘Pool staff, police and non-Indigenous bystanders who said nothing, did nothing’ (witness report, non-Indigenous).

### 2.6.1 Gender of the perpetrator

Those completing the Register were asked to identify the gender of the perpetrator, with 318 people (72%) completing this optional question.

Figure 10 below shows a slight difference in the gender of identified perpetrators. Males constituted 36% of perpetrators and females constituted 31% (a difference of five

percentage points). By comparison, in 2023-24 there was a more notable difference between male perpetrators (42%) and female perpetrators (30%) (a difference of 12 percentage points). (See also Table 14 in Appendix A).



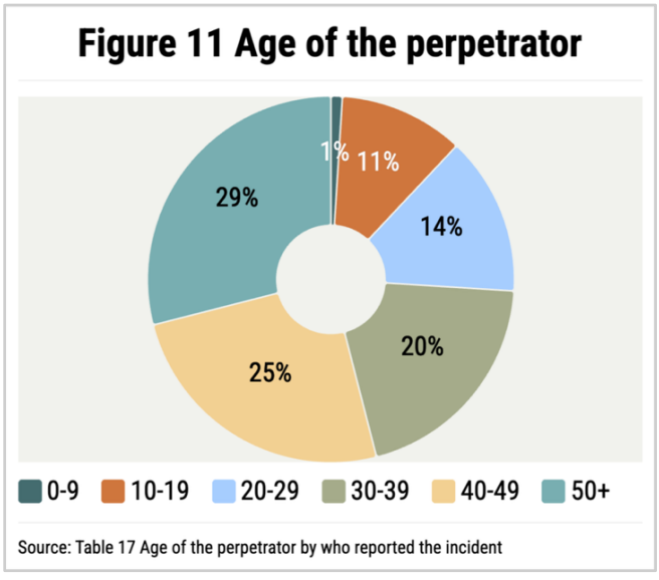

In 26% of cases gender was 'not applicable' (for example, where the perpetrator was an organisation or a group of people).[29] In a further 7% of cases, the gender was 'unknown' (for example, an unidentified individual on social media/online). One further report identified the gender of the perpetrator as non-binary.

There appears to be little difference in the type of racism perpetrated by either males or females, with negative attitudes and stereotyping, verbal abuse or hate speech and bullying and threats or intimidation prevalent for both male and female perpetrators (see Table 15 in Appendix A).[30]

However, there were some notable differences in relation to the type of perpetrators by gender. Comparatively, male perpetrators were more likely to be a stranger, while female perpetrators were more likely to be an employee/worker (see Table 16 in Appendix A).

### 2.6.2 Age of the perpetrator

Those completing the Register in 2024-25 were also asked to identify the age of the perpetrator, with 315 people (71%) completing this new optional question. Of those 315 respondents, some 140 people (44%) indicated that the victim's age was either 'unknown' or 'not applicable (for example, an organisation or group of people)'. Thus, 175 individuals identified an age group for




[29] This represents a 10 percentage points *increase* in cases where the gender was not applicable and a four percentage points *decrease* in cases where the gender was unknown, compared with 2023-24.

[30] There were some minor differences (by three percentage points or less), in relation to the type of racism by gender. Female perpetrators were more likely to shun or exclude, while males were more likely to perpetrate physical harm, property damage and discriminate via laws, policies and practices. (See Table 15 in Appendix A).

the perpetrator (see Table 17 in Appendix A).

Figure 11 above shows that, of these 175 respondents, more than half (54%) reported that the perpetrator was an adult aged 40 or over. More than a quarter (20%) of perpetrators were in the 30-39 age group, followed by 20-29 (14%) and 0-19 (12%). (See also Table 17 in Appendix A).

Some reported that older generations were especially racist. For example,

> My grandfather is not a First Nations Person. He is of Scottish/Australian heritage. He is in the baby boomer/silent generation (born 1944), so he inherited racist attitudes/sentiments from his family/societal norms. He was stereotyping First Nations Peoples as a whole. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> [Perpetrator was] just an old white man like most old white men who are racist because of Australia being a racist country. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

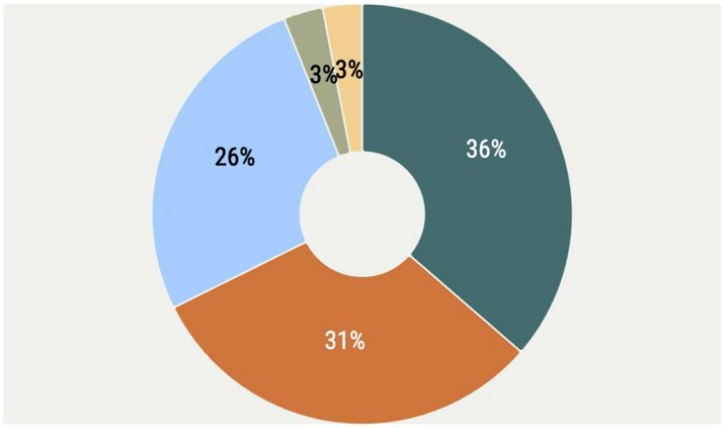
We note, however, that although children and young people (0-19 age group) were the least frequently reported age group for perpetrators (12%), young people *clearly* perpetrate racism too, and this is discussed further in [4.2] with some focus on education and social media as sites of racism. The most common type of racism for perpetrators aged 0-19 was verbal abuse/hate speech (33%) followed by racist attitudes/stereotypes (27%). Across all other perpetrator age groups, the most common type of racism was racist attitudes/stereotypes. (See Table 18 in Appendix A).

## 2.7 The victim of the incident

### 2.7.1 Gender of the victim

Those completing the Register were asked whether the victim of the racism was male, female, non-binary, or if the gender of the victim was 'not applicable (e.g. a group of people)' or 'unknown' (for example, an unidentified individual on social media/online). The question was completed by 322 respondents (see Table 19 in Appendix A).

**Figure 12 Gender of the victim**




Source: Table 19 Gender of the victim

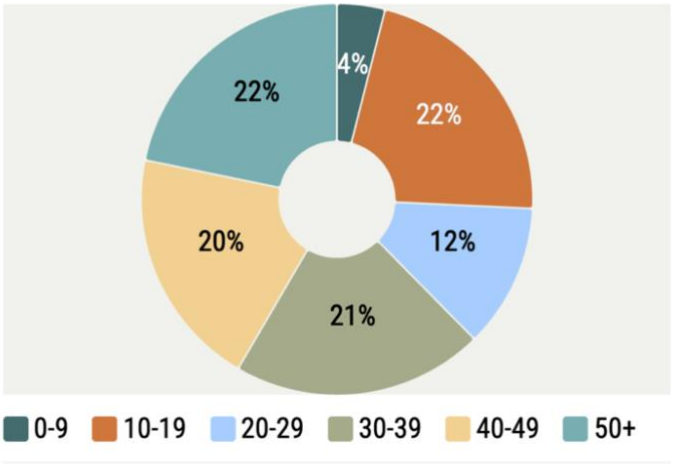
Figure 12 shows that more than a third of victims were identified as female (36%), and slightly

over a quarter as male (26%).[31] A significant proportion of respondents identified the gender of the victim as 'not applicable' (31%). The 'not applicable' category could arise, for example, with racist comments in social or mainstream media that target and impact First Nations people as a group. (See also Table 19 in Appendix A).

### 2.7.2 Age of the victim

More than two thirds of people filling in the Register answered the optional question on the age of the victim (319/442 or 72%). Of those 319 respondents, some 115 people (36%) indicated that the victim's age was either 'unknown' or 'not applicable'. Thus, 204 individuals identified an age group for the victim (see Table 20 in Appendix A). The reason for the large proportion of 'unknown' or 'not applicable' responses was likely the same as above for gender.

**Figure 13 Age of the victim**




Source: Table 20 Age of the victim by who reported the incident

Figure 13 shows that, of these 204 respondents, almost half (42%) reported that the person subjected to the racism was aged 40 or over.[32]

Notably, in 2024-25 more than a quarter of reported incidents (26%) targeted children and young people in the 0-19 age group. This represents an increase of 10 percentage points compared with 2023-24.[33] (See Table 20 in Appendix A).

We also examined the age group of the victim by the **type** of racism experienced or witnessed. There was little difference across age groups, with negative attitudes/stereotypes and verbal abuse/hate speech being proportionately the most prevalent type of racism for all ages. However, children and young people (0-19 age group) were subjected somewhat more frequently to bullying, threats or intimidation (5-8 percentage points difference) and physical harm (4-6 percentage points) (see Table 21 in Appendix A).

[31] These statistics are somewhat similar to those reported in our 2023-24 Annual Report.

[32] There were minimal differences in percentages of those subjected to racism in the age groups '50+', '40-49' and '30-39' (1-2 percentage points difference).

[33] Conversely, the proportion of reported victims aged 20-29 decreased by 11 percentage points compared with 2023-24.

In terms of the **location** of the incident:

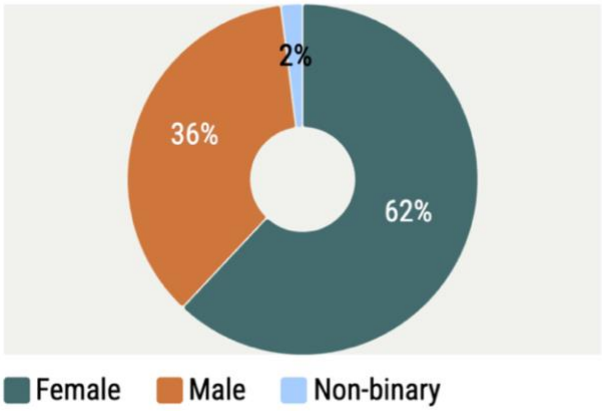
- Children and young people aged 0-19 were identified as proportionately more likely to have experienced racism in a school/educational setting (30%)[34] and in the media/online (31% combined).
- The media/online was also the most common location of racism for victims of racism aged 50 and over (31% combined).
- Those in the 30-39 and 40-49 age brackets were identified as proportionately more likely to experience racism in the workplace (20% and 17%, respectively). (See Table 22 in Appendix A).

There is further discussion of quantitative data related to incidents involving younger victims in [4].

## 2.8 Self-reports of racism by gender

As is the case in previous reports, we look more specifically at the people who self-reported racism to the Call It Out Register and analysed their responses by gender to identify differences in experiences between women and men. Thus, in this section we have omitted from the discussion third party reports of racism by either witnesses, or friends or relatives. The reason for doing this is that it provides for a clearer analysis of direct experiences of racism.

**Figure 14 Gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**




Source: Table 23 Gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism*

Previously in Figure 2 we indicated that 35% of all reports on the Register were self-reported. Here, Figure 14 shows the gender of those who self-reported racism where gender was recorded in 2024-25 (see also Table 23 in Appendix A).

Females registered nearly twice as many self-reported experiences of racism on the Register compared to males (62% compared to 36%), while 2% of those who self-reported identified their gender as non-binary.[35]

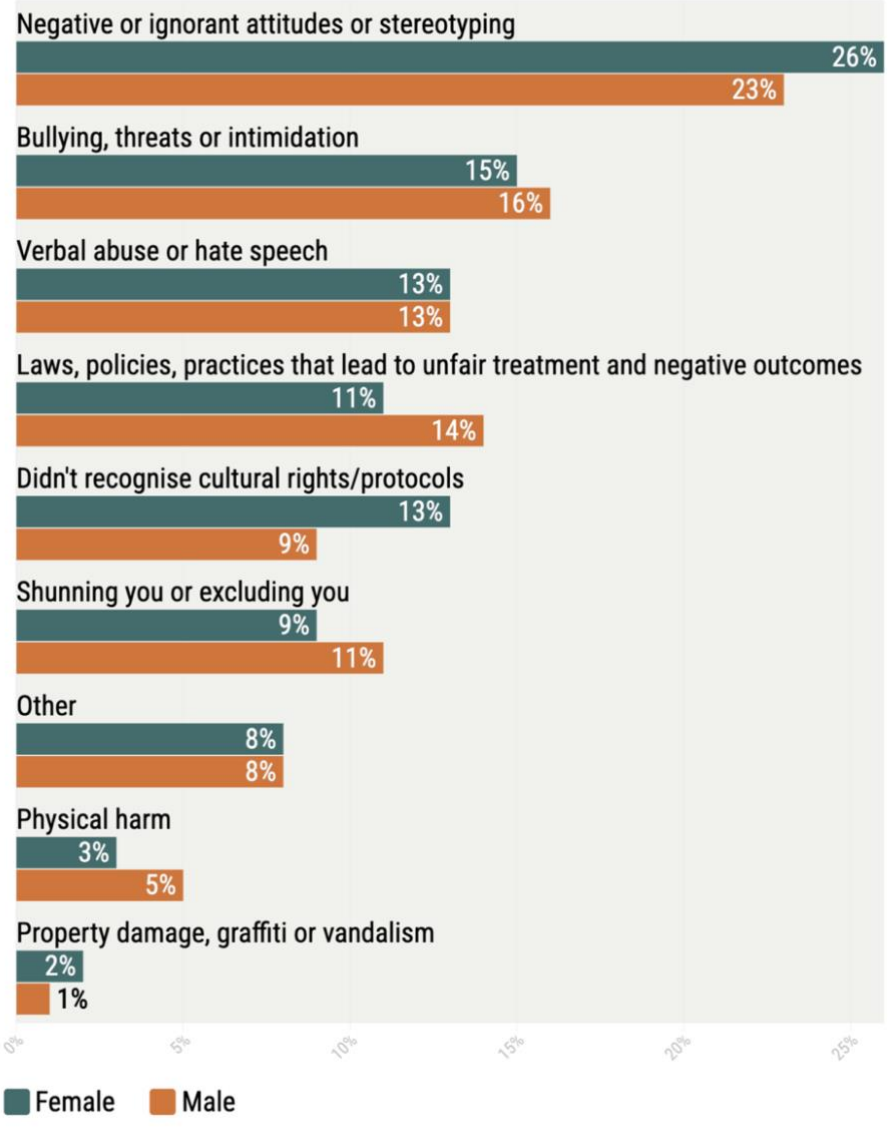
[34] Compared to 13% in 2023-24 (a difference of 17 percentage points).
[35] These statistics were similar to those in our 2023-24 Annual Report where 60% of those who self-reported racism were females.

Figure 15 shows that the two most common types of racism experienced by both genders was negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping and bullying, threats or intimidation (see also Table 24 in Appendix A).

There was little difference in the type of racism experienced by gender (four percentage points or less). Of these, females were proportionately somewhat more likely than males to report lack of recognition for cultural rights/protocols (13% compared to 9%) and negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping (26% compared to 23%).

Males were slightly more likely than females to report discriminatory laws, policies and practices (14% compared to 11%), being shunned or excluded (11% compared to 9%) and physical harm (5% compared to 3%). (See also Table 24 in Appendix A).

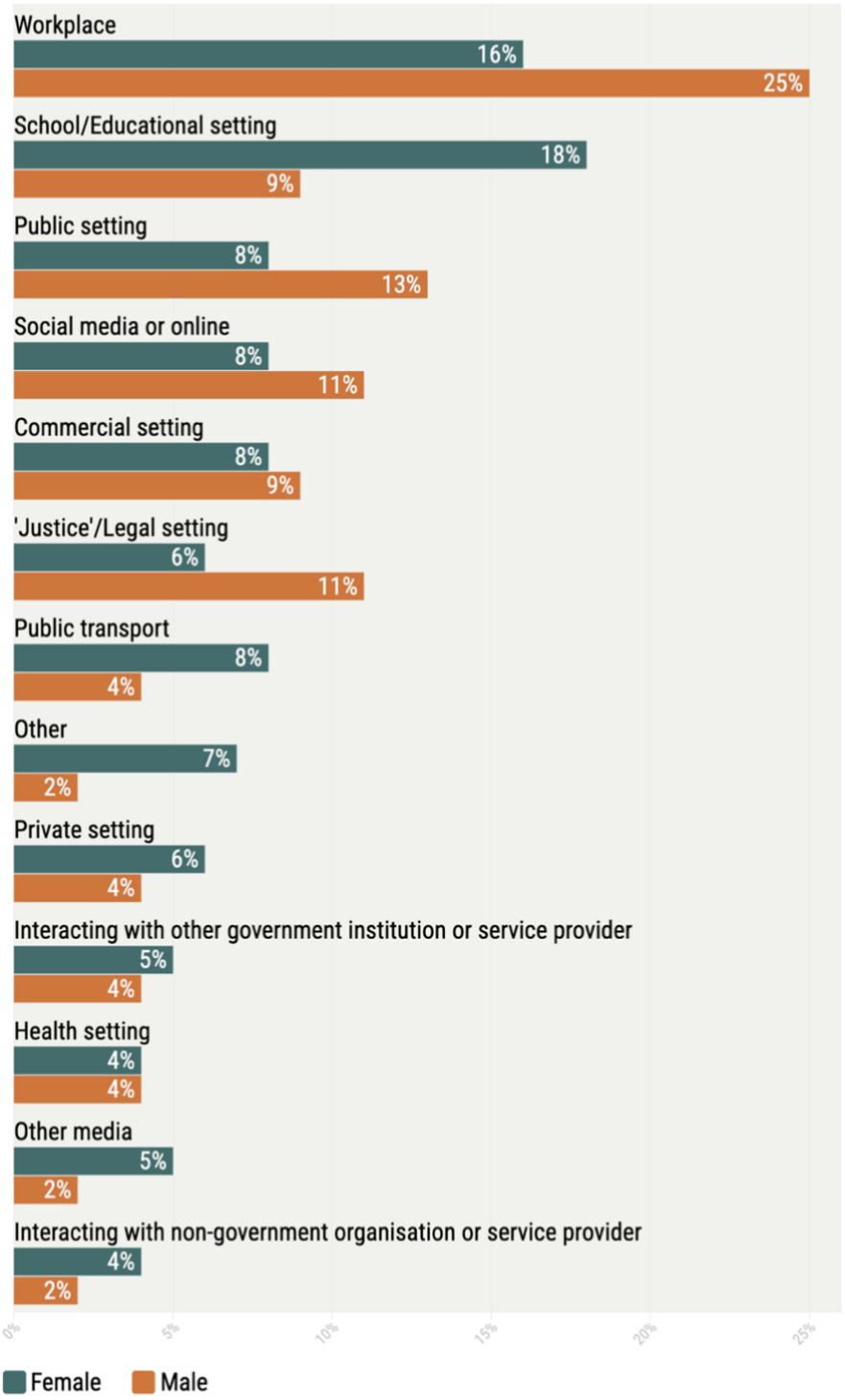
**Figure 15 Type of racism by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**




Source: Table 24 Type of racism* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism

However, there were notable differences in reported locations where racism occurred by the gender of the person experiencing it.

**Figure 16 Location where the racism happened by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**




Source: Table 25 Location where the racism happened* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism

Figure 16 above shows that males were proportionately more likely to self-report racism in the workplace than females (25% compared to 16%). By comparison, in 2023-24 females were proportionately more likely to self-report racism in the workplace than males (26% compared to 18%).

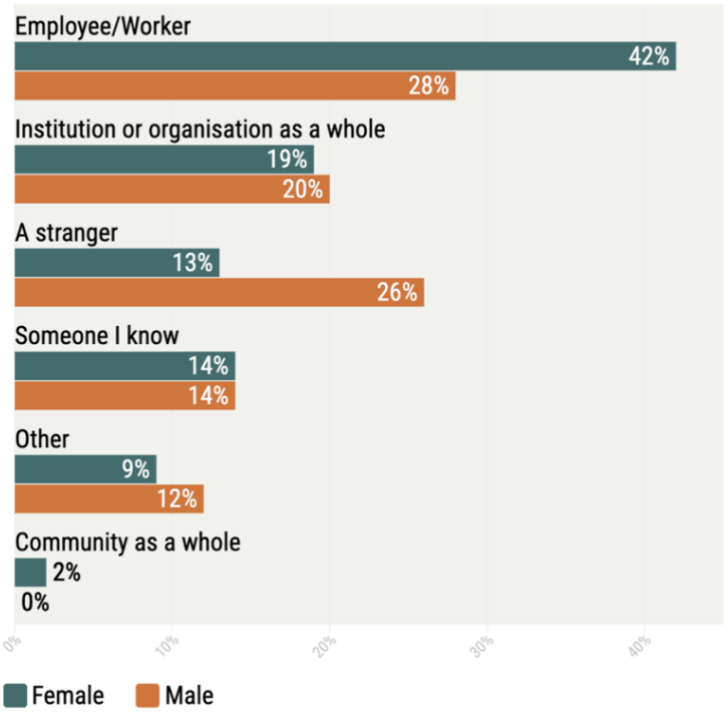
In 2024-25, males were also proportionately more likely than females to report racism in a public setting (13% compared to 8%), in a 'justice'/legal setting (11% compared to 6%)[36] and on social media/online (11% compared to 8%).

Females were proportionately more likely to report racism in a school/educational setting (18% compared to 9%) and on public transport (8% compared to 4%). (See also Table 25 in Appendix A).

We also examined who the perpetrator was for those who self-reported by gender.

Figure 17 shows that females were proportionately more likely than males to identify the perpetrator as being an employee/worker of an institution or organisation (42% compared to 28%).[37] Males were proportionately more likely than females to self-report perpetrators as a stranger (26% compared to 13%).[38]

**Figure 17 Who was the perpetrator by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**




Source: Table 26 Who was the perpetrator* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism

Both males and females were proportionately equally likely to identify the perpetrator as an institution/organisation (20% and 19%, respectively) and someone they know (both 14%). (See also Table 26 in Appendix A).

[36] These statistics are similar to those in our 2023-24 Annual Report where males were more likely to report racism in a public place (17% compared to 10%) and in a police station, courthouse or prison (5% compared to 1%).

[37] By comparison, in 2023-24 there was a 14 percentage points difference in the combined employee/worker perpetrators identified by gender (with males proportionately more likely than females to identify the perpetrator as an employee of an organisation or institution (64% compared to 49%). Note the range of multiple choice options were different in 2023-24.

[38] In 2023-24, females were more likely to identify the perpetrator as a member of the public unknown to them than males (19% compared to 14%).

# 3. Responses to Racism

Questions on the Call It Out Register asked how the person reporting racism felt about it, identifying its emotional impacts, and whether and how they responded or took action in response to racism. Sharing of perspectives on more effective responses to racism were also invited.

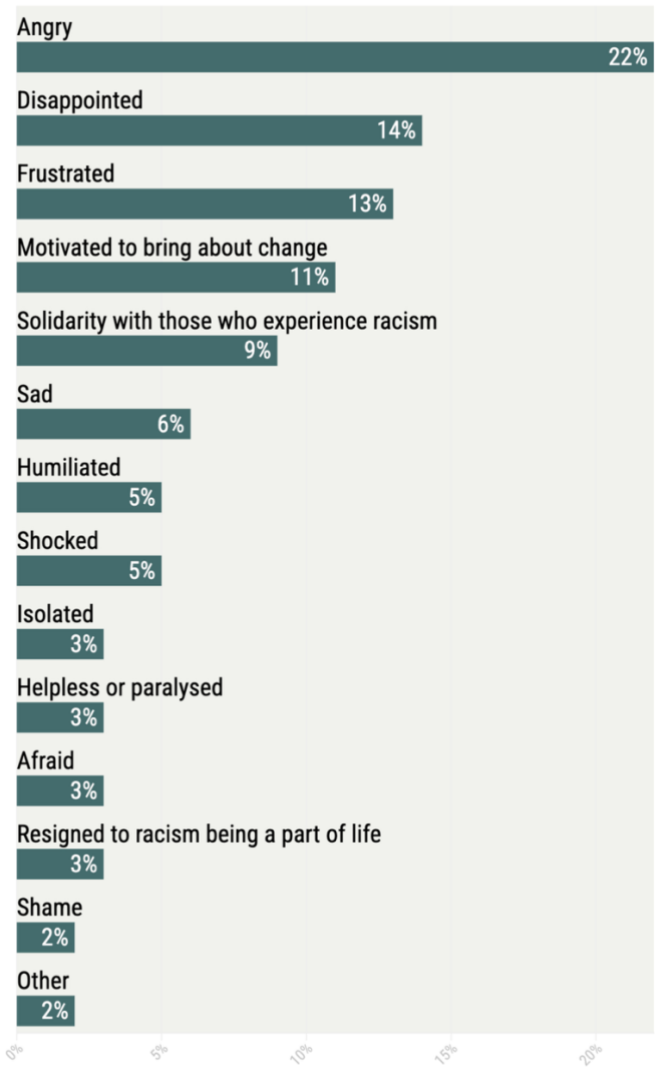
## 3.1 Impacts of racism

Those completing the Register were asked to nominate how they felt about the incident reported from a range of 14 options. In 2024-25, a maximum of three responses could be nominated for this question.[39] Some 314 (71%) of the 442 people completing the Register chose to answer this question. The majority of this group (272) indicated multiple responses (n=832, see Table 27 in Appendix A).

As shown in Figure 18, the most common feeling identified by all groups was anger (22%), followed by disappointment (14%), frustration (13%) and motivation to bring about change (11%).[40] (See also Table 27 in Appendix A).

Perhaps unsurprisingly, those who self-reported and friends/relatives were proportionately more likely to feel humiliation (11% and 8%,

**Figure 18 Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed**




Source: Table 27 Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident

[39] In previous years there was no restriction on the number of responses an individual could identify in response to this question. A limit of up to 3 answers was introduced in 2024-25 to understand/identify the key responses to racism for those who reported experiencing and witnessing racism, as well as any differences in responses between groups.

[40] Compared to 2023-24, those reporting racism in 2024-25 were slightly more likely to feel angry and disappointed (a difference of two to three percentage points only) and somewhat less likely to feel sad (a difference of five percentage points). Note feeling 'frustrated' was not an available response option in previous reporting.

respectively) and isolation (8% and 3%, respectively) than witnesses (see Table 27 in Appendix A).

Anger, frustration and disappointment (49% combined, see Figure 18) were also the most common emotional impacts across age categories (46% combined, see Table 28 in Appendix A).[41] Just under a fifth of responses identified feeling motivated to bring about change and/or solidarity with those who experience racism (16% combined, see Table 28 in Appendix A).

Notably too, sadness was a relatively common response for incidents of racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group) (13%), while motivation to bring about change was more frequently identified in response to incidents against those in the 50+ age group (15%) (see Table 28 in Appendix A). See also discussion of children and young people at [4.4].

### 3.1.1 Emotional impacts

The experiences recorded on the Register show that a multitude of different emotions are experienced by those targeted by or witnessing racism – and often all at once. As examples, the First Nations person who reported her manager as saying she'd go 'walkabout' felt anger, isolation, sadness and fear.

> I am scared that I will lose my job because the new manager openly hates me. I am now working less to try and avoid her which has caused financial difficulties for me and my family. I am also angry that someone in a position of power and employed in a government role is so openly racist and horrible without concern, sad that things are still so far behind reality, isolated and alone cos I'm the only Aboriginal employee in the team. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The First Nations person who encountered and challenged racism during a beauty treatment also reported a range of emotions.

> It made me feel all sorts of feelings, even guilty for not being able to change his perspective. Hopeless that even nice people haven't learnt who we are. It made what should have been a nice self-care experience feel tiring. Made me sad for my grandchildren and worried what they will experience. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

[41] Note the number of available response options changed in 2024-25, increasing from 8 to 11 options. The option 'I didn't believe that anything could be done' has been removed and the following options have been added: 'Other type of complaint or report (e.g. reported directly to the organisation/service, internal HR)'; 'Disengaged (e.g. walked away, took a break from social media)'; 'Other action (e.g. reported to media, wrote a letter)'; and 'Avoided the place/person (e.g. didn't go back to shop/service, left my job/studies)'.

As discussed above, emotions more commonly reported are anger and frustration – including for the First Nations woman encountering racism in a local sauna and those witnessing the fishing competition interview.

> Well unfortunately I am not surprised at all. I have heard it all before too many times over my life. It pissed me off that I can't even go to the local [sauna] ... without hearing this type of bullshit. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> Angry. Empty. Sad for something finally positive for our culture to be tainted and aggressively done. Constantly shame. Always trying to prove ourselves. Very, very angry. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Incidents like the latter that arise online or in the media may lead to emotional responses *across* First Nations communities, including and beyond witnesses reporting it to Call It Out. The two reports below again discuss the fishing competition interview. The first report speaks of racist comments posted online by the public in response to a TikTok video calling this interview out (see also above at [2.4.1]).

> The commenter wasn't just targeting this Indigenous TikTok creator, they were also targeting Indigenous people as a whole as they were stereotyping [them]. I'm trying not to let it negatively affect me too much, but it's so hard, and I know I should be focusing my energy to do good things. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

> This impacts not only the young man from [named town], but 3% of the population in this Country - including Me. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Other emotions described in reports were fear (3%) and concern more broadly, including for First Nations people living in communities openly expressing race-based hatred and hostility on social media. 'I'm worried they are going to try and start a civil war. They are all talking about it' (self-report, Aboriginal female).

Isolation and distrust were also reported, including where nobody steps in to challenge racism - as was the case for the First Nations employee working alongside a racist student nurse. This was also raised by an Aboriginal witness to racism online.

> It made me feel uncomfortable and quite apprehensive to work alongside this person. I was also disappointed that none of my colleagues challenged her. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

> Hurts seeing this all the time and others jump on there [online] and agree but no one goes on there to stand up to him. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Distrust was raised by the First Nations woman assaulted in a public hotel and who received a poor response to the incident from police (above at [2.4.4]). Problematic policing more generally can lead to distrust.

> I'm extra cautious of my surroundings and not confident in police providing any assistance in these types of circumstances. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)
>
> Local police often harass and over-police Aboriginal people in my locale, I have lost all confidence in them. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Shame was experienced by non-Indigenous people witnessing racism, including after witnessing First Nations people being excluded from a bus. 'I am deeply ashamed and so very sorry that these four passengers were treated like this' (witness report, non-Indigenous). As a further example,

> Shame (about my own non-Indigenous people). I was also angry at what a complete idiot this woman was; she was telling someone she thought was Aboriginal to go back to a land they're inherently from. First Nations and non-Indigenous people are working so hard together to create a brighter future and idiots like her can ruin people's day in one fell swoop. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

For First Nations people, shame or humiliation was reported following security guard attention in stores and, as the following comment indicates, during the incident when the older First Nations woman was prevented from sharing a seat on a train platform. This report also describes the exhaustion experienced due to ongoing racism.

> The victim is older, has health conditions and is a very respected member of her community. It's humiliating to be treated with obvious disrespect and distain. It's just that ongoing feeling of exhaustion from the weight of racism. Wears you down. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

Sadness was felt by the First Nations person who was made to feel not 'Blak' enough at work.

> Feeling pretty frustrated at work, impacts professional relationship and makes me feel too "white" to be in an Identified position. I walk around paranoid, everyone is questioning whether I'm Blak or not just because of my skin. I don't like wearing my hair out and want to change it now. After a few weeks of things building I just sit in my car at the end of the day and cry because I feel like I have to prove myself every second of the day. I thought after 30 years I was starting to feel comfortable in my own skin, but not anymore. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

And also, by the First Nations man made to feel invisible while shopping, who again describes the cumulative effect of ongoing racism.

> I felt depressed after that. I know some may think it's a minor thing but that small act made a big impact on me and my mental well-being coz it is not an isolated incident for Blak fullas. We have to deal with this almost daily! (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Related to this sadness and exhaustion are emotional responses of helplessness and despair - sometimes following more immediate responses such as shock or anger. The witness who reported the child protection system identified being 'continually shocked but now sadly not surprised' by the 'widespread racism' in question. 'Completely in despair that it is supposed to be a 'protection' system for our children' (witness report, non-Indigenous).

The witness who described negative audience feedback on an Acknowledgement of Country identified this as having 'contributed to my sense of Australia's social cohesion becoming undermined due to organised hate and disinformation campaigns. I'm losing faith in Australia's capacity and willingness to improve things for us all'. This feeling is more pronounced when there seems to be no remedy for racism. 'I had to accept that I had no recourse for calling out the racism. The choice was to simply ignore it…' (witness report, non-Indigenous).

One First Nations person who left a government job working on Country due to racism reported feeling 'like there's no help for Aboriginal people', as well as thinking about self-harming (self-report, Aboriginal male). Another First Nations person identified racism as a 'silencer' (self-report, Aboriginal female), a point raised earlier in discussion of workplace racism.

For some, being in some sense 'resigned' to racism was a protective response, as was the case for two First Nations people reporting workplace incidents – and again, this occurs in particular where there is a belief that nothing can be done about racism.

> I am so used to this type of behaviour, it is the normal. Sometimes I think just accept it and keep moving on, if I stop and try to address it, it always comes back to bite me and I lose my job and sanity. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)
>
> … now knowing that because it's a government department that has a lot of resources, I can't do anything about it, accept move on and face the fact that things will never change. I've had to deal with this my whole life. Calling it out but the black man has no say! (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

Others spoke of being motivated to bring about change and/or feeling solidarity with those encountering racism. As one First Nations woman states in describing being repeatedly asked to provide proof of purchase at a hardware store (when non-Indigenous people didn't have to do this), 'Ongoing racism towards myself or my people is unacceptable and is not tolerated by me' (self-report, Aboriginal female).

Witnesses also described similar responses. The person who was called an '<n word> lover' for calling out Australia Day to a family member stated that this 'made me angry and even more motivated to speak up against the racism around me, especially in white spaces' (witness report, non-Indigenous). Another stated, 'Will continue to support

Aboriginal people [in my work] to lead solutions to racism and over incarceration as a key manifestation of racism' (friend/relative report, non-Indigenous).

### 3.1.2 Other impacts of racism

Further impacts on socio-economic, cultural and other forms of wellbeing were reported to the Register. The significant physical and psychological health implications of racism were highlighted, in particular. As noted in previous annual reporting, these arise both during and following an incident, including due to poor responses to challenges to racism, and can be long-term in nature. Some of the accounts in [3.1.1] describe significant emotional impacts, including thoughts of self-harm, for instance. As other examples, the first report below relates to a First Nations man being discriminated against while flying (including being removed from a flight, with police attending) and the second to a workplace incident.

> My mental health has taken a big blow and I have been recently diagnosed from this incident as having PTSD. I experience panic attacks near or around airports, flight attendants and planes. I am also terrified of men in uniform (such as police). I've taken time off work as I cannot function. I am teary all the time and cry a lot. I've lost hope in people which I had previously and I cannot trust anymore. My whole world has changed and tilted on its axis and I have no confidence that this will get any better, despite receiving ongoing psychological support. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I am so anxious, feeling like a failure. I don't want to go to work as I have headaches every day and don't sleep well as I always wake up. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

One friend reported another perpetrating racism against his Aboriginal 'mate', calling him 'a petrol sniffer and a dumb abo' and 'discriminating against him because of his race'. '[T]hey make him very sad all the time I'm worried about his mental health' (witness report, non-Indigenous).

Financial impacts were also reported, including for workplace related incidents. Note how these impacts have broader consequences (including not being able to make mortgage and other repayments, according to reports to the Register).

> I ended up struggling to find income after leaving this role and declared bankruptcy [... and had] to seek crucial surgery for my teeth which are still in immense pain. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

> I lost my main source of income and slowly became bankrupt as he continued to bully me and intimidate me and spread racist rumours about me - I had to get a new job in a new state - I became depressed, suicidal and ended up experiencing

> domestic violence as my life began to fall apart. I have only just begun to recover. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)
>
> As a result, my wife blames me for our financial position and wants to leave me. I feel like a failure. My kids wonder why I'm crying all the time. I really thought a black man could make it in the corporate world, but the boys-club who pushed me out are too sneaky and they're going to get away with it without any problems too. (Self-report, Torres Strait Islander male)

Another First Nations man described 'Loss of job, blocked from getting work … [and being] financially bankrupt from not being paid wages' following workplace related incidents. He also identified as impacts 'mental, career, reputation, self-esteem, confidence' (self-report, Aboriginal male). The First Nations woman who called out the racism of a charity (successful in accessing funding by bringing her First Nations-led organisation into a funding application) also identified financial loss, including due to lost business relationships.

> I have suffered severe financial hardship this year as I had said no to other work because of the work I was contracted to [deliver for named charity]. My health has been impacted very badly. Jaw clenching causing intense headaches, depression, loss of interest in usual activities, crying. I had built business relationships for five years and have been isolated from those relationships because of calling out racism. (Self-report, Torres Strait Islander female)
>
> We lost $86k of income for that year. Overall, the opportunity cost to our Indigenous business in this [named charity] Charity Fraud was $645,000 over five years. Had we not joined the … consortium and submitted our own grant application we could have achieved [a] $645,000 grant ourselves as we were the only business in the country [able to offer specialised] training to First Nations and women of colour [to be funded]. (Self-report, Torres Strait Islander female)

Disconnection from important community ties was also reported, including by the First Nations woman targeted by a member of her church congregation.

> My children became targets of subtle and kind of covert singling out to a point where we no longer go to that church community as a direct result of what happened. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Family and friend connections may also be affected, as occurred for the First Nations woman talking about Uluru with her sister.

> Impacted our relationship as I don't know if I want to continue having a relationship with her. My mental health was affected as it left me feeling quite depressed and I felt a lot of grief about my family, my dad and about my connection to my Indigenous background. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Homelessness was a further potential impact of racism identified in reports. One First Nations woman reported racism by her real estate agent but also the courts who (incorrectly) determined that she could not pay her water or rent bills as tenant. This led to a court order for eviction.

> [The court] did not check if I had paid the rent and water bill and they went ahead and posted on the court order that I did not pay [them]. Which the [real estate] staff member must have said in Court. I was told by the manager of [the real estate] she would put to the Sherrif's office that I was to be evicted and it would be in the next days because the owners wanted me out and vacant possession. I know I didn't pay rent and water on time but I know the rent and water bills were paid.

The practical and emotional impacts of this court order are identified as substantial.

> The Court Order broke me. I cried, I was shaking. My head was spinning. I couldn't walk. My blood pressure was over 90 on the reading. I just didn't know what to do. The Courts decision was unfair. I didn't attend the court because I was sick and had difficulty walking. I am afraid of falling down. I have had a brain scan. I have blurred vision as well and can't read small print. The long term impact is that the comment made by the Court will influence all possible applications not to grant to me a rental property. I would be homeless living on the street, 81 years old all my life's collection of items I valued taken by the Sheriffs' [office]. I would lose all my paintings, my computer and other items I valued. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

A further report discussing homelessness as an impact is as follows, and as above, one First Nations person experiencing racist harassment by a neighbour in public housing reports trying to leave her current home.

> Non Aboriginal neighbour of Aunt is racially abusing her and forcing her to leave her public housing unit where she was so happy and safe. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

### 3.1.3 Emotional and other impacts of racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender

We investigated responses to the question about how the incident made the person feel by gender of those who self-reported racism. Of this group, more than half (85/155 or 55%) chose to respond to this optional question, and a majority of these (76/85 or 89%) selected multiple responses (n=231, see Table 29 in Appendix A). In 2024-25, respondents could select up to a maximum of three responses for this question.

For both men and women, the most frequent feelings were anger (21% males and 18% females) and disappointment (13% females and 10% males), followed by humiliation

(12% females and 10% males), frustration (10% males and 9% females), isolation (9% females and 6% males) and sadness (8% males and 7% females) (see Table 29 in Appendix A). Overall, for those who self-reported racism there was very little difference by gender in feelings arising due to experiences of racism.

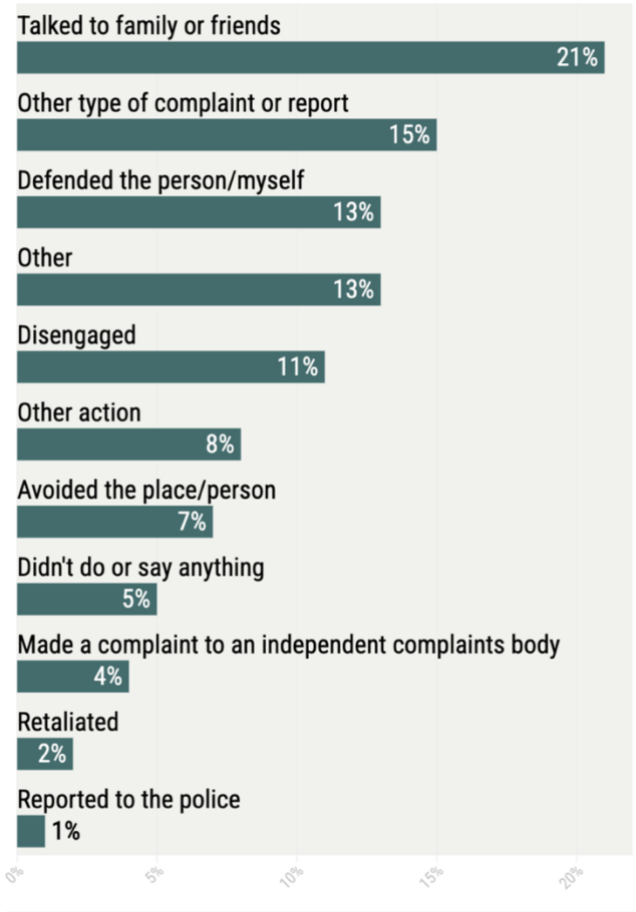
## 3.2 Responding to racism

All individuals completing the Register were asked whether and how they responded to racism from a choice of 11 options.[42] In 2024-25, a maximum of three responses could be nominated for this question.[43]

More than half (287/442 or 65%) of those filling in the Register completed this question, and just over half of those people (156/287 or 54%) provided multiple responses (n=512, see Table 30 in Appendix A).

Figure 19 shows that the most common response to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed was 'talked to family or friends' (21%) (see also Table 30 in Appendix A). This was also the most common response across all victim age groups (see Table 31 in Appendix A).[44]

**Figure 19 Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed**




Source: Table 30 Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident

[42] Note the number of available response options changed in 2024-25, increasing from 8 to 11 options. The option 'I didn't believe that anything could be done' has been removed and the following options have been added: 'Other type of complaint or report (e.g. reported directly to the organisation/service, internal HR)'; 'Disengaged (e.g. walked away, took a break from social media)'; 'Other action (e.g. reported to media, wrote a letter)'; and 'Avoided the place/person (e.g. didn't go back to shop/service, left my job/studies)'.

[43] Previously there was no restriction on the number of responses to this question. A limit of up to 3 answers was introduced in 2024-25 to better understand/identify key responses to racism for those who reported experiencing and witnessing racism, as well as any differences in responses between groups.

[44] These statistics are similar to the 2023-24 Annual Report, where talked with family/friends was similarly the most common response to incidents of racism, both overall and across age groups. Although in 2024-25 the overall response rate for talked to family/friends decreased by 13 percentage points, from 34% in 2023-24 to 21% in 2024-25. However, this decrease is perhaps attributable to the introduction of limitations on the number of responses an individual can select (up to 3) and/or the introduction of three new/additional response options for this question.

The second most common response to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed was 'other type of complaint or report' (15%). (See Table 30 in Appendix A). Responses falling into this category might include reporting directly to a relevant organisation/service (for example, a school) or internal HR. Notably, this response was proportionately highest for incidents of racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group) (20%, by a difference of 6 to 13 percentage points) compared to other age groups (see Table 31 in Appendix A). See also discussion of responses by children and young people at [4.5].

Taken together, disengaging and avoiding the place/person constituted a comparatively high 18% of all responses (see Table 30 in Appendix A). Notably too, 'not doing or saying anything' was only 5% of responses (and lower than the 9% recorded in 2023-24).

Consistent with previous reporting years, the three *least* common responses in 2024-25 were making a complaint to an independent complaints body, such as Fair Work, Australian Human Rights Commission or Ombudsman (4%); retaliation, such as swearing or lashing out at the perpetrator (2%); and reporting to police (1%). These were the three least common responses across witnesses, friends/relatives and those self-reporting (see Table 30 in Appendix A), across age groups and by gender (see Tables 30, 31 and 32 in Appendix A).

### 3.2.1 Responding to racism

Our previous reporting identified that many see calling racism out as an essential strategy for reducing its incidence. This was again the case in 2024-25, with one in five people (Table 27, Appendix A) identifying feeling motivated to bring about change and/or solidarity with those who are targeted by this issue.

> It has gotten out of control now where something has to be done! This cannot continue and that is why I joined this platform, to speak up for my own rights! & To fight for equality & justice & fairness & to be treated like a normal human being. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

People are responding to racism by defending themselves/another (13%, Table 27, Appendix A). Examples include the two First Nations women; one who recorded on video the assault on a young person in a store (subsequently arrested by police) and the other who challenged racism at the sauna.

> I have experienced this type of talk too many times in my life and thought I'd speak up and just let them know I am Aboriginal and I don't get everything for free. I handled myself well and tried to not show too much anger. It turned into a bit of a debate and one of the younger men kind of became an ally to me. I then heard the usual spiel of not all Aboriginals are like this etc. I then just proceeded to leave the premises and have not returned since - this happened over a year ago. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The following further example describes a First Nations man feeling like retaliating against family members perpetrating racism but confronting them verbally instead.

> My in-laws were visiting my wife and I and they invited some of their friends over for breakfast and their friend made a joke ... "it's like culling Aboriginal people". I paused and watched him and his wife laughing and my in-laws joining in the laughter. I said with a stern voice "I'm Aboriginal". I got a reply "yeah I know" and the laughter continued. Until I said that's not right you shouldn't say that. The mood changed I had to leave my own home before I assaulted him. I felt like dragging him out of my house and hurting him. I didn't. I left and went to my mum's. The next day I confronted my in-laws and they kept interrupting me before I could tell them how I felt and it got out of hand they got defensive and started to yell and I asked them to leave my home. They call me a Son but they didn't even look at [me] when they got home didn't console me didn't ask me if I'm okay. Just acted like it didn't happen ... (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

When a 'student voiced in a group setting, should we ask if they are sniffing petroleum?... during a medical studies lecture and case study work' the First Nations woman reporting the incident 'Questioned their thinking and thought process-smashed the stereotype publicly' (self-report, Aboriginal female). In the incident where the First Nations woman was blocked from sitting down at the train platform both women 'loudly spoke up between ourselves within ear shot that it was hurtful and a clear act of racism' (friend/relative report, Aboriginal).

Direct questioning or confrontation leads to varied and unpredictable outcomes, as is clear from accounts shared throughout this report. As further examples shared in self-reports, the first comment below was provided by the First Nations person responding to her sister's comments about Uluru, the second relates to the transport incident involving use of the term 'natives', and the third to the racism from a stranger in a bakery. These examples demonstrate that calling racism out directly in conversation may have somewhat limited impacts on the attitudes of racists.

> I tried to shut the conversation down, but she started raising her voice at me and telling me I'm rigid in my way of thinking about Indigenous people. I told her that her views are outdated. She also works for the government which is even more disappointing. Husband is in military, and they are complete racists. Older generations with brainwashed views. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I told the driver that calling First Nations peoples "natives" is insulting and that maybe things would improve if he referred to us as First Nations people. Second, not all our people are homeless, violent, etc. I told him that it was insulting for him to assume these negative thoughts of us. He then decided to tell me I was too fair to be a native. I asked him when he makes coffee, if he adds milk, does he still call it coffee? Before he could answer, I politely requested that we cease our

> conversation I was upset by his comments and was no longer interested in continuing the conversation. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)
>
> I turned around and told him his comments were offensive and unnecessary. Instead of taking a moment to reflect, he started yelling at me, claiming that "no one wants to talk about the problems." It was clear he wasn't open to reasoning, so I decided to leave … What kind of world do we live in? (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Witnesses also spoke about stepping in to challenge racists both during and after incidents (including via formal complaints), as in the following report about security guards policing a shopping centre area.

> Around 1 pm today … I saw two First Nations women in the carpark area of the [named] Shopping Centre … I had seen them in the area before, and the previous day they were sitting in a park … while I was getting lunch. They are kind, very friendly women. I planned to do some shopping at the vegetable shop and return to give them some change on the way back to my car. However, as I walked out of the shop, I saw a young, female security guard … screaming at the women. I stopped to listen and heard her tell them they are not allowed in the shopping precinct area and if they did not leave, she would call police. The women politely replied that they were not doing anything wrong but they would leave regardless …. I told her that if she did not leave the women alone immediately, I would be reporting her racist, discriminatory, and abusive actions. She told me that she was just doing her job. I returned to my car and as I was driving through the carpark, I saw the security officer had been joined by another female security officer …. They were yelling and intimidating the women, following them as they headed off the premises … I told both security guards that I would be reporting them for discrimination and verbal abuse. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

In response to harassment by a neighbour, potentially causing a First Nations woman to leave public housing, the friend/relative reporting the incident states that 'With Aunt's permission I spoke to [the] neighbour saying that her behaviour is against the law and I will call the police if it continues' (friend/relative report, non-Indigenous). Note that only 1% had reported incidents to police (3% of self-reports) – unsurprising given issues of trust and racism within policing raised in other parts of this report (Table 30, Appendix A).

Most commonly, people talked to family and friends following racism (21%, see Figure 19). The First Nations man who experienced racism in conversation with his non-Indigenous in-laws identified this as a positive response.

> I felt worthless until I talked to my father and he said I did the right thing by kicking them out of my home. He said you not only did it for yourself. You did it for me for

> your auntie and uncles your grandparents and your future children. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

Examples of 'other type of report or complaint' or 'other action' (15% and 8% respectively, see Figure 19) include the action taken by witnesses to racism perpetrated by the comedian discussed earlier. 'I wrote to the venue requesting they make a public denouncement of her and reassure the wider community that this would never happen again' (witness report, non-Indigenous). The First Nations employee concerned about a racist student nurse took the following action.

> As it was my first day at this job and this person already had connections with my coworkers, I felt uncomfortable confronting her about this. I have reported the interaction to her University though as I don't believe this person should be working within regional healthcare with her attitude. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

A range of strategies was employed by the First Nations academic reporting racism experienced at the hands of a student, including taking internal and external legal and other action.

> … reported to my boss, asked student to leave the classroom the second time it happened, reported to university support service, told my Dean, told my PVC Indigenous, told colleagues I trusted, told my [named Union] branch president, increased therapy frequency, hired a lawyer when the union proved useless. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Other actions reported included working for a First Nations legal organisation offering support to First Nations people in the face of discriminatory drinking laws in the NT (friend/relative report, non-Indigenous) and as identified by multiple people, use of the Call It Out Register.

> I have waited for the heat to subside. I want this incident recorded somewhere that sees it counted as racism against Aboriginal people. I am still weighing whether it reaches the threshold for a complaint to the Ombudsman, though I am adding it to my existing file of evidence with them. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> As I was frustrated and angry… I vented to a colleague who is Aboriginal-identified and she referred me to make this complaint. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Today I felt the only action I could manage was this one - to call it out [on this Register]. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

There are also multiple accounts shared throughout this report indicating that disengaging, avoiding the place/person and not saying or doing anything in response to racism is not uncommon (in combination, 23% of reports) (see Figure 19). We consider the *very significant* barriers inhibiting responses to racism in [3.3].

Avoidance is evident, for instance, where First Nations people leave a job or stay away from the place in which racism has occurred. ‘I actually haven't caught a tram since the incident! I've gone back onto my anxiety medication since the incident happened’ (self-report, Aboriginal female). ‘I won't be using that store ever again’ (self-report, Aboriginal female). Avoidance or disengagement may be responses that sit alongside others (including defending oneself/others). And we note too that these are not necessarily unconstructive responses to racism, as identified in previous Call It Out reports. They can be a form of self-preservation, as the following reports related to social media incidents suggest.

> Didn't want to give oxygen to this person and their views, so just blocked and deleted them. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Facebook profile ... really got to me this morning and triggered my own racist experiences. I can't understand or accept why his profile is getting away with posting such racist statements and memes. This may seem trivial, but today I'm not having it! I don't want to waste my energy focusing on [this individual’s] personal racism, because it makes me physically sick, annoyed, distraught and I'm no longer being quiet about racism! I'm over it all, my frustrations at people who are unable to feel empathy, compassion and being non-judgemental is only growing every day. It's so sad that people are still thinking like this in 2024! (Self-report, Aboriginal)

At other times, these types of responses look more like exclusion, shunning, isolation or similarly negative outcomes (see also discussion of disengagement from school in [4]). For instance, when a manager refused to allow a First Nations employee to ‘set the team budget even though other’ non-Aboriginal staff at similar levels ‘had full autonomy over their team budgets’ this employee resigned from their role, ‘leading to loss of income’ (self-report, Aboriginal female).

### 3.2.2 Responses to the incident for those who self-reported racism, by gender

We have also investigated responses to incidents of racism by gender for those who self-reported racism. Of this group, more than half (80/155 or 52%) chose to respond to this optional question, and a majority of these (54/85 or 68%) selected multiple responses (n=170, see Table 32 in Appendix A). As above, in 2024-25 respondents could select up to a maximum of three responses for this question.

‘Talked to family or friends’ was the most frequent response for both genders (26% females and 24% males) (see also Table 32 in Appendix A), as was the case in our previous two annual reports for 2022-23 and 2023-24.

Although the numbers are small, males were proportionately more likely to ‘disengage’ (14% males compared to 9% females). While females were more likely to report directly

to the organisation/service or internal HR (13% females compared to 8% males). Males were proportionately more likely to make a complaint to an independent complaints body (10% males compared to 3% females) and slightly more likely to report to police (5% males compared to 3% females). Both genders were equally likely to retaliate (both 3%) (See Table 32 in Appendix A).[45]

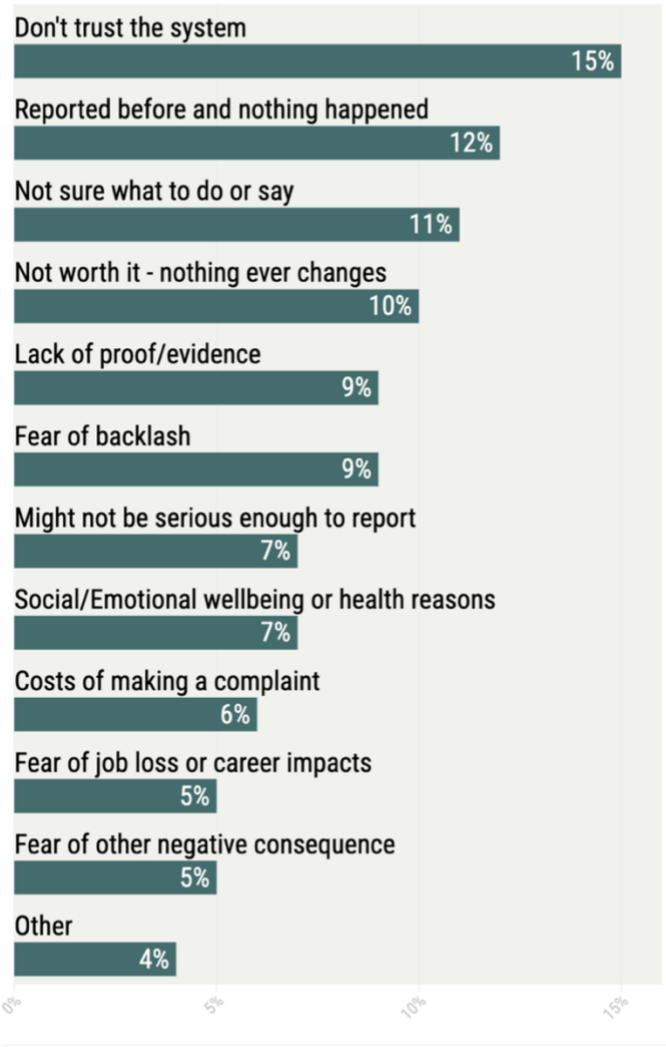
## 3.3 Barriers to calling out racism

As noted above, a sizeable number of persons identify disengaging, avoiding a place/person or doing or saying nothing when encountering racism. This speaks to the enormous challenge of calling racism out.

Individuals completing the Register were asked to identify up to three main barriers to responding to racism from a choice of 12 answers. This was a new question on the Register in 2024-25, and more than half (261/442 or 59%) of those filling in the Register completed this optional question. Of these, more than half (203/261 or 78%) provided multiple responses (n=621, see Table 33 in Appendix A).

As shown in Figure 20, 'lack of trust in the system' was the most common barrier to calling out racism (15%), including for each respondent group (see Table 33 in Appendix A). Other barriers more frequently identified, as shown in Figure 20, include 'reported before and nothing happened' (12%), 'not sure what to do or say' (11%) and 'not worth it – nothing ever changes' (10%) (see Table 33 in Appendix A).

**Figure 20 Barriers to calling out racism**




Source: Table 33 Barriers to calling out racism*^ by who reported the incident

[45] These statistics are similar to those recorded in 2023-24.

There were some differences in barriers for different groups reporting to the Register (see detail at Table 33 in Appendix A),[46] and across targeted age groups. For instance, for reported incidents of racism targeting children and young people in the 0-19 age group, the most common barrier identified was 'don't trust the system' (19%), while 'fear of job loss' was somewhat more likely for incidents targeting adults in the 30-39 age group (11%) (Table 34 in Appendix A).

### 3.3.1 Nothing to be done about racism

The barriers identified as 'not worth it nothing ever changes', 'reported before and nothing happened' and to an extent, 'don't trust the system' all speak to similar issues and collectively make up a sizeable 38% of all responses (Figure 20). They are interconnected issues, at certain points. Lack of trust arises, for instance, where 'the system' fails to respond appropriately to racism. This system could be an HR or other internal system through which an employee might seek a remedy, legal system protections against racism or perhaps how the mainstream world operates more broadly (and however else this term is interpreted by those responding to this question). There was, understandably, an overarching sense that people can still get away with racism and that there was *very little* to be done about it.

> There is no recourse for these acts of racism. Our society allows it. They are entitled to act this way and if we respond we are the problem. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

As previously discussed, there are variable and unpredictable outcomes of calling out racism. Multiple accounts shared to the Register and throughout this report identify poor responses to challenges to racism – whether that be via formal complaints mechanisms or when defending oneself/others directly (in conversation with a racist, for example). As a further example, the academic who experienced racism from a student identified other students as 'great allies in checking in with me after class to see if I was ok and praised my handling of the matter' (self-report, Aboriginal female). The university's response was identified as falling short, however – as discussed earlier.

> I expected the student to be removed from my subject but university support services that investigated did not recognise any racism and took 3 months to investigate so student stayed in my subject but as an online student and got to

[46] Friends/relatives (19%) and self-reports (16%) were somewhat more likely to report not trusting the system than witnesses (14%). Witnesses were more likely to identify not knowing what to do or say (14%) compared to reports from friends/relatives (3%) and First Nations people directly experiencing racism (9%). See further detail at Table 33, Appendix A.

> keep their B grade because classroom behaviour has no bearing on passing or failing, only written assessments count. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The First Nations family member reporting harassment by a church congregation member 'approached the leadership team' 'with no result other than that: "We need to understand age. This lady is old and will never change"' (self-report, Aboriginal female). As was recorded in previous Call It Out reports, those failing to moderate content online are also identified as racist. 'Meta is terrible at mitigating racism' (witness report, non-Indigenous).

> This page [on social media] contains videos calling for violence towards Aboriginal First Nations [people] in [named town] etc. The comments prove this. I have reported this page to Facebook with no success. This is 1 of a number of pages. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

Lodging complaints with anti-discrimination bodies or other independent complaints body was not especially common as a response to racism (4%, Figure 19) but for one First Nations person who did so the body in question 'weren't even sure how to support' (self-report, Aboriginal female).

In terms of challenges to racism being 'not worth it, nothing ever changes' (10%, Figure 20), people questioned the 'time it takes' and 'whether it actually affects change', including where incidents or issues are more 'systemic' in nature. (Witness report, non-Indigenous). Also discussed is that the power to bring about change sits with those that are likely to be *part of the problem*. This was noted in discussing challenges in reporting the Church Dean to the senior Bishop (see [2.2]). Another relevant comment is as follows.

> It's enormous. And very long standing. And serves [the] interests of the powerful who actually have capacity to change things. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Those using the Register felt that there was not enough proof or evidence to do anything about racism (9%, Figure 20). That First Nations people might know they are being discriminated against, but face difficulties proving this is illustrated in the following reports. These describe First Nations people calling out racism 'in the moment' - when subjected to over-surveillance in stores (see also [2.4.2]). Attempts to identify racism may (apparently relatively easily) be countered with 'well, where is the evidence?'.

> I said is this pick on black people day. The female said you're the second person who said that and it's not because of the colour of your skin. I asked why are you not stopping … white people that were leaving the store. This was racial profiling and unconscious bias towards me and I felt it and knew it was and I called it out. Unacceptable behaviour. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> Walked into the store with my father, we both have a dark complexion and the worker used her earpiece walkie talkie to tell the other worker out loud to watch me and my father after we were going to get engine coolant. As soon as we got our item the worker quickly radioed the other colleague don't worry and played it off as a joke when it was a clear that she was racially profiling us when other non-Indigenous customers that walked ahead of us were not told to be watched. (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander female)

This last report continues as follows.

> ... Made me realise that racial profiling is still happening in this day and age. I imagined the days of going into a shop without being the target of racism were less prevalent and more subtle. Understanding that Australia has a subtle subculture of treating Indigenous people differently to white people. (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander female)

A fear of 'job loss/other career impacts', 'other negative consequences' or 'backlash' of some description constituted 19% (combined, Figure 20). The witness who reported a customer speaking of running over an Aboriginal person did not respond at the time due to fear, for example.

> I had to continue serving them due to a fear of potential escalation. I had to advise the team manager of what happened and he was not reassuring as he mentioned it is unlikely they are able to do anything to do anything. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

An Aboriginal woman who reported being told to 'move over you black cunts' by a stranger on the street also didn't challenge this individual, stating 'I'm scared of getting stabbed' (self-report, Aboriginal female). And certainly, as we have seen, calling out racism can *and does* have real-life and weighty negative consequences (for example, the Aboriginal woman arrested when videoing a young person's assault in a store). The following report discusses fear of repercussions arising in a workplace setting.

> Prior to us meeting [an Aboriginal organisation] my manager presented her concerns about attending the meeting [with this organisation] as the only white person and said, "so do I need to be careful as they might spear me with their spears". She laughed but stopped once she seen my facial expressions become very uncomfortable and how my tone was when I said that's a racist thing to say, how dare you. I only started in the role 2 weeks prior and felt isolated as ... I didn't want to get into a conflict that could see me losing this new opportunity in an instant that I worked very hard to achieve. I've been in this situation many times and when I have called it out I was shone upon and people stayed clear of me for worry of their mouths saying the wrong things about my people. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

Related to this, intimidation was seen as a tactic purposefully used to silence challenges to racism – in this instance in online spaces.

> This [named social media account] keeps trying to intimate me by saying his admins are from VIC Pol[ice] and WA Pol[ice] and are looking into my place of employment. And that's illegal as I know the law very well. I have also reported these posts, and Facebook has done nothing among more and more comments. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

'Social emotional wellbeing/health' barriers inhibiting responses (7%, Figure 20) might include the above-mentioned fear, as well as other issues. It may be just too overwhelming in general (wellbeing wise) to take on racism.

> They accuse the victim of being the perpetrator and isn't taken seriously. Also constantly repeating the story is re-traumatising. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

For this reason, people may choose (or as follows, be encouraged) to avoid taking action as a form of self-protection – unless absolutely necessary. This may link with a further barrier identified; that an issue or incident may not be seen as 'serious enough' to warrant taking action (7%, Figure 20).

> I have had management (even Aboriginal management) tell me to leave it before. Pick my battles, separate myself from the ones who are angry. But I feel angry too. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

For this same First Nations person, not taking action in this instance made them 'feel like I'm betraying' grandchildren (who are also likely to face racism in future – pointing to the intergenerational nature of racism).

The barrier related to the costs (6%, Figure 20) may relate to financial but perhaps also other (for example, emotional) costs associated with taking action. One Aboriginal female reported that they 'Tried to gain a no win no fee lawyer … and they refused to take it on' (self-report, Aboriginal female). One witness raised lack of knowledge/clarity about legalities associated with racist online content as somehow 'permitting' such behaviour. This includes legalities about what content is or isn't against the law and who has responsibility (legally) when such content is shared – and somewhat related to this point is the barrier of 'not being sure what to do or say' (11%, Figure 20). Below we also discuss the murkiness of laws when students post social media content outside of school.

> Gross online posts and comments by many in my community about [young people] throwing rocks at cars in my community. Understand community anger - but lots of 'bashing until teeth fall out' kind of responses. Some jumping in to call it out but with all the aggression, it's intimidating to do so … These people have no shame and think they will have no accountability. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

### 3.3.2 Barriers to calling out racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender

We also investigated barriers to standing up to racism by gender for those who self-reported racism. Of this group, just under half (76/155 or 49%) selected to respond to this question, and a majority of these (66/76 or 87%) selected multiple responses (n=200, see Table 35 in Appendix A). As above, respondents could select up to three responses for this optional question.

Females were more proportionately more likely to report not trusting the system (17% females and 9% males), fear of job loss or career impacts (10% females and 6% males) and social/emotional wellbeing or health reasons (9% females and 3% males) (Table 35, Appendix A).

Males were more likely to identify lack of proof/evidence (males 13% and females 6%), cost of making a complaint (males 13% and females 6%) and not sure what to do or say (13% males compared to 10% females) (Table 35, Appendix A).

## 3.4 What needs to be done to combat racism

The Register also contained a question on what needs to be done to combat racism. In 2024-25, a maximum of three responses could be nominated for this question.[47] More than half of all respondents (280/442 or 63%) completed this optional question, and most of those people (255/280 or 91%) provided multiple responses (n=779, see Table 36 in Appendix A).

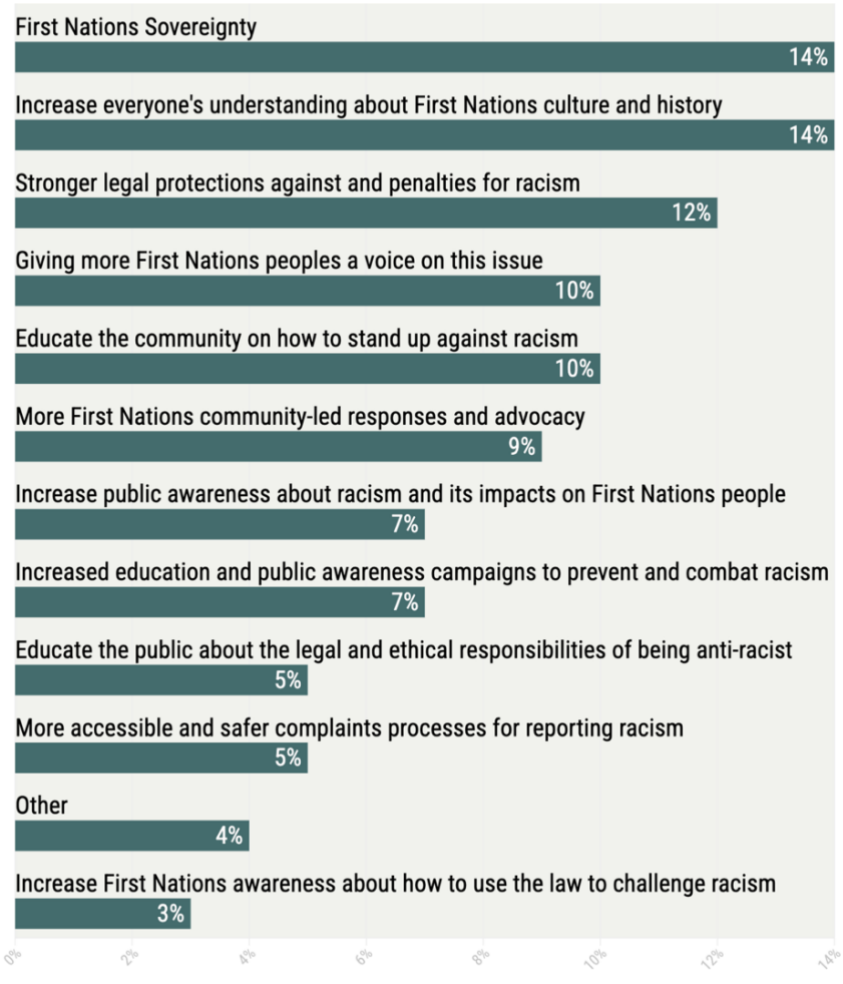
As shown in Figure 21 below, the most frequently identified solution for combatting racism was ‘First Nations Sovereignty (e.g. self-determination, land back, reparations)’ and ‘increase everyone’s understanding about First Nations culture and history’ (both 14%) (see also Table 36 in Appendix A). This strategy, in combination with the third most common response, ‘stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism’ accounted for over a third of all responses (40%) (see Table 36 in Appendix A).

These were the most common solutions identified for self-reports and witness reports. However, for friend/relative reports the most common solutions were ‘educate the community on how to stand up against racism’ (16%), followed by ‘stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism’ (14%) and ‘increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people’ (12%). (See Table 36 in Appendix A).

[47] In previous years there was no restriction on the number of ndividual responses for this question. As a result, there was little differentiation between answers identified in previous annual reports. A limit of up to 3 answers was introduced in 2024-25 to better understand key solutions for combatting racism identified by those who reported experiencing and witnessing racism.

There were some differences in solutions to racism identified across reports based on the age of the person being targeted. For instance, stronger legal protections/penalties was the most common solution in reports where the person being targeted was identified as aged 40-49 years (13%), while for incidents targeting 20-29 year olds, respondents were equally likely to identify 'increased education and public awareness campaigns to prevent and combat racism' and 'First Nations Sovereignty' (both 16%) (see detail at Table 38 in Appendix A).

**Figure 21 What needs to be done to combat racism**




Source: Table 36 What needs to be done to combat racism*^ by who reported the incident

### 3.4.1 What needs to be done to combat racism for those who self-reported racism, by gender

We analysed responses to the question of what needs to be done to combat racism by gender for those who self-reported racism. Of this group, just under half (76/155 or 49%) chose to respond to this question, and of these a majority (71/76 or 93%) selected multiple responses (n=217, see Table 37 in Appendix A). As above, in 2024-25 respondents could select up to a maximum of three answers for this optional question.

First Nations Sovereignty was a common response to the question of what needs to be done to combat racism by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism. There was little (1 percentage point) differentiation between responses for males (14%) and females (13%). (Table 33, Appendix A).

There were some notable differences in other responses by gender, however the numbers are relatively small. Taken together males were more likely to identify other First Nations self-determination and governance strategies[48] by a difference of 18 percentage points (52% males compared to 34% females). Males were more likely to identify stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism (16% males compared to 12% females), giving more First Nations peoples a voice on this issue (16% males and 11% females), more First Nations community-led responses and advocacy (14% males compared to 7% females). (Table 37, Appendix A).

Taken together, education and awareness related strategies targeting the broader community/society[49] were more frequently identified by females (43%) than males (25%); except for responses identifying 'educate the community on how to stand up against racism' which were similar (9% females and 10% males). (Table 37, Appendix A).

### 3.4.2 Strategies to combat racism

We heard that multiple different approaches and strategies are required to tackle racism, given its enormity and complexity. 'Anti-racism is the work of everyone. This needs to be embedded culturally, politically, legally' (friend/relative report, non-Indigenous). This probably accounts for the similarity in preferred responses to racism, as above (see Figure 20). As one First Nations woman stated in response to this question, 'It won't let me select 'all of the above' but ALL OF THE ABOVE. It ALL needs to happen' (self-report, Aboriginal female).

#### Rights and responsibilities

That everyone should be combatting racism came through in various reports, including those speaking of the reluctance of some to take on this responsibility. Others were

[48] The self-determination and governance strategies grouped here includes: 'Stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism', 'Giving more First Nations peoples a voice on this issue', 'Educate the community on how to stand up against racism', More First Nations community-led responses and advocacy', 'Increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people' and 'Increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism' (see Table 33 in Appendix A).

[49] The education and awareness strategies grouped here includes: 'Increase everyone's understanding about First Nations culture and history', 'Educate the community on how to stand up against racism', 'Increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people', 'Educate the public about the legal and ethical responsibilities of being anti-racist', and 'Increased education and public awareness campaigns to prevent and combat racism'.

clearly ready to step in, which for one witness meant ‘listening, learning, and speaking up when it matters’ (witness report, non-Indigenous).

> More white people calling out racism. It shouldn't be up to Blak people to call out their own abuse without support. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> Organisationally, there are layers of risk around responding to this kind of thing. I see businesses and governments taking a hands-off approach. Ours took no side on the Referendum for instance, so challenging those kinds of opinions could be deemed "political". Easier for social media comments to be hidden rather than responded to for example… (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Enhancing protections targeting racism was again a focus this year. One First Nations person wanted ‘stricter punishment for people who perpetrate racism’, for instance. The self-report about a workplace incident involving a manager talking about being speared spoke of this too.

> It's powerless [to call it out directly] without the right platforms that hold racists accountable for their actions - not shielded to do it again with improved measures to avoid getting caught. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

Enhanced legal protections against racism accounted for a relatively high 25% of all responses when combining the following strategies: ‘stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism’ (12%), ‘educate the public about the legal and ethical responsibilities of being anti-racist’ (5%), ‘more accessible and safer complaints processes for reporting racism’ (5%) and ‘increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism’ (3%) (see Figure 21).

As this data indicates, responses were somewhat less centred on initiation of complaints or legal action, including by First Nations people (8%, combining better complaints mechanisms and First Nations awareness of how to use the law), compared with measures for increasing accountability of others to avoid or address racism (17%, combining having stronger protections in place and increased awareness about responsibilities to avoid breaching them) (see Figure 21). This perhaps speaks to the important role of the law in changing behaviours proactively and preventatively as an alternative to placing the onus on those impacted by racism to take legal action. There are significant barriers for First Nations people affected by racism to challenge it via the legal system, some of which are touched on above (for example, costs, distrust).

(Stronger) legal provisions as solutions to racism include but extend beyond human rights law. One First Nations person called for stronger ‘social media laws to protect

against unauthorized videos and racist intent', for instance.[50] Other comments include the following.

> … I despair for Aboriginal people being inflicted [with] this daily abuse - this abuse has grown stronger since the failed Referendum- these people feel … safety [in] numbers to be openly racist. I feel Australia needs a human rights charter. Something needs to happen. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> Prosecute perpetrators. Make examples of their behaviours and sanction them…!!! (Witness report, Aboriginal)
>
> Policies and stronger laws with consequences supported by a massive PR push to the community and in all media showing and highlighting bad behaviours. They must be legislated as permanent prime time short grabs in all [mainstream media]. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> Large fines and demotion for racial microaggressions. Loss of Blue card and Yellow Card and ability to work with vulnerable people. Racial molesting is trauma and mental health and lifespan eroding. Prison time for racial crimes. (Witness report, not identified)

While referring to the fishing competition interview, one First Nations man identified Articles 15 and 16 of the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) as provding essential legal protection against racism (witness report, Aboriginal). We cite these provisions in full here, as they were in the report.[51]

**Article 15, UNDRIP**

1. Indigenous peoples have the right to the dignity and diversity of their cultures, traditions, histories and aspirations which shall be appropriately reflected in education and public information.
2. States shall take effective measures, in consultation and cooperation with the Indigenous peoples concerned, to combat prejudice and eliminate discrimination and to promote tolerance, understanding and good relations among Indigenous peoples and all other segments of society.

**Article 16, UNDRIP**

1. Indigenous peoples have the right to establish their own media in their own languages and to have access to all forms of non-Indigenous media without discrimination.
2. States shall take effective measures to ensure that State-owned media duly reflect Indigenous cultural diversity. States, without prejudice to ensuring full freedom of expression, should encourage privately-owned media to adequately reflect Indigenous cultural diversity.

[50] Some responses point to the need to clarify existing provisions that might offer protection against racism (that may need bolstering).

[51] The full UNDRIP document is available here: <https://www.un.org/development/desa/indigenouspeoples/wp-content/uploads/sites/19/2018/11/UNDRIP_E_web.pdf>.

**Understanding and attitudes**

The following report identifies 'training' as necessary to lift government accountability to address racism – part of a broader common theme of working on understanding and attitudes to combat this issue.

> The local council needs independent oversight and training to improve their servicing. The racist divide is tangible and disgusting. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Public education and awareness strategies together accounted for 39% of responses, combining the following strategies: 'increase everyone's understanding about First Nations culture and history' (14%), 'educate the community on how to stand up against racism' (10%), 'increase public awareness about racism and its impact on First Nations people' (7%), 'educate the public about the legal/ethical responsibilities to be anti-racist' (5%) and 'increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism' (3%) (see Figure 21). Various reports spoke of these strategies, including as follows.

> I think white Australians on the coast haven't been even introduced to a wide variety of Indigenous peoples so they believe a stereotype they've been taught by their parents is what Indigenous people are. As well as that white Australians on the coast don't care that Indigenous peoples were first on land and should be respected. I think people who are not of Aboriginal descent need to be educated that Indigenous Australians need to be respected and treated the same as them, because there is still a big racial inequity. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> [A racist incident on social media] made me realise that many non-Indigenous Australians have extremely superficial knowledge and understanding of Indigenous cultures. It makes you lose faith in people and society. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

One witness to an incident involving denigration of a prominent First Nations athlete emphasised this point.

> The incident has motivated me to research more into Aboriginal athletes in the sporting world and the accomplishments they have achieved. It has made me eager to learn more about how Australia is supporting First Nations athletes and this way, I can then be better informed when perpetrators of racism do make discriminatory statements. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Changing attitudes is identified as crucial. We note that racist attitudes and stereotypes are *consistently* the most commonly reported type of racism identified in our annual reports.

> … I felt disheartened about how many people were so comfortable and confident perpetuating harmful stereotypes about Aboriginal people. It reflects that there is a still long way to go to change social attitudes towards Aboriginal people. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Increased understanding of culture and history may address some of the ignorant and harmful racism reported to the Register, including where these incidents demonstrate poor recognition of culture, for instance. This might perhaps help increase society's empathic and 'trauma based responses'; essential due to our 'colonial history' (self-report, Aboriginal male). Increasing empathy was identified in a report about a recent trend involving use of a First Nations man's image when making video-calls (for some reason, seen as humorous).

> [The incident] left me feeling frustrated that people did not take the time to think about the harm they are perpetuating. I wish they had taken a moment to think about how they would feel if someone from their own family was used by complete strangers for something like this. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Others suggested that increasing empathy (or changing attitudes generally) would be impossible and as such, mechanisms of accountability are (also) certainly required – in this instance, a name and shame register (suggested in previous Call It Out reporting). This again highlights the importance of multi-layered strategies.

> If I could, I would tick all of these. There is one problem (apart from the limit [to number of options to select]). People like this will never be convinced by listening to the experiences of others. There is an ingrained narcissism that resents being asked to reflect and place oneself in the shoes of another. In many ways we almost need a name-and-shame register: this seems to be the only thing that's likely to shift attitudes with these people. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Education is also identified as occurring in less formal settings; where individuals step up, speak up and act as good role models, including for younger generations. There are different ways to build understanding, it is suggested, which don't always have to be directly centred on teaching people about avoiding being racist.

> Knowing that the solution does not sit with reporting it, more so with adults being good role models and providing education from a young age. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> I thought "respecting the difference" would help. Now I teach nurses, midwives and doctors about First Nations health and wellbeing. Change is going to be slow and frankly painful. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

**Strength in culture and self-determination**

As noted, preferred strategies incorporate and centre First Nations self-determination (through First Nations Sovereignty, amplifying First Nations voices and prioritising First Nations-led responses and solutions (33% in combination, Figure 21)). First Nations people are already taking action to combat racism, as we have seen throughout this report - and as the following report by a friend/relative identifies.

> Sitting running a workshop about justice system with Aboriginal people for work. Every Aboriginal participant had been locked up or had family currently locked up. Shameful situation we are in in this country. Very stark reminder of the shit that happens on a daily basis to our First Nations peoples but inspired by their resolve at that workshop to take action to bring about change. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

This may also, in part, involving talking to friends/family when experiencing racism, the most commonly identified response to incidents. Strong Indigenous leadership was highlighted too as a key solution, as was strengthening of culture.

> Build stronger communities and individuals, to stop following the way of life we lived on missions and communities, be loving leaders in their families, pick up the value of Kinship relationships, extra mothers and fathers, extra Grandmothers and Grandfathers, find language words for those people - drop the false name words Aunty, Uncle, cousins we have our own language words find them and use them... Relearn our culture ... organise camps in our own lands, find our own designs, check museums to see if they have items that represent certain cultural property you belong to. Be true to ourselves, teach our kids. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

# 4. Children and young people

The focus in this section of the Report is on incidents of racism impacting children and young people (0-19 age group). This is a focus given the increase this year in reports about and from this age group - and for this reason, we have included as an introductory piece thoughts from a young First Nations woman about racism and her responses to it.

Reports to the Register impact this group in different ways. Sometimes incidents are reported by adults where younger people are the direct targets of racism. In other adult-initiated reports, this group is less directly targeted but are still impacted. The latter might include, for example, when incidents target their parents or other First Nations people, such as social media incidents.

Younger people might also report incidents themselves – most likely where they are directly targeted. One example of this is a comment shared to the Register by a young Aboriginal person describing racism as experienced constantly and viscerally.

> Everywhere I go no matter where, if it's around non-Indigenous people I feel a hate vibe. It feels like I'm being watched. (Self-Report, Aboriginal)

Adults reporting to the Register may also identify incidents that occurred in their youth, with significant and lasting impacts. Or in some cases the whole family can be directly targeted, as occurred in the report concerning the church congregation member. Incidents that fit into each of these categories are shared throughout the report and discussed in more detail below, along with responses to such incidents and their impacts.

## 4.1 Racism experienced by children and young people

We recorded at [2.7.2] that more than a quarter of those who identified the age of the victim of incidents selected the 0-19 years age group.[52] Thus, a significant proportion of reports, where age was known, impacted children and young people.

'Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping' and 'verbal abuse or hate speech' were proportionately more prevalent as types of racism for all age groups, including those aged 0-19. However, those aged 0-19 were more likely than other age groups to experience bullying/threats/intimidation and physical harm (see Table 21 in Appendix A).

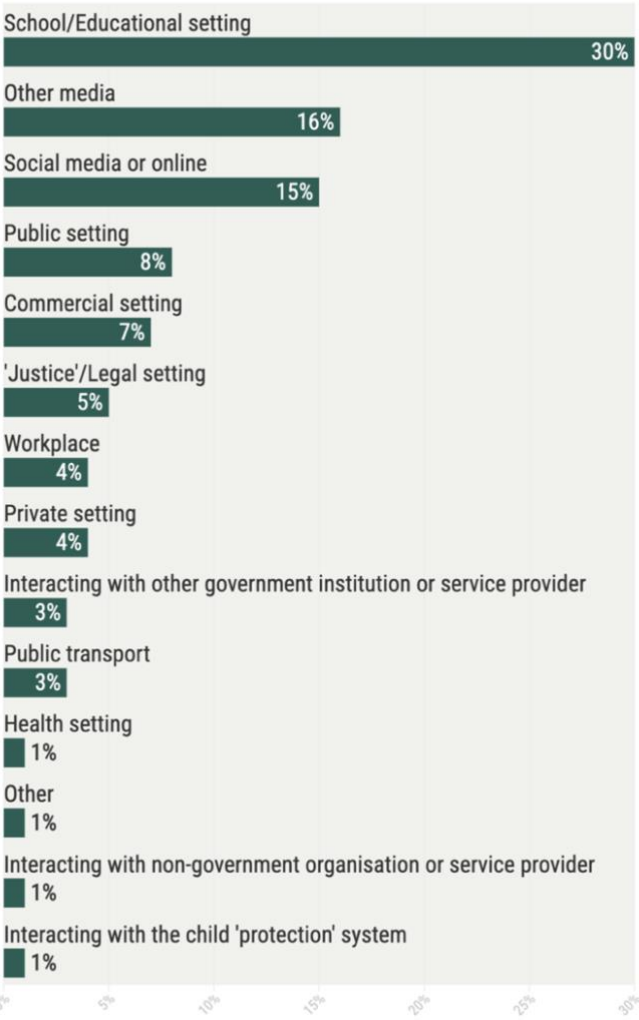
Perhaps not surprisingly, those aged 0-19 were also likely to have experienced racism in a school/educational setting (30% of identified locations of racism). Other media and social media/online were also frequent locations (16% and 15% respectively) (Figure A).

[52] The age group was identified by 204 respondents, of these 53 (or 26%) were in the 0-19 age bracket, see Table 20 in Appendix A.

Children and young people also experienced racism in these same settings proportionately more frequently than other age groups. (Table 22 in Appendix A).[53]

A higher proportion of children and young people victims of racism were male, where gender was identified (Table C in Appendix B).[54] A higher proportion of those perpetrating racism against children and young people were also male (again, where gender was identified) (Table D in Appendix B).[55] Also notable, nearly half of those perpetrating racism against victims aged 0-19 were also aged 0-19 (44%) (Table E, Appendix B).[56]

**Figure A Location of racism targeting children and young people**




Source: Table B Location where the racism happened* by who reported the racism for incidents targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

## 4.2 School-based racism

Education related incidents describe multiple incidents of racism experienced by children and young people in a school setting.[57] The statistics above indicate that children and young people were proportionally more likely to be targeted by perpetrators in their own age bracket. The following self-reports identify students targeting students via stereotyping (being not 'Black enough' and receiving too

[53] But note that 30% of reports with a victim aged 50+ identified social media/media as a location.
[54] Female victims constituted 30% and gender was not applicable in 17% of reports.
[55] Gender not applicable constituted 28% and females 21%. The higher proportion of 'gender not applicable' may relate to the higher proportion of social media/media related incidents reported for this group.
[56] As additional data, how racism was experienced and the type of racism they encountered were both somewhat different for those aged 0-19. Firstly, this group was proportionally more likely to be identified as experiencing interpersonal racism (49%) than either systemic/institutional racism (13%) or both interpersonal and systemic/institutional (28%) (Table A in Appendix B). In comparison, 34% of reports overall identified experiences of interpersonal racism, 33% of both interpersonal and systemic/institutional racism and 21% of systemic/institutional racism (Table 4 in Appendix A).
[57] We have not focused on reports related to other educational settings in [4], including university, as younger victims were predominantly attending and affected by racism in schools. University related incidents are referred to in other sections of the report.

many hand-outs) and not recognising cultural and other Indigenous rights (in this case, culture-based school programs). The reports also confirm the relative prevalence of bullying as type of racism impacting First Nations children and young people (see Table 21 in Appendix A).

> The fellow student went around telling other students in my year group saying, "I was only 3 percent" and that I was "Faking it to receive benefits" and that "I was a fake Aboriginal". (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander male)

> So this was while I was at my school, right? We're moving between classes and I'm talking to my friends about being Aboriginal, you know. And, you know, I appear Caucasian. I don't look "Aboriginal" (I'm saying that with quotation marks). So while I'm talking this guy comes up to me, he's one of my people in my year, and he's like, "You can't possibly be Aboriginal. You're White. That's not how that works. You're not Black". And you know I try to explain basic history to him and he just wouldn't have it. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I get told by friends that the programs we get to do at school to recognise our culture are unfair, that people that are "barely" Aboriginal get to get all this stuff and when we get the stuff from government all we do is trash it. I try to defend myself but then all my friends turn on me. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Incidents were reported by First Nations adults recounting experiences of racism as a student at school – and again, involving student perpetrators. The below report and others set out in this section identify racist hate speech and verbal abuse.

> I used to go to a predominantly Pacific Islander high school. I was moved there in hopes of a fresh new start because my last high school wasn't the best for me. Everyone there was always asking me what I was ethnically, obviously because I was the new girl. Of course, I answered with "I'm Aboriginal & Tongan". They all knew I was half Aboriginal. Yet all they would do was throw the word "abo" around and be racist right in front of me... There was this girl who'd always say horrible things about Blakfullas then would look at me, laugh, and say "oh I wasn't talking to you, don't worry". But I knew she was. Another time I was walking to class and that same girl screamed out "ABO" to this other Blak boy. I felt horrible for him. There was only about 5 Blakfullas there including me ... Another time, someone was talking about a bad incident in class and I happened to overhear it. Apparently, the perpetrator was Aboriginal. Then some guy said, "bloody abos." As if we're some kind of disgusting group of people who all condone and do that stuff... that's the first time I've ever heard of something like that happen. All ethnic groups across the world [have their] good and bad ... (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Other incidents of racism at school were reported by friends and parents of children targeted.

> My friends were walking around school & other students called them "ab*s" whilst pointing at them. (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)

> My daughter was called coon by one of her peers. They were taking the piss out of each other, he called her ugly, so she called him Pugsley and he responded with well you're a coon. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

> My daughter is in year six at Primary School. The incident occurred during a lesson. The class was studying history and Aboriginal culture in particular when there were derogatory comments made by another child in the classroom. The class was watching a video on a corroboree when this child said it sounds like his parents when they are drunk at 3am. At another point during the lesson this same child referred to Aboriginal people as violent. At another point during the writing session that followed the same child asked the teacher for the name of the toy monkey with cymbals. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

Incidents also involved school staff. For instance, the last report above goes on to state that the teacher did not respond to the comments by the year six student.

> My daughter was very upset about the comments. Unfortunately, the teacher did not address any of the comments. It is uncertain if the teacher heard the first two comments, but my daughter was able to hear them and she was not at the same table as the child making these comments. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

Other incidents recounted individual staff *directly perpetrating* racism, not just failing to respond to it.

> It was while the yes, no Referendum was going on in 2023. It came up [as a] topic in class at school and the whole class including the teacher goes on saying why we don't deserve it etc. I was left feeling targeted. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> I was attending music class where the teacher referred to the blues music and its basis in slavery as "nigger music". (Self-report, Aboriginal, non-binary)

> Teacher of mental health refuses to do Acknowledgement of Country and tried to minimise the experiences of people and families that are a part of the Stolen Generation. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

> My 10 year old was told to write a narrative from the perspective of Captain Cook. When he raised [that] this was racist (alongside the other information the students are being taught about so called discovery and settlement of Australia), he was told this is your opinion. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

As noted previously, incidents perpetrated by individuals constitutes institutional racism where it demonstrates patterns of behaviour and/or where racism is poorly addressed by institutions or organisations. The failure by schools to respond to racism appropriately was called out in a number of reports.

> Child in grade 4 called another child a 'N____R' and the teacher heard it and did nothing. Victim then hit perpetrator and got in trouble. School wants each child to apologise to each other. End of story they said. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

> An Aboriginal friend told me about how her child has been called racist names at school multiple times. Despite multiple complaints the school were yet to do anything effective about it. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

The student whose music teacher used the 'N__' word in class also identifies a poor response to a complaint she lodged about the incident.

> ... I reported her for it making sure my identity as an Aboriginal was known specifically because everyone in the class was white or white passing and I wanted to put an emphasis on the harm that she's committing specifically when she thinks only white people are around. I was then subjected to a harassment campaign by her, her friends who were my other teachers and school faculty until I decided to drop her class, classes her friends taught, and eventually had to leave school entirely. The school said all they could do about it was make her apologise and they wouldn't do anything further. They also tried to act like forcing me to drop her class instead of punishing the racist was doing me a favour. (Self-report, Aboriginal, non-binary)

The parent who reported racism in a year 6 classroom described escalating a complaint – again, without a satisfactory outcome. This report identifies failure on the part of the school to take racism sufficiently seriously at a policy and practical level.

> I called the school that same day and asked to speak to the principal and teacher. I told the school that my child was very upset and did not want to return to the classroom, particularly since they were doing a series of lessons on Australian history and the racism was likely to continue. The principal called me back the next day at lunch time, which demonstrated a lack of concern about the matter. I asked to meet with the principal as a matter of urgency on the issue to discuss an anti-racism procedure for the school. The principal has confirmed that she cannot meet me for a week as she has meetings. She also said that of course the school has a policy on racism but did not know it offhand. The principal also said that she is really the middle person, between the teacher and the parent. I told the principal that I was happy to talk to the teacher but was reporting the racism higher up as it falls within the principal's remit. The principal was entirely

> unconcerned with the issue and was aware that my child did not want to return to her classroom as she felt unsafe. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

A similar account was shared to the Register by a witness.

> A young Indigenous 12 year old girl has been racially bullied at an eastern Victorian secondary school. She has been racially abused by multiple students including peers and friends. It has been a repeated cycle because she has reported it to the school who then only asks the offending student to write a letter of apology to the girl directly and is suspended. She has felt embarrassed and upset about her Indigenous heritage due to this. The racism has since stopped for approximately 3 weeks but she fears it may continue and that apologies are not enough to change people's racist behaviour and own internal racist thoughts. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

## 4.3 Other racism targeting children and young people

Social media/media related reports sometimes crossed over with school-based incidents. A report was made by a First Nations parent whose son saw an image online, which was content created by students at his school. The image depicted two girls: one in full Black-Face holding a sign that says 'I'm a <N> prostitute' (with the word fully spelled out); the other holding a sign that says 'I am Suicide Night' (with love hearts around it). We describe below at [4.5] what happened when this was reported to the school.

Another report identified a very 'light touch' response by a private school in the wake of racist social media posted by its students.

> ABC News report: An elite private school in WA, '[names school] received a complaint about the messages sent over the social media app Snapchat, then screenshots were circulated within the school community. The school became aware of the messages and due to its position as private independent institutions, was not required to notify the Department of Education or the WA minister for education. The ABC has chosen not to show the messages as they contain offensive depictions of Indigenous people. The messages contained racial slurs against Indigenous Australians, including references to suicide, sexual abuse, and alcohol use... [named school principal] told the ABC the school did not comment on student matters. "[Named school] is committed to fostering an inclusive, respectful learning environment for all students, from pre-kindergarten

> to year 12," she said. "We value diversity and the importance of learning from one another in a supportive way."[58] (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Social media/media related incidents involving victims aged 0-19 frequently cross over with criminal legal system related issues and stereotyping too. For example, the raising of past offending in the interview with the fishing competition winner (aged 19 at the time), which as noted, leant and fed into common stereotypes of First Nations young people as 'law breakers'. Other social media incidents reported similar stereotyping, as well as aggressive racism (threats of harm) that directly targeted First Nations young people alleged to have committed a crime.

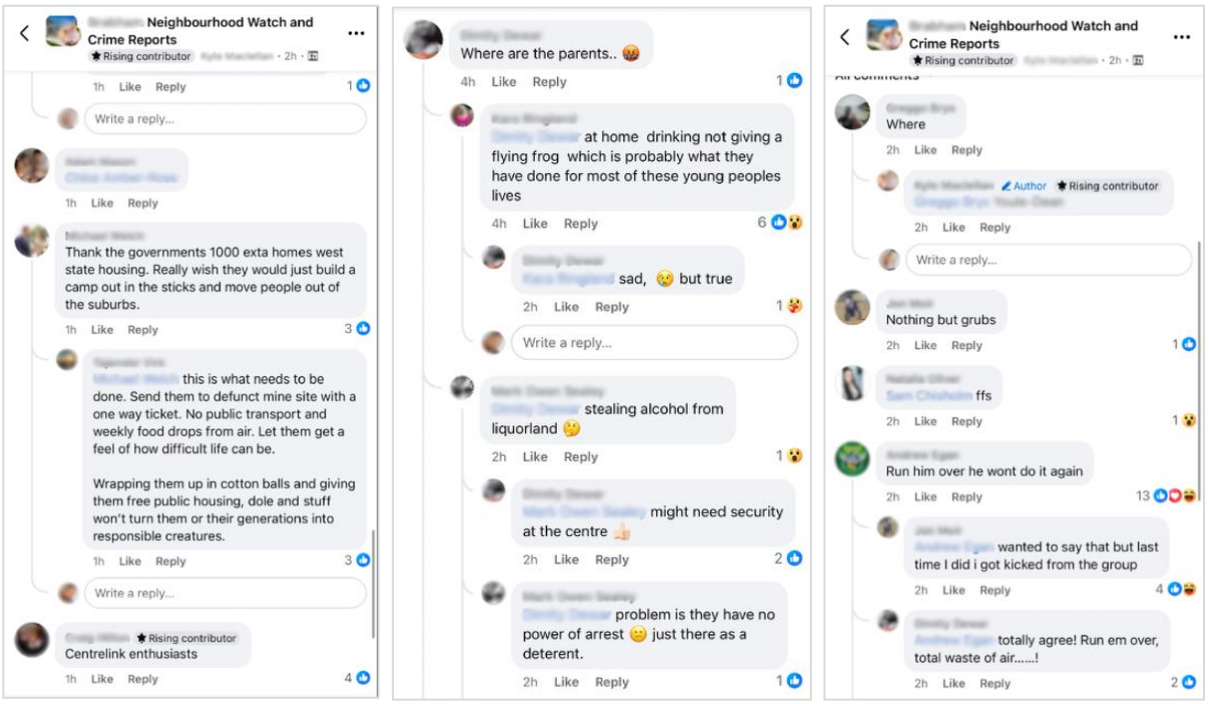
> Local [named town] community group using skin colour as the only descriptor of a 5 year old child they claim was attempting to steal a bike. Almost all [online] comments were blaming drug and alcohol addicted parents. Many suggesting that they would use a bat to discipline the 5 year old child. Others were writing the entire child's future off. Lots of grouping language such as they're all like this and other very thinly veiled racist remarks. Reported to group admins and no action was taken. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

> A person posted on the [named town] noticeboard a video of some youth breaking into a sushi shop. Two people commented and talked about how they could sniper them and shoot them. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

As the above illustrates, discussion online of alleged offending by young people can lead to (mass) racist commentary related to First Nations people in general. The following report from a First Nations person aged 0-19 included multiple screenshots of such commentary (see below).

> I am a member of a Facebook neighbourhood page for [named town]. There has been a photo put up of a group of young Aboriginal boys, one of them threw food at someone's car. This person has uploaded the images to Facebook and there has been a spill of violent and hate speech about the boys. Threats to run the boy over, and use of discriminatory words and descriptions about Aboriginal people. I have reported it a few times and nothing has happened. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

[58] See news link shared to the Register here: <https://www.abc.net.au/news/2025-02-18/elite-wa-school-condemns-racism/104747860>.




In discussion of the criminal legal system ([2.4.4]) and law, policy and practice ([2.3.3]) criminal law was identified as disproportionately impacting young First Nations people, with specific reference to bail laws and racial profiling by police.

As a specific example, over-policing with intrusive surveillance was reported by non-Indigenous witnesses concerned about increased deployment of night cameras in a local area, directly linked to the surveillance of First Nations children. Concerns were raised that young people were being criminalised and that children would be more fearful of police as a result. The witness reporting this incident addresses the broader implications for trust and wellbeing and the racialised nature of police surveillance towards First Nations children in the local community.

> Recently police have increased their surveillance of the youth, many of whom are First Nations children. They have set up night cameras and increased police presence. These kinds of tactics lead to the kids being more fearful and disdainful of police and police in turn being more likely to criminalise the kids. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Over-surveillance and racial profiling of young people arose in other reports. One report shared a link to media describing a police crackdown against young people in Far North QLD. The media story included an image, described as follows.[59]

[59] See news link shared to the Register here: <https://www.news.com.au/national/queensland/crime/police-taskforce-charges-54-cairns-youths-with-220-offences-in-weeklong-youth-crime-crackdown/news-story/479ea89fa959179d6fdbc494aa8aba56>.

> This is a deliberate act to humiliate and vilify all Indigenous youth, and the image was created to reflect old black & white historical images of Indigenous people in neck chains. This is all about trophies, not community safety. How much real physical harm have the captured youths caused and where is the pre-trial proof that justifies this treatment? The makeup of police forces is skewed towards white culture … (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

Other reports speak of online incidents that identify police violence against young people – and again, that this causes distrust of police amongst First Nations young people.

> [Named social media account] has a page dedicated to hate videos towards Indigenous people especially youth. He has shared a video that emerged last year of a 11 year old being slapped by a VIC pol officer after he spat on her, I have reported it to Facebook etc and nothing's been done … I work with high risk youth and cops do this, when we are told to tell [young people] to trust cops. This is hypocritical from the get-go. These cops clearly don't know how to work with you. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

As noted in [4.1], physical harm was proportionately more frequently reported as a type of racism experienced by children/young people.[60] Examples of this outside of policing include the following incident occurring in a public space.

> While walking along the road in the streets of [named town, QLD] it wasn't unusual for a car to swerve at you and scream racial slurs out the car. There was this one time that has stuck with me when 3 of my mates and myself were waking back from a school function and a white car swerved at us almost colliding and screaming "you filthy blacks". Luckily, we were aware of our area and was able to move quick away from the situation and run up a different street. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

One deeply concerning report described sexual assault against a child/young person (age not provided) in the workplace.

> I was given a job by the business owner for one reason only. He liked young boys. He raped me, then said who are they going to believe me a business owner and church elder or you a half cast. (Self-report, Aboriginal male)

Racist verbal abuse and hate speech targeting those aged 0-19 were also reported, one as young as three years of age.

[60] The difference was two to six percentage points higher compared to other age groups, see also Table 21 in Appendix A.

> A 3-year old Aboriginal girl was wearing a Disney Princess Elsa dress when another lady with two daughters had told her that she was "Black" and "Black is ugly", hence she couldn't be Elsa. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> A young 9 year old boy was racially taunted by his [named sports organisation] teammates, he stated they called him "monkey" and they started driving by his home and calling him racial slurs. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)
>
> My son was playing Football for [named junior football club, VIC] when a racial comment was said to another player on our Team about my son, a comment that is heart breaking for the two young fullas involved, my son the victim and his team player. A player from [another named club] had walked up to one of our players and said a comment “is that [named individual] the coon from your school”. This racism is disgusting and very disturbing**.** (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

Racism occurring in commercial places described stereotyping – once again related to First Nations young people as offenders. One report below pertains to sales staff and another to store staff, security guards and police as perpetrators. There is further discussion of violence perpetrated against young people (based on stereotypes related to alleged criminality) at [2.4.4].

> I am a long time Carer for an Indigenous Boy who is now 15. I went to [named chain department store] in [named shopping centre, WA] with him and 2 Friends and another young boy to buy the little one a gift. While I was being served the boys walked ahead and the Sales Assistant turned to the Lady serving me and asked, “do you think they looked sus”? I quickly said they were with me and were not stealing and the older lady repeated it was the way they were walking - one of them was recovering from a broken leg! I said to her they walk like that because that is what people expect them to do and pleaded for compassion and less racism. I phoned the Centre Manager to lodge a complaint but was unable to speak to the Store Manager. I was very distressed and my Boy said, "don’t worry it happens all the time" (Friend/Relative report, non-Indigenous)
>
> I witnessed an instance of interpersonal and institutional racism the other day at [named chain department store]. A young Indigenous boy (14) maybe was exiting the store when he was asked to stop and present his receipt. I witnessed him state, 'They didn’t have the charger I need' … he hadn’t purchased anything. The white male staff member immediately accused him of stealing. I interfered because this young boy was telling the truth, had showed his pockets, showed his bag everything. The staff member said that he had to stay until the police arrived because a security member had seen him stealing. I asked, what security and he said he got a message on his phone. At this point it was evident he was making this up to stall the young boy into waiting for the cops. A security guard from the shopping centre came and stood in to stop him from leaving and I reminded them

> it was illegal to detain a child like this. Eventually the police came. They gave him a warning. Yet there was absolutely NO evidence of him stealing anything. This is racial profiling. It is racist and it is harmful for everyone especially young children. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

We have earlier discussed reports of racism in the child protection system at [2.3.3]. The following is an incident reporting physical and verbal abuse, neglect and other harsh treatment of a young First Nations man in a residential unit (in the care of the state) - again, quite disturbing in nature. The young person is identified as being 'criminalised' rather than cared for.

> Worked alongside a young [Aboriginal] man who was placed in a residential unit under child protection. He was repeatedly shamed by the residential workers for being Aboriginal and often called "a piece of shit". Staff intentionally treated him so poorly to make him abscond so they wouldn't have to look at him. That was a stated mission. He was also assaulted but written up in incident reports as being the perpetrator. They wouldn't give him food. They didn't clothe him. They wouldn't treat his health conditions. He was given no pocket money. Importantly, no effort was made to foster his connection with culture & community. None whatsoever. And any talk about First Nations culture & people were put negatively. The discourse typically depicted Aboriginal people as lesser humans & alcoholics. The residential staff would also repeatedly shame him for allegedly getting 'special treatment' because he was Aboriginal. They publicly bagged him in front of the other kids for being eligible for Centrelink but then wouldn't fill in the forms for him to access it! With no money & no safe housing, here was a kid under the care of the state who slept in a city park & begged to get by. His rap sheet was huge but full of the stupidest pettiest offences like shoplifting food and clothes. Basically - he was being criminalised instead of being cared for & blamed for the outcome. (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

## 4.4 Emotional and other impacts

Feelings of anger (20%), disappointment (16%) and frustration (15%) are the more common emotional responses to racism for those aged 0-19 (see Figure B below and Table F in Appendix B). These are the same most common responses reported across all age groups (34%, combined), but they are identified at higher rates for those aged 0-19 (51%, combined).

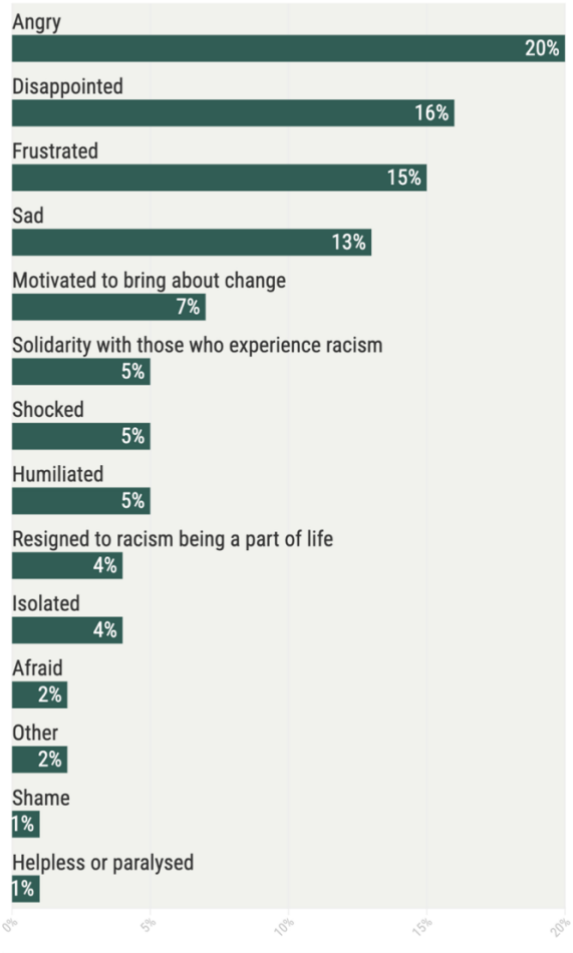
Sadness is proportionally more commonly reported for this group too compared with other age groups (13%, compared with 6% across all groups) (Table 28, Appendix A). As one example, the young person reporting feeling a hate vibe everywhere they go identified as an emotional response, 'Made me think I wasn't welcomed or needed. Made me feel low' (self-report, Aboriginal).

Anger arose as a response to school-based incidents, for instance. The following comments relate to the above reported incidents involving a year 4 student calling another student a 'N__r' (with a poor response from school staff) and being told that Aboriginal students have access too many programs.

> Anger as mother of victim shared experience with me as she was traumatised as the parent and needed support. Victim was angry, confused and shocked. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

> It made me feel upset, I didn't know why people hated me and my culture so much. I was frustrated. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

**Figure B Emotional responses to racism targeting children and young people**




Source: Table F Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the racism for incidents targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

It is also clear that emotional responses following incidents targeting younger people were clearly felt across the entire family unit, including in the case of the year 6 classroom incident – said to have impacted 'Relationships in the classroom and the school. Emotional impact for my child and myself [and my] family' (friend/relative report, Aboriginal).

Concerns were raised by parents too about the wellbeing of their children following racist incidents reported to the Register, regardless of whether they were directly targeted.

> The constant stereotyping of Aboriginal people needs to stop. I have 3 Aboriginal children and the fact that they are going to have to keep dealing with this is extremely concerning. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Concerns for children and young people arose following social media incidents targeting First Nations people in general, as an example.

> Makes me angry and disappointed to be living in a town with such hatred. Makes me fearful of if they will do anything when I'm in ACCO (Aboriginal community controlled organisation) work uniform being employed there. And if my kids are safe at sport. (Self-report, Aboriginal)

> Social and emotionally it has been difficult because I live within this community and have two children so to think this is how people behave in this suburb is worrying. (Witness report, Aboriginal)

Shame, and long-standing feelings of isolation and distrust were named by the Aboriginal and Pacific Islander woman who reported school-based racism. She also identifies skipping school and significant levels of sadness and pain.

> Being at that school made me feel so [much] shame. It's so crazy that I felt and still feel so unwanted in my own country! (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

> The feeling I was feeling was so disgusting. It's hard to describe!! I've never felt so lonely and hurt. I couldn't bare it anymore. Eventually I started skipping school. It turned into skipping school for a few days, then weeks, then months. I couldn't do it anymore. Walking into a place I felt unwanted was so hard to do. My mum could see I was struggling. We tried everything. But it was close to the end of the year anyway, so I was told to just hold on a little while longer ... Not to mention I was also being bullied and harassed everyday by boys too. I was So miserable. I wanted to kill myself. These dark parts of my life are something I'll always be scarred by as a young Aboriginal woman. The people they speak so sickeningly of are literally me, my family, ancestors, and everything I've ever known growing up! To really hear how people spoke about us in real life really broke my heart, especially coming from my Islander side. I couldn't stand it. I never understood the hate. Never in my life have I felt more disgraceful and unwelcomed as an Indigenous person on my own country! (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

Others also reported interrupted education following school-based racism and long-term educational impacts.

> It forced me to have to drop out of school, to this day I still haven't completed my schooling and I have a fear of teachers and people who were supposed to help me and support me. (Self-report, Aboriginal, non-binary)

> I was upset as my child loves school and the lack of professionalism from the teacher and principal has created a situation where an Aboriginal child who loves school now does not want to attend because the school is unsafe for an Aboriginal person. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)

Further school-related reports described educational and health/wellbeing impacts as follows.

> Because of how long he kept dragging it on it really impacted my mental health which then impacted my physical health. I couldn't stop thinking about what if I'm not deserving to call myself Aboriginal, you know? What if this is just something that I don't deserve. What if I'm just a really horrible person for calling myself that

even though I don't look it. And then I started to just get really depressed and hide in my room, and it just really impacted my physical health a lot. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

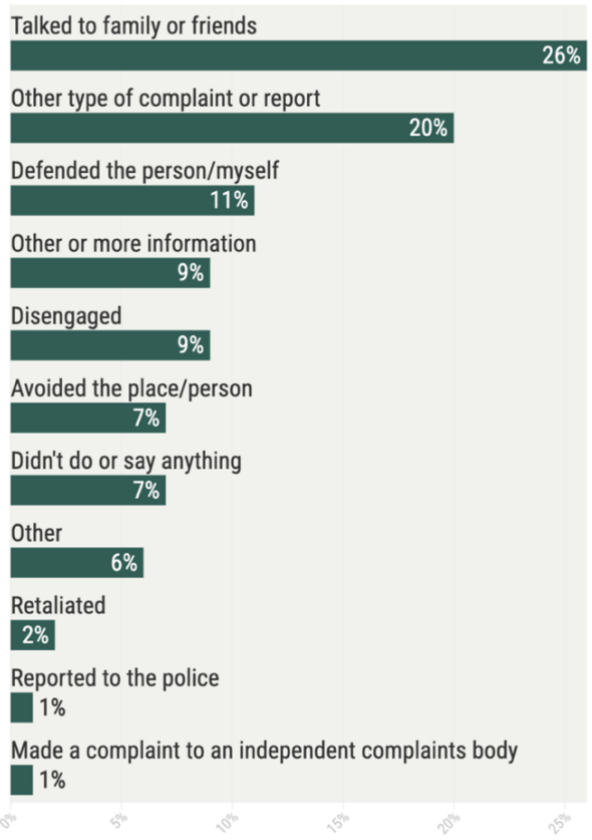
Many people questioned my Aboriginality. Made me go into a state of major anxiety and depression. Attendance percentage at school dropped from in the high 90 to the low 50's. I got diagnosed by GP with Bi-Polar Disorder, Depression and General Anxiety Disorder, Started abusing Cannabis and Vaping, Smoking and Alcohol. (Self-report, Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander male)

The young First Nations man who was sexually assaulted at his workplace also identified a range of significant consequences, including never being able to 'trust anyone in authority','Depression anxiety, suicide attempts. Never able to work anywhere for [any] length' of time. Further impacts include being 'Lost financially' and having 'turned to drugs alcohol'. This is a further example of how racism has multi-layered impacts.

## 4.5 Responding to racism

Talking to friends/family was identified as a response in 26% of reports involving incidents impacting those aged 0-19, followed by 'other type of complaint/report' (20%) and 'defending self/another' (11%) (see Figure C and Table G in Appendix B). These responses are proportionally similar to those across all age groups, though 'other type of complaint or report' was highest proportionately for incidents impacting those aged 0-19 (see also Table 31 in Appendix A).

**Figure C Responses to racism targeting children and young people**



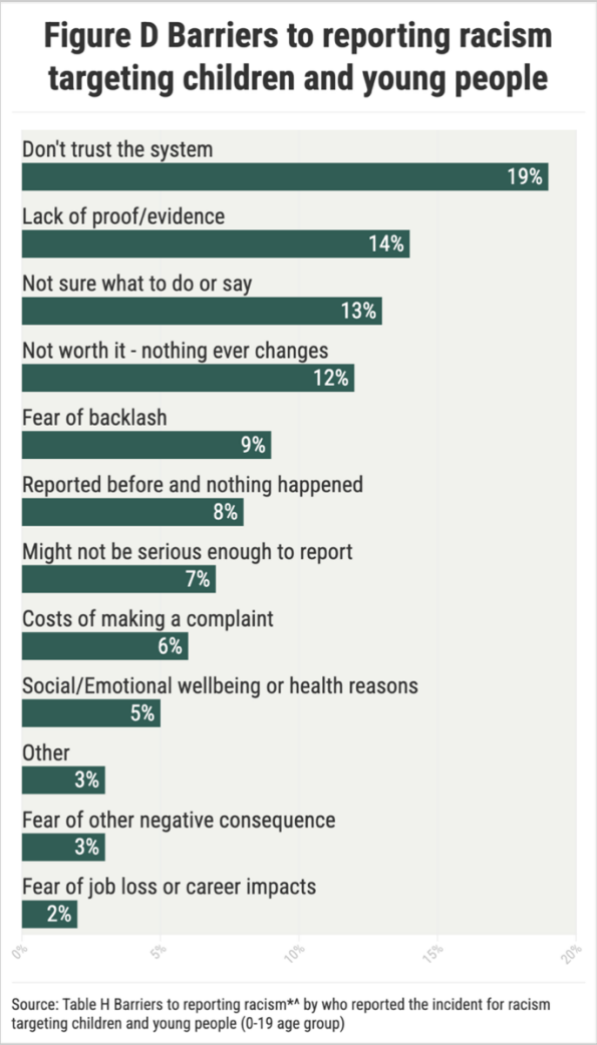

Source: Table G Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident for racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

Examples of 'other type of report or complaint' or 'other action' include a report that describes the family's response to the blackface post made by students (see above at [4.3]). In this instance, positive outcomes were achieved. We note that this comment advocates for strategies discussed above: greater individual and institutional accountability (including via development and implementation of policy) and education about rights/responsibilities.

> My son witnessed this image that was on social media from a student in his year. He complained to the school principal. She initially said to him they cannot do anything as it was done outside of school. He said well my family will press charges. My husband was then called by the principal in the afternoon. She asked us how we wanted the situation managed. We have said the school should suspend the student and then the principal write a letter to all the families/students saying that a situation of racism has taken place and this behaviour will not be tolerated and students will be suspended etc. Hopefully these recommendations will be activated though so much more needs to be done around management of racism in schools and then consequences for students. If we didn't follow this up and apply pressure nothing would have happened. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

One school-based report identifies leaning into culture as a positive, proactive or response to racism.

> I am working with the teacher to support my child better in the classroom. I am also working with my daughter to understand racism and to develop resilience and love in her cultural identity. (Friend/Relative report, Aboriginal)




Responses also sometimes involved avoidance or disengagement. We see this, for instance, in children and young people disengaging from school, described above.

Those reporting incidents involving younger people were most likely to identify as barriers to reporting racism 'don't trust the system' (19%), followed by lack of proof/evidence (14%), being 'not sure what to do/say' (13%) and 'not worth it' (12%). (See Figure D and Table H in Appendix B).

Relevant to lack of trust are poor responses by schools to racism. As one further example of this, the Aboriginal and Pacific Islander student reporting racism spoke of inadequate responses by school staff, in response to a report of racism.

> I even went to the school counsellor about it, and of course she did nothing but dismiss & invalidate my feelings all because I admitted I was skipping school! That was all that was important to her. She could never understand why I was skipping and how I felt! She was white of course. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The young man who was sexually assaulted at work also identified reporting the incident to police, 'government, even Royal Commission into Child Sexual Abuse'. 'Nothing done' (self-report, Aboriginal male).

Being unsure of what to do or say is evident in the response by the mother to the incident involving verbal racial abuse of her son in a sports setting. She reports feeling 'isolated', having 'nowhere to turn to for support' – not to the club in question or the 'Sports Minister'.

We discuss above how social media and other incidents that may not target young First Nations people can still give rise to fear for their safety and wellbeing. Similarly, fear for children/young people presented as a barrier for adults to take action against racism. The mother whose team manager asked about her being a 'half-caste' and who missed out on a team manager role discussed feeling unsafe calling this out because of repercussions against her children.

> I have children … who play and [it] can impact their sporting opportunities. Nearly a year on I did mention to wellness officer for state academy and head coach of [named sports team] and the head coach gave me [an] email. But it's not safe as we girls gave feedback at exit meeting – my youngest, 15 at the time, had four adults on panel. Now is treated less favourably. Also is in State 18 coming back from injury and another athlete in same program [was] looked after and my daughter dropped to U18's and not league [sic]. The head Coach does not speak to her. And not given the same equal opportunities as the non-Aboriginal athlete. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

This report continues as follows, demonstrating the importance of providing a safe (anonymous) space through which incidents can be reported (Call It Out).

> I didn't know I could report. Still feel uneasy – worried girls will be impacted if I bring to attention. I did not write a letter as its unsafe and we were having a referendum. It's not safe to even truth tell. I'm writing this. I will go over [the] draft as I just came across this app. Thank you 😭 Ps please protect us it's not safe this is one incident and have another and know of other stories - also in education. (Self-report, Aboriginal female)

The worker reporting the above neglect and abuse of a First Nations young person in care also reported consequences of calling it out – clearly demonstrating why people might be fearful of doing so.

When he gave me permission to make an abuse in care 'allegation' I was given no more shifts. No racism to see here they said. Shame on the child protection system! (Witness report, non-Indigenous)

# 5. Conclusion

This is our third Annual Report on Call it Out. It presents detailed accounts of racism shared to the Call It Out Register between March 2024 to March 2025. The Register's distinctive approach allows not only those who directly experience racism, but also friends, relatives, and bystanders, to document these events. Call It Out stands as a unique archive and resource in providing a comprehensive record that amplifies the voices of those affected and those witnessing racism. As we note in the Introduction, racism can take many forms. However, the Call it Out archive allows us to see both the patterns and the particularities of racism against First Nations people. There are many similarities between the racism identified in this Report with previous years (for example, workplace racism, online and social media racism) and also particularities in this reporting period (for example, an increase reports involving First Nations children and young people).

This Report draws on 442 documented incidents of racism targeting Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people. Over half of these reports (56%) originated from witnesses, while a third (35%) were submitted by the First Nations people who were directly impacted. The remaining 9% were reported by friends or relatives. The register's secure online reporting system enables individuals to share their experiences, detailing the emotions, physical impacts, and broader consequences of racism. These personal narratives are crucial for identifying the multi-layered nature and patterns of racism at all levels: interpersonal, institutional and structural. Importantly, the narratives document and help us to understand the extensive and profound effects on those subjected to racism. They also inform strategies to combat racism.

A recurring theme throughout the incidents of racism analysed in this Report is the urgent need for accountability and education. Respondents emphasised the importance of collective efforts, suggesting that more support like Call It Out should be established and that solutions are rooted in unity and collaboration. The emotional impacts recorded in the Register are significant and varied: anger, sadness, fear, emptiness, constant shame, the relentless need to prove oneself, and exhaustion from the persistent weight of racism. Disrespect and disdain were cited, alongside frustration in professional environments where individuals felt they were not recognised as 'Blak enough'. Such emotional tolls often culminate in moments of vulnerability, such as sitting alone in a car crying at the end of the day, overwhelmed by the continual need for self-justification.

The cumulative effect of ongoing racism is further illustrated by a First Nations woman who described feeling invisible while shopping because she failed to receive any assistance, 'some may think it's a minor thing but that small act made a big impact on me and my mental well-being'. It resulted in depression and a sense of isolation. These experiences are rarely isolated; for many, they represent a daily struggle with little hope for tangible support. The absence of effective remedies prompts some to ignore racism

altogether, as exemplified by a First Nations person who left a government job, citing a lack of support for Aboriginal people. Nonetheless, the register also documents the resilience and motivation of individuals who persistently call out racism and actively support Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people in leading solutions to systemic issues, including over-incarceration.

The report's guest author with lived experience of racism, 17-year-old Amelia Whyman, offers a perspective shaped by courage and spiritual connection to her ancestors. Her narrative shows the generational trauma perpetuated by racism and the importance of creating safe spaces for collaboration and learning. She expresses a desire for equality and a future where standing up to racism is no longer necessary. The importance of education and accountability is reiterated as essential for meaningful change and healing.

Our analysis reveals that anger is the most common emotional response to racism across all reports to the Register (22%), followed by disappointment (14%), frustration (13%), and motivation to bring about change (11%). Those who self-reported incidents of racism and reports from friends or relatives are more likely to reflect feelings of humiliation and isolation than those from witnesses. Notably, sadness is the predominant emotional response to incidents targeting children and young people (13%), while motivation to instigate change is more frequently identified in cases involving individuals aged 50 and above (15%).

The nature of racism described in this Report reveals that just over a third of incidents were experienced as interpersonal racism (34%). Approximately a third (33%) involved both interpersonal and systemic/institutional racism, while more than one in five (21%) were categorised as solely systemic/institutional. The Register acknowledges that racism can manifest across multiple forms and categories, and individuals may relate their experiences to more than one type. Our Report highlights cases where a single incident encompasses different forms of racism, such as interpersonal racism perpetrated by a university student and systemic racism reflected in the institution's inadequate response.

Stereotyping emerged as the most prevalent form of racism reported (30%), followed by verbal abuse or hate speech (17%), bullying, threats or intimidation (12%), discriminatory laws, policies, or practices (12%), and failure to recognise cultural rights or protocols (11%). The persistent nature of stereotyping was underscored by its ongoing presence across various environments. Media representation was key concern, with reports calling out the negative portrayal and deliberate targeting of First Nations people in news coverage. Multiple reports detailed the perpetuation of racist stereotypes by mainstream media, on social media and online platforms, with individuals sharing screenshots of harmful, violent and deeply racist content circulated online. As

highlighted in our earlier Reports, racist attitudes and stereotyping underpin racism in many contexts in which it arises.

Aggressive racism, comprising verbal abuse (17%), bullying, threats, intimidation (12%), physical harm (3%), and property damage (1%), accounted for a significant proportion (33%) of all reported incidents and constituted 35% of ongoing cases. Intimidation and harassment were evident in personal and real-life contexts, such as a non-Aboriginal neighbour racially abusing and driving an elderly aunt to leave her public housing. Shunning and exclusion were identified in reports, particularly in public transport and commercial spaces. The impacts of such exclusion were profound, leading individuals to avoid certain places, leave employment, or withdraw from educational settings following racist incidents.

This year, the Register included 'law, policies and practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes' as a new category of racism, identified in 12% of all reports. Witnesses expressed concern about bureaucratic barriers that impede efforts to support Aboriginal clients. Education policies, particularly in the Northern Territory, were criticised for failing to account for cultural reasons behind student absences, resulting in inaccurate records and reduced funding. Criminal laws, such as Victoria's bail laws, were also highlighted for their foreseeable adverse effects on First Nations people. In these examples, racist *intent* may not always be obvious, although the effects demonstrate institutional or systemic racism.

Government institutions were criticised for tokenistic efforts, such as establishing Reconciliation Action Plans and cultural safety frameworks that lack genuine community engagement and consultation. Mining and health companies were specifically mentioned for policies that do not align with actual practices. The deceptive practice of 'Black cladding', where organisations falsely present themselves as Indigenous owned, was called out for undermining authentic Aboriginal enterprises and depriving genuine businesses of opportunities.

The child protection system was also scrutinised for systemic failures in working inappropriately with First Nations families and communities, as well as non-compliance with policies designed to protect First Nations rights and cultural recognition. Lack of accountability remains a persistent issue. Reports again highlighted the non-recognition of Indigenous sovereignty, cultural, and spiritual connections to land and country, with an ongoing resistance to acknowledgements and Welcome to Country ceremonies.

Racism was documented across diverse settings, including workplaces, beauty salons, universities, licensed clubs, saunas, health facilities, public transport and institutions. In general, social media and online platforms were the most common reported locations for incidents of racism (22%), followed by workplaces (11%) and educational settings (10%). However, First Nations people who self reported directly experiencing racism

most frequently reported experiences of racism in workplace environments (15%), followed by social media (13%) and education settings (12%).

Racism was also identified in public settings, in commercial settings and on public transport. First Nations people travelling on public transport were subject to over-surveillance and discriminatory behaviour. Aggressive racism accounted for 42% of public setting incidents, 32% of commercial place incidents, and 45% of public transport incidents. Shunning and exclusion were most frequently reported in commercial locations (14%) and public transport (15%). Being subjected to intense scrutiny or over-visibility in commercial spaces was a recurring theme, leading to avoidance of certain places and employment withdrawal.

Multiple reports this year addressed racism within the criminal legal system, with incidents in 'justice/legal settings' comprising 6% of all reports. There is a particular focus in our Report on police responses to First Nations victims of crime, including failure to investigate assaults, as well as dehumanising practices such as invasive searches, excessive force, unnecessary use of arrest, racist abuse and targeting, and institutional neglect of a duty of care. Institutional actions, such as police extinguishing fires at Camp Sovereignty, exemplified systemic racism and bias in law enforcement. Historic patterns of exclusion, such as barring young people from public places like swimming pools, were also referenced.

Many reports to Call It Out included multiple incidents experienced or witnessed by the same individual, often spanning years and generations. This suggests that the register's figures significantly undercount the true prevalence of racism. Of the 369 respondents to an optional question, just under half (47%) reported multiple incidents, with First Nations people more likely to do so (54%) than friends/relatives (44%) or witnesses (43%). More than half of all incidents occurred recently (within the last three months), while nearly a quarter were ongoing (22%). Friend/relative reports and self-reports were more likely to identify ongoing racism (33% and 27%, respectively) compared to witness reports (18%). Aggressive racism constituted 35% of ongoing cases.

Racism targeting First Nations people is entrenched, endemic, and difficult to capture statistically. The Register's questions about incident frequency and duration offer some insight. However, the complexity of lived experiences – of single incidents with multiple layers, of recurring events across locations, and of intergenerational trauma – requires ongoing attention. Historical references, such as a taxi driver's use of the term 'natives' and accounts from First Nations women in government workplaces, shops and supermarkets, and of Aboriginal children being removed from a public swimming pool, illustrate the persistence of harmful stereotypes and policies of racial segregation from past to present.

A significant finding of our Report was that more than a quarter of all reports to the Register involved children and young people (aged 0-19) as victims, signalling the profound impact of racism on this group. There was an increase in reports involving racism in schools and educational institutions compared to previous years. Media, social media and online locations (31%) and schools and educational institutions (30%) were the most commonly identified location involving children and young people.

Children and young people were more likely to experience bullying, threats, intimidation, physical harm than other age groups. Where gender and age were noted, children and young people victims were more likely to be male. Children and young people were proportionally more likely to be targeted by perpetrators in their own age bracket. Reports to the Register highlighted the failure of schools to respond effectively to racist behaviour, with repeated complaints going unaddressed. Other incidents included police targeting children, racist social media posts, and offensive depictions shared within schools. The emotional impacts for children and young people included anger (20%), disappointment (16%), frustration (15%), and sadness (13%), with proportionally higher rates of these type of responses compared to other age groups.

In general, the most commonly identified perpetrators of racism were strangers (26%), employees or workers (25%), and institutions or organisations as a whole (20%). As noted above, children and young people were disproportionately affected by racism in schools (30%) and media/online platforms (31%). For those aged 50 and above, media/online was also the most common location of racist incidents (31%). Individuals in the 30-39 and 40-49 age brackets were more likely to experience racism in the workplace (20% and 17%, respectively).

The impacts of racism were severe, including homelessness, mental health issues such as PTSD, and suicidal ideation. The lack of effective responses to challenges posed by racism contributes to long-term harm, with some individuals reporting suicide attempts, financial loss, and substance abuse as consequences. The multi-layered impacts of racism are illustrated by the account of a young First Nations man who was sexually assaulted in his workplace, resulting in lasting consequences such as loss of trust in authority, depression, anxiety, suicide attempts, inability to maintain employment, financial hardship, and substance abuse. These narratives demonstrate the pervasive and enduring harm caused by racism.

The most frequent response to racism was seeking support from family or friends (26% females, 24% males), consistent with previous annual reports. Males were more likely to disengage (14% compared to 9% females), while females were more likely to report directly to organisations or internal HR (13% compared to 8% males).

The barriers to reporting racism were significant, with the most common being a lack of trust in the system (16%). Other frequently identified barriers included having reported before without any action taken (12%), uncertainty about what to do or say (11%), and a

belief that reporting is futile (10%). For incidents targeting children and young people, distrust of the system was the most common barrier (19%), while fear of job loss was more prevalent among adults aged 30-39 (11%). These interconnected barriers – distrust, perceived futility, and previous inaction – collectively accounted for 38% of responses and reflect systemic failures to address racism adequately.

Solutions identified for combating racism included First Nations Sovereignty (self-determination, land back, reparations) and increasing understanding of First Nations culture and history (both 14%). In combination with stronger legal protections and penalties for racism, these strategies comprised over a third of all responses (40%). For reports from friends or relatives, the most common solutions were educating the community on how to stand up against racism (16%), stronger legal protections (14%), and increasing public awareness about the impacts of racism on First Nations people (12%). Age-based differences were observed in preferred solutions: those aged 40-49 prioritised stronger legal protections (13%), while those aged 20-29 equally emphasised education campaigns and sovereignty (both 16%).

The shared responsibility for combating racism was evident throughout the reports, with some individuals reluctant to act and others actively engaging through listening, learning, and speaking up. Calls for enhanced protections and stricter penalties were reiterated, including more severe consequences for perpetrators. Public education and awareness strategies accounted for 39% of responses, encompassing increased understanding of First Nations culture (14%), community education on anti-racism (10%), public awareness campaigns (7%), legal and ethical responsibilities (5%), and empowering First Nations people to use the law (3%). Prioritising First Nations sovereignty and amplifying First Nations-led responses was highlighted as a key strategy (34%).

Our Report affirms that the struggle against racism is collective and ongoing, demanding accountability, education, and the amplification of First Nations voices. The commitment to truth-telling, recognition of generational trauma, and the pursuit of solutions led by First Nations people are essential for a future where equality and respect prevail. The enduring message of the call it out report is clear: the elimination of racism against Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people requires determined action, shared responsibility, and First Nation led solutions and accountability in responding to racism.

Call It Out is committed to ensuring every voice and story is heard. The individual stories shared each year not only highlight the prevalence of racism across all spaces in society, but also addresses the importance of unity, accountability, and education. The ultimate conclusion of our Report this year is that while the evidence of racism is overwhelming, the pathway to elimination lies in the collective societal commitment to support those who speak out, translating their experiences into irreversible systemic change and effective and enforced processes for accountability. Amelia Whyman clearly and powerfully defined at the start of this report the necessary path forward, the ideal

environment where: ‘People look at another person and think they are just another person, I don’t need to say anything about their cultural background, and that people don’t offend each other – where they see each other as equals’. Amelia’s vision demands an unwavering commitment of every individual to challenge and call out racism.

# 6. Appendices

## 6.1 Appendix A: Data Tables 2024 –2025

### Table 1 Background of the person who reported the incident

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Non-Indigenous | 225 | 51 |
| Aboriginal | 186 | 42 |
| Prefer not to say | 18 | 4 |
| Both Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander | 10 | 2 |
| Torres Strait Islander | 3 | 1 |
| **Total** | **442** | **100** |

Respondents N=442.

### Table 2 Who reported the incident by background of the person who reported the racism*

| | Aboriginal and/or Torres Strait Islander | | Non-Indigenous | | Prefer not to say | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Witness of racism towards a First Nations person/peoples | 37 | 15 | 199 | 80 | 12 | 5 | **248** | **100** |
| First Nations person who experienced racism | 148 | 95 | 3 | 2 | 4 | 3 | **155** | **100** |
| Friend or relative of a First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | 14 | 36 | 23 | 59 | 2 | 5 | **39** | **100** |

Respondents N=442.

*Note data validity issues for three self-reports identifying as non-Indigenous

### Table 3 Geographic location of reported incidents

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| New South Wales | 81 | 28 |
| Queensland | 47 | 16 |
| Victoria | 45 | 16 |
| Western Australia | 43 | 15 |
| South Australia | 31 | 11 |
| Northern Territory | 28 | 10 |
| Australian Capital Territory | 6 | 2 |
| Tasmania | 4 | 1 |
| **Total** | **285** | **100** |

Respondents N=285.

**Table 4 How the incident was experienced or witnessed by who reported the racism**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Interpersonal racism | 47 | 30 | 16 | 41 | 88 | 35 | 151 | 34 |
| Both (interpersonal and systemic/institutional racism) | 61 | 39 | 12 | 31 | 71 | 29 | 144 | 33 |
| Systemic/Institutional racism | 33 | 21 | 11 | 28 | 47 | 19 | 91 | 21 |
| Other | 14 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 42 | 17 | 56 | 13 |
| **Total** | **155** | **100** | **39** | **100** | **248** | **100** | **442** | **100** |

Respondents N=442.

**Table 5 Type of racism experienced or witnessed* by who reported the racism**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 102 | 24 | 21 | 25 | 180 | 37 | 303 | 30 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 60 | 14 | 18 | 22 | 97 | 20 | 175 | 17 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 59 | 14 | 10 | 12 | 54 | 11 | 123 | 12 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 56 | 13 | 10 | 12 | 50 | 10 | 116 | 12 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols (e.g. Kinship, Sorry Business, Acknowledgement of Country) | 53 | 12 | 5 | 6 | 56 | 11 | 114 | 11 |
| Shunning you or excluding you (e.g. refusing service) | 46 | 11 | 8 | 10 | 20 | 4 | 74 | 7 |
| Other | 28 | 7 | 5 | 6 | 18 | 4 | 51 | 5 |
| Physical harm (e.g. abuse, assault) | 15 | 3 | 6 | 7 | 14 | 3 | 35 | 3 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 11 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 1 | 14 | 1 |
| **Total** | **430** | **100** | **83** | **100** | **492** | **100** | **1005** | **100** |

Respondents N=442; Responses N=1005.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism.

**Table 6 Location where the racism happened* by who reported the racism**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Social media or online (e.g. FaceBook, TikTok, blog) | 40 | 13 | 2 | 4 | 115 | 33 | 157 | 22 |
| Workplace | 47 | 15 | 6 | 12 | 27 | 8 | 80 | 11 |
| School/Educational setting (e.g. pre-school, TAFE, university) | 37 | 12 | 11 | 22 | 23 | 7 | 71 | 10 |
| Commercial setting (e.g. bank, shop, club, hotel, mall) | 22 | 7 | 4 | 8 | 27 | 8 | 53 | 8 |
| Public setting (e.g. street, park, sports event, rally) | 25 | 8 | 4 | 8 | 21 | 6 | 50 | 7 |
| Other media (e.g. TV, radio, news, website) | 12 | 4 | 2 | 4 | 34 | 10 | 48 | 7 |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting (e.g. policing, court or prison) | 22 | 7 | 5 | 10 | 18 | 5 | 45 | 6 |
| Health setting (e.g. hospital or medical centre) | 22 | 7 | 2 | 4 | 15 | 4 | 39 | 6 |
| Private setting (e.g. your home, family or friend's home) | 16 | 5 | 6 | 12 | 14 | 4 | 36 | 5 |
| Interacting with other government institution or service provider (e.g. Centrelink, NDIS) | 14 | 5 | 3 | 6 | 18 | 5 | 35 | 5 |
| Public transport (e.g. bus, taxi, Uber) | 16 | 5 | 2 | 4 | 10 | 3 | 28 | 4 |
| Other | 16 | 5 | 3 | 6 | 8 | 2 | 27 | 4 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation or service provider (e.g. charity, support services, church) | 11 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 7 | 2 | 18 | 3 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 7 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 8 | 2 | 16 | 2 |
| **Total** | **307** | **100** | **51** | **100** | **345** | **100** | **703** | **100** |

Respondents N= 442; Responses N=703.

* Data includes multiple responses for location where the racism happened.

**Table 7 Location where the racism happened* by type of racism experienced and witnessed***

| | Cultural rights/ protocols | | Shunning, excluding | | Laws, policies, practices | | Negative attitudes, stereotyping | | Bullying, threats, intimidation | | Verbal abuse/hate speech | | Physical harm | | Property damage, graffiti, vandalism | | Other | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Social media/online | 37 | 9 | 15 | 4 | 28 | 7 | 130 | 33 | 53 | 13 | 93 | 24 | 14 | 4 | 5 | 1 | 18 | 5 | **393** | **100** |
| Workplace | 34 | 14 | 30 | 12 | 37 | 15 | 53 | 22 | 38 | 16 | 26 | 11 | 10 | 4 | 4 | 2 | 12 | 5 | **244** | **100** |
| School/Educational setting | 26 | 14 | 21 | 11 | 21 | 11 | 41 | 22 | 25 | 13 | 33 | 18 | 8 | 4 | 2 | 1 | 11 | 6 | **188** | **100** |
| Public setting | 16 | 10 | 14 | 9 | 18 | 12 | 34 | 22 | 20 | 13 | 28 | 18 | 11 | 7 | 6 | 4 | 7 | 5 | **154** | **100** |
| Commercial setting | 15 | 10 | 21 | 14 | 21 | 14 | 41 | 27 | 16 | 11 | 24 | 16 | 6 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 4 | 3 | **151** | **100** |
| Health setting | 21 | 16 | 17 | 13 | 22 | 16 | 31 | 23 | 16 | 12 | 14 | 10 | 5 | 4 | 2 | 1 | 7 | 5 | **135** | **100** |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting | 21 | 16 | 12 | 9 | 33 | 24 | 26 | 19 | 14 | 10 | 13 | 10 | 7 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 6 | 4 | **135** | **100** |
| Interacting with other government institution/service | 26 | 19 | 17 | 13 | 23 | 17 | 22 | 16 | 16 | 12 | 13 | 10 | 7 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 7 | 5 | **134** | **100** |
| Other media | 15 | 12 | 8 | 6 | 17 | 13 | 39 | 31 | 18 | 14 | 17 | 13 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 6 | 5 | **126** | **100** |
| Private setting | 15 | 13 | 10 | 9 | 11 | 10 | 29 | 25 | 12 | 11 | 20 | 18 | 9 | 8 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 3 | **114** | **100** |
| Public transport | 9 | 9 | 15 | 15 | 11 | 11 | 20 | 20 | 16 | 16 | 15 | 15 | 9 | 9 | 5 | 5 | 1 | 1 | **101** | **100** |
| Other | 14 | 16 | 7 | 8 | 11 | 12 | 19 | 21 | 11 | 12 | 10 | 11 | 3 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 13 | 14 | **90** | **100** |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 7 | 11 | 7 | 11 | 13 | 21 | 11 | 18 | 10 | 16 | 5 | 8 | 4 | 6 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 6 | **62** | **100** |
| Interacting with non-government organisation/service | 8 | 13 | 7 | 11 | 11 | 18 | 14 | 23 | 9 | 15 | 9 | 15 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 2 | **62** | **100** |

Respondents N=422. Responses N=2089.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism and location where the racism happened.

**Table 8 Type of racism experienced and witnessed* by location where the racism happened***

| | Cultural rights/ protocols | | Shunning, excluding | | Laws, policies, practices | | Negative attitudes, stereotyping | | Bullying, threats, intimidation | | Verbal abuse/hate speech | | Physical harm | | Property damage, graffiti, vandalism | | Other | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Social media/online | 37 | 14 | 15 | 7 | 28 | 10 | 130 | 25 | 53 | 19 | 93 | 29 | 14 | 14 | 5 | 11 | 18 | 18 | 393 | 19 |
| Workplace | 34 | 13 | 30 | 15 | 37 | 13 | 53 | 10 | 38 | 14 | 26 | 8 | 10 | 10 | 4 | 9 | 12 | 12 | 244 | 12 |
| School/Educational setting | 26 | 10 | 21 | 10 | 21 | 8 | 41 | 8 | 25 | 9 | 33 | 10 | 8 | 8 | 2 | 5 | 11 | 11 | 188 | 9 |
| Public setting | 16 | 6 | 14 | 7 | 18 | 6 | 34 | 7 | 20 | 7 | 28 | 9 | 11 | 11 | 6 | 14 | 7 | 7 | 154 | 7 |
| Commercial setting | 15 | 6 | 21 | 10 | 21 | 8 | 41 | 8 | 16 | 6 | 24 | 8 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 7 | 4 | 4 | 151 | 7 |
| Health setting | 21 | 8 | 17 | 8 | 22 | 8 | 31 | 6 | 16 | 6 | 14 | 4 | 5 | 5 | 2 | 5 | 7 | 7 | 135 | 6 |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting | 21 | 8 | 12 | 6 | 33 | 12 | 26 | 5 | 14 | 5 | 13 | 4 | 7 | 7 | 3 | 7 | 6 | 6 | 135 | 6 |
| Interacting with other government institution/service | 26 | 10 | 17 | 8 | 23 | 8 | 22 | 4 | 16 | 6 | 13 | 4 | 7 | 7 | 3 | 7 | 7 | 7 | 134 | 6 |
| Other media | 15 | 6 | 8 | 4 | 17 | 6 | 39 | 8 | 18 | 7 | 17 | 5 | 4 | 4 | 2 | 5 | 6 | 6 | 126 | 6 |
| Private setting | 15 | 6 | 10 | 5 | 11 | 4 | 29 | 6 | 12 | 4 | 20 | 6 | 9 | 9 | 5 | 11 | 3 | 3 | 114 | 5 |
| Public transport | 9 | 3 | 15 | 7 | 11 | 4 | 20 | 4 | 16 | 6 | 15 | 5 | 9 | 9 | 5 | 11 | 1 | 1 | 101 | 5 |
| Other | 14 | 5 | 7 | 3 | 11 | 4 | 19 | 4 | 11 | 4 | 10 | 3 | 3 | 3 | 2 | 5 | 13 | 13 | 90 | 4 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 7 | 3 | 7 | 3 | 13 | 5 | 11 | 2 | 10 | 4 | 5 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 62 | 3 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation/service | 8 | 3 | 7 | 3 | 11 | 4 | 14 | 3 | 9 | 3 | 9 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 62 | 3 |
| **Total** | **264** | **100** | **201** | **100** | **277** | **100** | **510** | **100** | **274** | **100** | **320** | **100** | **99** | **100** | **44** | **100** | **100** | **100** | **2089** | **100** |

Respondents N=422. Responses N=2089.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism and location where the racism happened.

### Table 9 Single and multiple incidents by who reported the racism

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| A single incident | 56 | 46 | 18 | 56 | 123 | 57 | 197 | 53 |
| Multiple incidents | 65 | 54 | 14 | 44 | 93 | 43 | 172 | 47 |
| **Total** | **121** | **100** | **32** | **100** | **216** | **100** | **369** | **100** |

Respondents N=369.

### Table 10 When the racism happened by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Recently (in the last three months) | 49 | 45 | 17 | 57 | 130 | 63 | 196 | 56 |
| Ongoing | 30 | 27 | 10 | 33 | 38 | 18 | 78 | 22 |
| More than a year ago | 21 | 19 | 2 | 7 | 24 | 12 | 47 | 14 |
| This year | 10 | 9 | 1 | 3 | 16 | 8 | 27 | 8 |
| **Total** | **110** | **100** | **30** | **100** | **208** | **100** | **348** | **100** |

Respondents N=348.

### Table 11 Ongoing racism by location where the racism happened*

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Social media or online | 33 | 23 |
| School/Educational setting | 17 | 12 |
| Workplace | 15 | 11 |
| Public setting | 14 | 10 |
| Interacting with other government institution or service provider | 12 | 8 |
| Private setting | 8 | 6 |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting | 8 | 6 |
| Other | 8 | 6 |
| Health setting | 7 | 5 |
| Commercial setting | 7 | 5 |
| Other media | 6 | 4 |
| Public transport | 5 | 4 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation or service provider | 2 | 1 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 0 | 0 |
| **Total** | **142** | **100** |

Respondents N=78; Responses N=142.

* Data includes multiple responses for location where the racism happened.

### Table 12 Ongoing racism by the type of racism experienced or witnessed*

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 53 | 25 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 34 | 16 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 30 | 14 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols | 30 | 14 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 27 | 13 |
| Shunning you or excluding you | 17 | 8 |
| Other | 11 | 5 |
| Physical harm | 11 | 5 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 3 | 1 |
| **Total** | **216** | **100** |

Respondents N=78; Responses N=216.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism.

### Table 13 Who perpetrated the racism* by who reported the racism

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| A stranger | 57 | 22 | 3 | 7 | 101 | 32 | 161 | 26 |
| Employee/Worker | 81 | 31 | 14 | 32 | 62 | 19 | 157 | 25 |
| Institution or organisation as a whole | 48 | 18 | 9 | 20 | 65 | 20 | 122 | 20 |
| Other | 23 | 9 | 8 | 18 | 38 | 12 | 69 | 11 |
| Someone I know | 40 | 15 | 8 | 18 | 20 | 6 | 68 | 11 |
| Community as a whole | 14 | 5 | 2 | 5 | 32 | 10 | 48 | 8 |
| **Total** | **263** | **100** | **44** | **100** | **318** | **100** | **625** | **100** |

Respondents N=442; Responses N=625.

* Data includes multiple responses for who perpetrated the racism.

### Table 14 Gender of the perpetrator

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Male | 116 | 36 |
| Female | 97 | 31 |
| Not applicable (e.g. an organisation or a group of people) | 83 | 26 |
| Unknown | 21 | 7 |
| Non-binary | 1 | 0 |
| Total | 318 | 100 |

Respondents N=318.

**Table 15 Type of racism experienced or witnessed* by gender of the perpetrator**

| | Male | | Female | | Non-binary | | NA & Unknown | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 92 | 35 | 75 | 34 | 0 | 0 | 66 | 27 | 233 | 32 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 45 | 17 | 41 | 19 | 1 | 100 | 43 | 18 | 130 | 18 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 33 | 13 | 28 | 13 | 0 | 0 | 28 | 11 | 89 | 12 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 25 | 10 | 16 | 7 | 0 | 0 | 38 | 16 | 79 | 11 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols | 25 | 10 | 23 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 29 | 12 | 77 | 11 |
| Shunning you or excluding you | 14 | 5 | 18 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 16 | 7 | 48 | 7 |
| Other | 13 | 5 | 13 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 5 | 37 | 5 |
| Physical harm | 13 | 5 | 4 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 8 | 3 | 25 | 3 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 3 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 2 | 9 | 1 |
| **Total** | **263** | **100** | **219** | **100** | **1** | **100** | **244** | **100** | **727** | **100** |

Respondents N=318; Responses N=727.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism.

**Table 16 Who perpetrated the racism* by gender of the perpetrator**

| | Male | | Female | | Non-binary | | NA & Unknown | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| A stranger | 39 | 27 | 23 | 19 | 1 | 33 | 47 | 30 | 110 | 26 |
| Employee/Worker | 39 | 27 | 47 | 39 | 1 | 33 | 19 | 12 | 106 | 25 |
| Institution or organisation as a whole | 21 | 15 | 14 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 49 | 31 | 84 | 20 |
| Other | 21 | 15 | 25 | 21 | 1 | 33 | 10 | 6 | 57 | 13 |
| Someone I know | 18 | 13 | 11 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 9 | 6 | 38 | 9 |
| Community as a whole | 5 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 25 | 16 | 30 | 7 |
| **Total** | **143** | **100** | **120** | **100** | **3** | **100** | **159** | **100** | **425** | **100** |

Respondents N=318; Responses N=425.

* Data includes multiple responses for who perpetrated the racism.

### Table 17 Age of the perpetrator by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| 0-9 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 4 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1 |
| 10-19 | 8 | 11 | 7 | 30 | 4 | 5 | 19 | 11 |
| 20-29 | 8 | 11 | 3 | 13 | 13 | 16 | 24 | 14 |
| 30-39 | 10 | 14 | 2 | 9 | 23 | 28 | 35 | 20 |
| 40-49 | 17 | 24 | 5 | 22 | 22 | 27 | 44 | 25 |
| 50+ | 28 | 39 | 5 | 22 | 18 | 22 | 51 | 29 |
| **Total** | **71** | **100** | **23** | **100** | **81** | **100** | **175** | **100** |

Respondents N=175

### Table 18 Type of racism* by age of the perpetrator

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 13 | 27 | 20 | 41 | 24 | 31 | 32 | 30 | 41 | 31 | 130 | 31 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 16 | 33 | 10 | 20 | 14 | 18 | 15 | 14 | 18 | 14 | 73 | 18 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 8 | 16 | 6 | 12 | 14 | 18 | 15 | 14 | 14 | 11 | 57 | 14 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols | 2 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 5 | 6 | 17 | 16 | 17 | 13 | 42 | 10 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 1 | 2 | 4 | 8 | 8 | 10 | 14 | 13 | 13 | 10 | 40 | 10 |
| Shunning you or excluding you | 3 | 6 | 6 | 12 | 4 | 5 | 8 | 7 | 12 | 9 | 33 | 8 |
| Other | 2 | 4 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 5 | 5 | 5 | 10 | 8 | 23 | 6 |
| Physical harm | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 5 | 2 | 2 | 7 | 5 | 15 | 4 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 4 | 1 |
| **Total** | **49** | **100** | **49** | **100** | **78** | **100** | **108** | **100** | **133** | **100** | **417** | **100** |

Respondents N=175. Responses N=417.

*Data Includes multiple responses for type of racism

### Table 19 Gender of the victim

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Female | 115 | 36 |
| Not applicable (e.g. a group of people) | 99 | 31 |
| Male | 84 | 26 |
| Unknown | 11 | 3 |
| Non-binary | 9 | 3 |
| Other | 4 | 1 |
| **Total** | **322** | **100** |

Respondents N=322.

### Table 20 Age of the victim by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| 0-9 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 8 | 4 |
| 10-19 | 13 | 14 | 10 | 40 | 22 | 25 | 45 | 22 |
| 20-29 | 8 | 9 | 3 | 12 | 14 | 16 | 25 | 12 |
| 30-39 | 26 | 28 | 4 | 16 | 12 | 14 | 42 | 21 |
| 40-49 | 25 | 27 | 4 | 16 | 11 | 13 | 40 | 20 |
| 50+ | 20 | 22 | 3 | 12 | 21 | 24 | 44 | 22 |
| **Total** | **92** | **100** | **25** | **100** | **87** | **100** | **204** | **100** |

Respondents N=204.

### Table 21 Type of racism experienced or witnessed* by age of the victim

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 36 | 29 | 15 | 33 | 31 | 31 | 29 | 25 | 32 | 30 | 143 | 29 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 25 | 20 | 9 | 20 | 15 | 15 | 17 | 15 | 19 | 18 | 85 | 17 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 23 | 19 | 5 | 11 | 12 | 12 | 13 | 11 | 15 | 14 | 68 | 14 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 8 | 7 | 4 | 9 | 9 | 9 | 15 | 13 | 16 | 15 | 52 | 11 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/ protocols | 6 | 5 | 8 | 17 | 15 | 15 | 13 | 11 | 8 | 7 | 50 | 10 |
| Shunning you or excluding you | 8 | 7 | 2 | 4 | 9 | 9 | 12 | 10 | 8 | 7 | 39 | 8 |

| | | | | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Other | 8 | 7 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 6 | 10 | 9 | 5 | 5 | 30 | 6 |
| Physical harm | 8 | 7 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 5 | 4 | 4 | 4 | 19 | 4 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 6 | 1 |
| **Total** | **123** | **100** | **46** | **100** | **100** | **100** | **115** | **100** | **108** | **100** | **492** | **100** |

Respondents N=204; Responses N=492.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism.

### Table 22 Location where the racism happened* by age of the victim

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** |
| Social media or online | 11 | 15 | 4 | 13 | 13 | 22 | 9 | 14 | 19 | 24 | 56 | 18 |
| School/Educational setting | 22 | 30 | 3 | 10 | 10 | 17 | 5 | 8 | 6 | 8 | 46 | 15 |
| Workplace | 3 | 4 | 4 | 13 | 12 | 20 | 11 | 17 | 11 | 14 | 41 | 13 |
| Other media | 12 | 16 | 3 | 10 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 5 | 6 | 24 | 8 |
| Commercial setting | 5 | 7 | 3 | 10 | 1 | 2 | 8 | 12 | 6 | 8 | 23 | 7 |
| Public setting | 6 | 8 | 1 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 8 | 12 | 4 | 5 | 23 | 7 |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting | 4 | 5 | 2 | 6 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 6 | 5 | 6 | 17 | 6 |
| Public transport | 2 | 3 | 3 | 10 | 5 | 8 | 4 | 6 | 2 | 3 | 16 | 5 |
| Interacting with other government institution or service provider | 2 | 3 | 2 | 6 | 3 | 5 | 4 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 14 | 5 |
| Private setting | 3 | 4 | 1 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 2 | 3 | 3 | 4 | 14 | 5 |
| Other | 1 | 1 | 3 | 10 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 4 | 5 | 12 | 4 |
| Health setting | 1 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 3 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 10 | 3 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation or service provider | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 7 | 2 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 1 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 2 |
| **Total** | **74** | **100** | **31** | **100** | **59** | **100** | **66** | **100** | **78** | **100** | **308** | **100** |

Respondents N=204; Responses N=308.

*Data includes multiple responses for location where the racism happened.

### Table 23 Gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism*

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Female | 56 | 62 |
| Male | 33 | 36 |
| Non-binary | 2 | 2 |
| **Total** | **91** | **100** |

Respondents N=91.

* Gender was not recorded for 64 of those who self-reported racism.

**Table 24 Type of racism* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Negative or ignorant attitudes or stereotyping | 40 | 26 | 22 | 23 | 1 | 20 | 63 | 25 |
| Bullying, threats or intimidation | 23 | 15 | 15 | 16 | 1 | 20 | 39 | 15 |
| Verbal abuse or hate speech | 21 | 13 | 12 | 13 | 1 | 20 | 34 | 13 |
| Laws, policies, practices that lead to unfair treatment and negative outcomes | 17 | 11 | 13 | 14 | 0 | 0 | 30 | 12 |
| Didn't recognise cultural rights/protocols | 21 | 13 | 9 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 30 | 12 |
| Shunning you or excluding you | 14 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 1 | 20 | 25 | 10 |
| Other | 12 | 8 | 8 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 20 | 8 |
| Physical harm | 5 | 3 | 5 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 10 | 4 |
| Property damage, graffiti or vandalism | 3 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 20 | 5 | 2 |
| **Total** | **156** | **100** | **95** | **100** | **5** | **100** | **256** | **100** |

Respondents N=91; Responses N=256.

* Data includes multiple responses for type of racism.

**Table 25 Location where the racism happened* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Workplace | 17 | 16 | 13 | 25 | 0 | 0 | 30 | 19 |
| School/Educational setting | 19 | 18 | 5 | 9 | 1 | 50 | 25 | 16 |
| Public setting | 9 | 8 | 7 | 13 | 1 | 50 | 17 | 11 |
| Social media or online | 8 | 8 | 6 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 14 | 9 |
| Commercial setting | 8 | 8 | 5 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 13 | 8 |
| 'Justice'/Legal setting | 6 | 6 | 6 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 7 |
| Public transport | 8 | 8 | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 10 | 6 |
| Other | 7 | 7 | 1 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 8 | 5 |
| Private setting | 6 | 6 | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 8 | 5 |
| Interacting with other government institution or service provider | 5 | 5 | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 7 | 4 |
| Health setting | 4 | 4 | 2 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 6 | 4 |
| Other media | 5 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 6 | 4 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation or service provider | 4 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 3 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| **Total** | **106** | **100** | **53** | **100** | **2** | **100** | **161** | **100** |

Respondents N=91; Responses N=161.

* Data includes multiple responses for location where the racism happened.

**Table 26 Who was the perpetrator* by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Employee/Worker | 36 | 42 | 14 | 28 | 0 | 0 | 50 | 36 |
| Institution or organisation as a whole | 16 | 19 | 10 | 20 | 1 | 33 | 27 | 20 |
| A stranger | 11 | 13 | 13 | 26 | 1 | 33 | 25 | 18 |
| Someone I know | 12 | 14 | 7 | 14 | 0 | 0 | 19 | 14 |
| Other | 8 | 9 | 6 | 12 | 1 | 33 | 15 | 11 |
| Community as a whole | 2 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 1 |
| **Total** | **85** | **100** | **50** | **100** | **3** | **100** | **138** | **100** |

Respondents N=91 Responses N=138.

* Data includes multiple responses for perpetrator of the racism.

**Table 27 Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Angry | 48 | 18 | 15 | 20 | 117 | 24 | 180 | 22 |
| Disappointed | 33 | 13 | 10 | 13 | 75 | 15 | 118 | 14 |
| Frustrated | 26 | 10 | 12 | 16 | 73 | 15 | 111 | 13 |
| Motivated to bring about change | 15 | 6 | 6 | 8 | 71 | 14 | 92 | 11 |
| Solidarity with those who experience racism | 8 | 3 | 5 | 7 | 59 | 12 | 72 | 9 |
| Sad | 18 | 7 | 6 | 8 | 23 | 5 | 47 | 6 |
| Humiliated | 29 | 11 | 6 | 8 | 4 | 1 | 39 | 5 |
| Shocked | 9 | 3 | 5 | 7 | 25 | 5 | 39 | 5 |
| Isolated | 21 | 8 | 2 | 3 | 3 | 1 | 26 | 3 |
| Helpless or paralysed | 15 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 1 | 25 | 3 |
| Afraid | 13 | 5 | 1 | 1 | 11 | 2 | 25 | 3 |
| Resigned to racism being a part of life | 13 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 8 | 2 | 24 | 3 |
| Shame | 5 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 14 | 3 | 20 | 2 |
| Other | 7 | 3 | 1 | 1 | 6 | 1 | 14 | 2 |
| **Total** | **260** | **100** | **76** | **100** | **496** | **100** | **832** | **100** |

Respondents N=314; Responses N=832.

*Data includes multiple responses for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

**Table 28 Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by age of the victim**

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Angry | 27 | 20 | 14 | 24 | 21 | 19 | 24 | 21 | 25 | 22 | 111 | 21 |
| Disappointed | 21 | 16 | 13 | 22 | 13 | 12 | 14 | 13 | 11 | 10 | 72 | 14 |
| Frustrated | 20 | 15 | 9 | 15 | 13 | 12 | 10 | 9 | 7 | 6 | 59 | 11 |
| Motivated to bring about change | 10 | 7 | 5 | 8 | 4 | 4 | 13 | 12 | 17 | 15 | 49 | 9 |
| Humiliated | 7 | 5 | 2 | 3 | 9 | 8 | 11 | 10 | 8 | 7 | 37 | 7 |
| Solidarity with those who experience racism | 7 | 5 | 3 | 5 | 6 | 6 | 9 | 8 | 10 | 9 | 35 | 7 |
| Sad | 17 | 13 | 4 | 7 | 7 | 6 | 4 | 4 | 3 | 3 | 35 | 7 |
| Isolated | 5 | 4 | 3 | 5 | 5 | 5 | 5 | 4 | 6 | 5 | 24 | 5 |
| Shocked | 7 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 6 | 3 | 3 | 7 | 6 | 24 | 5 |
| Helpless or paralysed | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 7 | 6 | 6 | 5 | 6 | 5 | 21 | 4 |
| Resigned to racism being a part of life | 5 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 7 | 6 | 3 | 3 | 5 | 4 | 21 | 4 |
| Afraid | 3 | 2 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 4 | 4 | 4 | 6 | 5 | 19 | 4 |
| Shame | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 10 | 2 |
| Other | 3 | 2 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 9 | 2 |
| **Total** | **134** | **100** | **59** | **100** | **108** | **100** | **112** | **100** | **113** | **100** | **526** | **100** |

Respondents N=197; Responses N=526.

*Data includes multiple responses for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

**Table 29 Emotional responses to incidents of racism*^ by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Angry | 27 | 18 | 16 | 21 | 1 | 25 | 44 | 19 |
| Disappointed | 20 | 13 | 8 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 28 | 12 |
| Humiliated | 18 | 12 | 8 | 10 | 1 | 25 | 27 | 12 |
| Frustrated | 13 | 9 | 8 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 21 | 9 |
| Isolated | 14 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 1 | 25 | 20 | 9 |
| Sad | 11 | 7 | 6 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 17 | 7 |
| Helpless or paralysed | 9 | 6 | 6 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 15 | 6 |
| Motivated to bring about change | 10 | 7 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 13 | 6 |
| Afraid | 7 | 5 | 5 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 12 | 5 |
| Resigned to racism being a part of life | 9 | 6 | 2 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 5 |
| Shocked | 7 | 5 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 25 | 9 | 4 |

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Solidarity with those who experience racism | 1 | 1 | 5 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 6 | 3 |
| Other | 1 | 1 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 2 |
| Shame | 2 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 2 |
| **Total** | **149** | **100** | **78** | **100** | **4** | **100** | **231** | **100** |

Respondents N=85; Responses N=231.

*Data includes multiple responses for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

### Table 30 Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Talked to family or friends | 45 | 24 | 13 | 25 | 50 | 19 | 108 | 21 |
| Other type of complaint or report (e.g. reported directly to the organisation/service, internal HR) | 24 | 13 | 9 | 18 | 42 | 16 | 75 | 15 |
| Defended the person/myself (e.g. verbally, online) | 21 | 11 | 6 | 12 | 40 | 15 | 67 | 13 |
| Other | 19 | 10 | 7 | 14 | 39 | 14 | 65 | 13 |
| Disengaged (e.g. walked away, took a break from social media) | 19 | 10 | 3 | 6 | 33 | 12 | 55 | 11 |
| Other action (e.g. reported to media, wrote a letter) | 8 | 4 | 3 | 6 | 30 | 11 | 41 | 8 |
| Avoided the place/person (e.g. didn't go back to shop/service, left my job/studies) | 20 | 10 | 5 | 10 | 12 | 4 | 37 | 7 |
| Didn't do or say anything | 13 | 7 | 3 | 6 | 11 | 4 | 27 | 5 |
| Made a complaint to an independent complaints body (e.g. Fair Work, Australian Human Rights Commission, Ombudsman) | 10 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 9 | 3 | 20 | 4 |
| Retaliated (e.g. swore or lashed out at perpetrator) | 6 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 10 | 2 |
| Reported to the police | 6 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 7 | 1 |
| **Total** | **191** | **100** | **51** | **100** | **270** | **100** | **512** | **100** |

Respondents N=287; Responses N=512.

*Data includes multiple responses for responses to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for responses to incidents of racism.

**Table 31 Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by age of the victim**

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Talked to family or friends | 23 | 26 | 6 | 20 | 20 | 27 | 17 | 22 | 18 | 25 | 84 | 25 |
| Other type of complaint or report (e.g. reported directly to the organisation/service, internal HR) | 18 | 20 | 2 | 7 | 10 | 14 | 8 | 10 | 10 | 14 | 48 | 14 |
| Defended the person/myself (e.g. verbally, online) | 10 | 11 | 6 | 20 | 9 | 12 | 9 | 12 | 10 | 14 | 44 | 13 |
| Disengaged e.g. walked away, took a break from social media) | 8 | 9 | 2 | 7 | 8 | 11 | 8 | 10 | 9 | 12 | 35 | 10 |
| Other | 8 | 9 | 2 | 7 | 6 | 8 | 10 | 13 | 9 | 12 | 35 | 10 |
| Avoided the place/person (e.g. didn't go back to shop/service, left my job/studies) | 6 | 7 | 1 | 3 | 6 | 8 | 11 | 14 | 5 | 7 | 29 | 8 |
| Didn't do or say anything | 6 | 7 | 7 | 23 | 7 | 9 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 22 | 6 |
| Other action (e.g. reported to media, wrote a letter) | 5 | 6 | 1 | 3 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 9 | 3 | 4 | 19 | 6 |
| Made a complaint to an independent complaints body (e.g. Fair Work, Australian Human Rights Commission, Ombudsman) | 1 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 | 5 | 12 | 4 |
| Retaliated (e.g. swore or lashed out at perpetrator) | 2 | 2 | 2 | 7 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1 | 8 | 2 |
| Reported to the police | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 3 | | 0 | 3 | 4 | 6 | 2 |
| **Total** | **88** | **100** | **30** | **100** | **74** | **100** | **77** | **100** | **73** | **100** | **342** | **100** |

Respondents N=179; Responses N=342.

*Data includes multiple responses for response to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for responses to incidents of racism.

**Table 32 Responses to incidents of racism*^ by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Talked to family or friends | 27 | 26 | 15 | 24 | 0 | 0 | 42 | 25 |
| Other type of complaint or report | 14 | 13 | 5 | 8 | 1 | 33 | 20 | 12 |
| Avoided the place/person | 13 | 13 | 7 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 20 | 12 |
| Defended the person/myself | 11 | 11 | 7 | 11 | 0 | 0 | 18 | 11 |
| Disengaged | 9 | 9 | 9 | 14 | 0 | 0 | 18 | 11 |

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Other | 14 | 13 | 2 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 16 | 9 |
| Didn't do or say anything | 5 | 5 | 4 | 6 | 1 | 33 | 10 | 6 |
| Made a complaint to an independent complaints body | 3 | 3 | 6 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 9 | 5 |
| Retaliated | 3 | 3 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 33 | 6 | 4 |
| Reported to the police | 3 | 3 | 3 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 6 | 4 |
| Other action | 2 | 2 | 3 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 3 |
| **Total** | **104** | **100** | **63** | **100** | **3** | **100** | **170** | **100** |

Respondents N=80; Responses N=170.

*Data includes multiple responses for response to the incident.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for responses to incidents of racism.

### Table 33 Barriers to calling out racism*^ by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** |
| Don't trust the system | 36 | 16 | 13 | 19 | 47 | 14 | 96 | 15 |
| Reported before and nothing happened | 24 | 11 | 8 | 12 | 40 | 12 | 72 | 12 |
| Not sure what to do or say | 21 | 9 | 3 | 4 | 44 | 14 | 68 | 11 |
| Not worth it - nothing ever changes | 23 | 10 | 8 | 12 | 31 | 10 | 62 | 10 |
| Lack of proof/evidence | 19 | 8 | 6 | 9 | 31 | 10 | 56 | 9 |
| Fear of backlash | 18 | 8 | 5 | 7 | 31 | 10 | 54 | 9 |
| Might not be serious enough to report | 15 | 7 | 4 | 6 | 23 | 7 | 42 | 7 |
| Social/Emotional wellbeing or health reasons | 16 | 7 | 7 | 10 | 18 | 6 | 41 | 7 |
| Costs of making a complaint (e.g. legal costs, time) | 20 | 9 | 4 | 6 | 12 | 4 | 36 | 6 |
| Fear of job loss or career impacts | 17 | 7 | 5 | 7 | 12 | 4 | 34 | 5 |
| Fear of other negative consequence (e.g. on relationships, loss of opportunities) | 12 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 18 | 6 | 33 | 5 |
| Other | 7 | 3 | 2 | 3 | 18 | 6 | 27 | 4 |
| **Total** | **228** | **100** | **68** | **100** | **325** | **100** | **621** | **100** |

Respondents N=261; Responses N=621.

*Data includes multiple responses for barriers to calling out racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for barriers to calling out racism.

**Table 34 Barriers to calling out racism experienced or witnessed *^by age of the victim**

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Don't trust the system | 20 | 19 | 6 | 14 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 15 | 15 | 16 | 65 | 16 |
| Not sure what to do or say | 14 | 13 | 10 | 23 | 6 | 7 | 9 | 10 | 4 | 4 | 43 | 10 |
| Not worth it - nothing ever changes | 12 | 12 | 3 | 7 | 9 | 10 | 8 | 9 | 11 | 12 | 43 | 10 |
| Reported before and nothing happened | 8 | 8 | 3 | 7 | 11 | 12 | 11 | 13 | 9 | 10 | 42 | 10 |
| Fear of backlash | 9 | 9 | 2 | 5 | 9 | 10 | 8 | 9 | 11 | 12 | 39 | 9 |
| Lack of proof/evidence | 15 | 14 | 6 | 14 | 7 | 8 | 5 | 6 | 3 | 3 | 36 | 9 |
| Costs of making a complaint | 6 | 6 | 2 | 5 | 4 | 4 | 10 | 11 | 9 | 10 | 31 | 7 |
| Social/Emotional wellbeing or health reasons | 5 | 5 | 3 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 28 | 7 |
| Might not be serious enough to report | 7 | 7 | 4 | 9 | 7 | 8 | 4 | 5 | 5 | 5 | 27 | 6 |
| Fear of job loss or career impacts | 2 | 2 | 3 | 7 | 10 | 11 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 27 | 6 |
| Fear of other negative consequence | 3 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 7 | 8 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 5 | 24 | 6 |
| Other | 3 | 3 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 7 | 8 | 13 | 3 |
| **Total** | **104** | **100** | **43** | **100** | **91** | **100** | **87** | **100** | **93** | **100** | **418** | **100** |

Respondents N=169; Responses N=418.

*Data includes multiple responses for barriers to calling out racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for barriers to calling out racism.

**Table 35 Barriers to calling out racism*^ by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Don't trust the system | 21 | 17 | 6 | 9 | 2 | 33 | 29 | 15 |
| Reported before and nothing happened | 13 | 10 | 8 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 21 | 11 |
| Not sure what to do or say | 12 | 10 | 9 | 13 | 0 | 0 | 21 | 11 |
| Not worth it - nothing ever changes | 11 | 9 | 7 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 18 | 9 |
| Lack of proof/evidence | 8 | 6 | 9 | 13 | 1 | 17 | 18 | 9 |
| Costs of making a complaint | 8 | 6 | 9 | 13 | 1 | 17 | 18 | 9 |
| Fear of backlash | 9 | 7 | 6 | 9 | 1 | 17 | 16 | 8 |
| Fear of job loss or career impacts | 12 | 10 | 4 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 16 | 8 |
| Social/Emotional wellbeing or health reasons | 11 | 9 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 17 | 14 | 7 |
| Might not be serious enough to report | 9 | 7 | 4 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 13 | 7 |

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fear of other negative consequence | 8 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 6 |
| Other | 4 | 3 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 3 |
| **Total** | **126** | **100** | **68** | **100** | **6** | **100** | **200** | **100** |

Respondents N=76; Responses N=200.

*Data includes multiple responses for barriers to calling out racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for barriers to calling out racism.

### Table 36 What needs to be done to combat racism*^ by who reported the incident

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/ peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** | **N** | **%** |
| First Nations Sovereignty | 34 | 14 | 6 | 8 | 70 | 15 | 110 | 14 |
| Increase everyone's understanding about First Nations culture and history | 33 | 14 | 8 | 11 | 66 | 14 | 107 | 14 |
| Stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism | 33 | 14 | 10 | 14 | 49 | 11 | 92 | 12 |
| Giving more First Nations peoples a voice on this issue | 28 | 12 | 4 | 5 | 49 | 11 | 81 | 10 |
| Educate the community on how to stand up against racism | 23 | 10 | 12 | 16 | 41 | 9 | 76 | 10 |
| More First Nations community-led responses and advocacy | 23 | 10 | 5 | 7 | 44 | 9 | 72 | 9 |
| Increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people | 12 | 5 | 9 | 12 | 33 | 7 | 54 | 7 |
| Increased education and public awareness campaigns to prevent and combat racism | 7 | 3 | 6 | 8 | 40 | 9 | 53 | 7 |
| Educate the public about the legal and ethical responsibilities of being anti-racist | 11 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 27 | 6 | 41 | 5 |
| More accessible and safer complaints processes for reporting racism | 13 | 5 | 4 | 5 | 24 | 5 | 41 | 5 |
| Other | 13 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 15 | 3 | 31 | 4 |
| Increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism | 12 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 6 | 1 | 21 | 3 |
| **Total** | **242** | **100** | **73** | **100** | **464** | **100** | **779** | **100** |

Respondents N=280; Responses N=779.

*Data includes multiple responses for combatting racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for combatting racism.

**Table 37 What needs to be done to combat racism*^ by gender of those who self-reported experiencing racism**

| | Female | | Male | | Non-binary | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| First Nations Sovereignty | 18 | 13 | 10 | 14 | 1 | 17 | 29 | 13 |
| Increase everyone's understanding about First Nations culture and history | 22 | 16 | 7 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 29 | 13 |
| Stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism | 16 | 12 | 12 | 16 | 1 | 17 | 29 | 13 |
| Giving more First Nations peoples a voice on this issue | 15 | 11 | 12 | 16 | 0 | 0 | 27 | 12 |
| Educate the community on how to stand up against racism | 13 | 9 | 7 | 10 | 1 | 17 | 21 | 10 |
| More First Nations community-led responses and advocacy | 10 | 7 | 10 | 14 | 0 | 0 | 20 | 9 |
| Increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people | 8 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 1 | 17 | 12 | 6 |
| Increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism | 6 | 4 | 4 | 5 | 2 | 33 | 12 | 6 |
| Educate the public about the legal and ethical responsibilities of being anti-racist | 11 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 5 |
| More accessible and safer complaints processes for reporting racism | 8 | 6 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 11 | 5 |
| Other | 5 | 4 | 4 | 5 | 0 | 0 | 9 | 4 |
| Increased education and public awareness campaigns to prevent and combat racism | 6 | 4 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 7 | 3 |
| **Total** | **138** | **100** | **73** | **100** | **6** | **100** | **217** | **100** |

Respondents N=76; Responses N=217.
*Data includes multiple responses for combatting racism.
^Limit of up to 3 responses only for combatting racism.

**Table 38 What needs to be done to combat racism*^ by age of the victim**

| | 0-19 | | 20-29 | | 30-39 | | 40-49 | | 50+ | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| First Nations Sovereignty (e.g. self-determination, land back, reparations) | 19 | 14 | 9 | 16 | 15 | 17 | 12 | 12 | 18 | 17 | 73 | 15 |
| Increase everyone's understanding about First Nations culture and history | 17 | 13 | 7 | 13 | 13 | 14 | 11 | 11 | 13 | 13 | 61 | 13 |
| Giving more First Nations peoples a voice on this issue | 18 | 13 | 7 | 13 | 11 | 12 | 9 | 9 | 13 | 13 | 58 | 12 |
| Educate the community on how to stand up against racism | 14 | 10 | 6 | 11 | 11 | 12 | 12 | 12 | 9 | 9 | 52 | 11 |

| | | | | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stronger legal protections against and penalties for racism | 13 | 10 | 4 | 7 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 13 | 9 | 9 | 50 | 10 |
| More First Nations community-led responses and advocacy | 15 | 11 | 6 | 11 | 8 | 9 | 11 | 11 | 6 | 6 | 46 | 10 |
| Increased education and public awareness campaigns to prevent and combat racism | 6 | 4 | 9 | 16 | 2 | 2 | 8 | 8 | 6 | 6 | 31 | 6 |
| Increase public awareness about racism and its impacts on First Nations people | 12 | 9 | 2 | 4 | 4 | 4 | 7 | 7 | 4 | 4 | 29 | 6 |
| Other | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 3 | 6 | 6 | 10 | 10 | 24 | 5 |
| More accessible and safer complaints processes for reporting racism | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 5 | 6 | 3 | 3 | 9 | 9 | 22 | 5 |
| Educate the public about the legal and ethical responsibilities of being anti-racist | 7 | 5 | 3 | 5 | 3 | 3 | 6 | 6 | 0 | 0 | 19 | 4 |
| Increase First Nations awareness about how to use the law to challenge racism | 5 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 4 | 2 | 2 | 6 | 6 | 17 | 4 |
| **Total** | **134** | **100** | **55** | **100** | **90** | **100** | **100** | **100** | **103** | **100** | **482** | **100** |

Respondents N=175; Responses N=482.

*Data includes multiple responses for combatting racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for combatting racism.

## 6.2 Appendix B: Children and Young People Data Tables 2024-25

### Table A How the incident was experienced or witnessed by who reported the racism for incidents targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Interpersonal racism | 6 | 46 | 8 | 73 | 12 | 41 | 26 | 49 |
| Both (interpersonal and systemic) | 4 | 31 | 2 | 18 | 9 | 31 | 15 | 28 |
| Systemic/Institutional racism | 3 | 23 | 1 | 9 | 3 | 10 | 7 | 13 |
| Other | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 17 | 5 | 9 |
| **Total** | **13** | **100** | **11** | **100** | **29** | **100** | **53** | **100** |

Respondents N=53.

### Table B Location where the racism happened* by who reported the racism for incidents targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| School/Educational setting (e.g. pre-school, TAFE, university) | 9 | 39 | 7 | 54 | 6 | 16 | 22 | 30 |
| Other media (e.g. TV, radio, news, website) | 1 | 4 | 1 | 8 | 10 | 26 | 12 | 16 |
| Social media or online (e.g. FaceBook, TikTok, blog) | 2 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 9 | 24 | 11 | 15 |
| Public setting (e.g. street, park, sports event, rally) | 2 | 9 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 8 | 6 | 8 |
| Commercial setting (e.g. bank, shop, club, hotel, mall) | 1 | 4 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 8 | 5 | 7 |
| Justice'/Legal setting (e.g. policing, court or prison) | 1 | 4 | 1 | 8 | 2 | 5 | 4 | 5 |
| Workplace | 2 | 9 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 3 | 4 |
| Private setting (e.g. your home, family or friend's home) | 1 | 4 | 1 | 8 | 1 | 3 | 3 | 4 |
| Interacting with other government institution or | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 3 |

| | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| service provider (e.g. Centrelink, NDIS) | | | | | | | | |
| Public transport (e.g. bus, taxi, Uber) | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 3 |
| Health setting (e.g. hospital or medical centre) | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 |
| Other | 0 | 0 | 1 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 |
| Interacting with non-government organisation or service provider (e.g. charity, support services, church) | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 |
| Interacting with the child 'protection' system | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 3 | 1 | 1 |
| **Total** | **23** | **100** | **13** | **100** | **38** | **100** | **74** | **100** |

Respondents N= 53; Responses N=74.

* Data includes multiple responses for location where the racism happened.

### Table C Gender of the victim for incidents of racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Man | 22 | 42 |
| Woman | 16 | 30 |
| Gender not applicable (e.g. group of people) | 9 | 17 |
| Non-binary | 4 | 8 |
| Gender unknown | 1 | 2 |
| Other | 1 | 2 |
| **Total** | **53** | **100** |

Respondents N=53.

### Table D Gender of the perpetrator for incidents of racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| Male | 25 | 47 |
| Gender not applicable (e.g. an organisation or a group of people) | 15 | 28 |
| Female | 11 | 21 |
| Gender unknown | 2 | 4 |
| **Total** | **53** | **100** |

Respondents N=53.

**Table E Age of the perpetrator for incidents of racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)**

| | N | % |
|---|---|---|
| 10-19 | 17 | 44 |
| 20-29 | 2 | 5 |
| 30-39 | 4 | 10 |
| 40-49 | 10 | 26 |
| 50+ | 6 | 15 |
| **Total** | **39** | **100** |

Respondents N=39.

**Table F Emotional responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the racism for incidents targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Angry | 3 | 10 | 7 | 26 | 17 | 22 | 27 | 20 |
| Disappointed | 3 | 10 | 4 | 15 | 14 | 18 | 21 | 16 |
| Frustrated | 5 | 17 | 5 | 19 | 10 | 13 | 20 | 15 |
| Sad | 4 | 13 | 3 | 11 | 10 | 13 | 17 | 13 |
| Motivated to bring about change | 1 | 3 | 2 | 7 | 7 | 9 | 10 | 7 |
| Solidarity with those who experience racism | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 7 | 9 | 7 | 5 |
| Shocked | 1 | 3 | 1 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 5 |
| Humiliated | 5 | 17 | 2 | 7 | 0 | 0 | 7 | 5 |
| Resigned to racism being a part of life | 1 | 3 | 1 | 4 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 4 |
| Isolated | 3 | 10 | 1 | 4 | 1 | 1 | 5 | 4 |
| Afraid | 2 | 7 | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 2 |
| Other | 2 | 7 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 3 | 2 |
| Shame | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| Helpless or paralysed | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| **Total** | **30** | **100** | **27** | **100** | **77** | **100** | **134** | **100** |

Respondents N=50; Responses N=134.

* Data includes multiple responses for emotional response to the racism

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for emotional responses to incidents of racism.

**Table G Responses to incidents of racism experienced or witnessed*^ by who reported the incident for racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Talked to family or friends | 5 | 19 | 7 | 33 | 11 | 27 | 23 | 26 |
| Other type of complaint or report (e.g. reported directly to the organisation/service, internal HR) | 2 | 8 | 7 | 33 | 9 | 22 | 18 | 20 |
| Defended the person/myself (e.g. verbally, online) | 3 | 12 | 1 | 5 | 6 | 15 | 10 | 11 |
| Other | 3 | 12 | 0 | 0 | 5 | 12 | 8 | 9 |
| Disengaged (e.g. walked away, took a break from social media) | 2 | 8 | 1 | 5 | 5 | 12 | 8 | 9 |
| Avoided the place/person (e.g. didn't go back to shop/service, left my job/studies) | 3 | 12 | 2 | 10 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 7 |
| Didn't do or say anything | 4 | 15 | 1 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 7 |
| Other action (e.g. reported to media, wrote a letter) | 1 | 4 | 2 | 10 | 2 | 5 | 5 | 6 |
| Retaliated (e.g. swore or lashed out at perpetrator) | 2 | 8 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 2 |
| Reported to the police | 1 | 4 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 |
| Made a complaint to an independent complaints body (e.g. Fair Work, Australian Human Rights Commission, Ombudsman) | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 |
| **Total** | **26** | **100** | **21** | **100** | **41** | **100** | **88** | **100** |

Respondents N=43; Responses N=88.

*Data includes multiple responses for responses to incidents of racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for responses to incidents of racism.

**Table H Barriers to reporting racism*^ by who reported the incident for racism targeting children and young people (0-19 age group)**

| | First Nations person who experienced racism | | Friend/Relative of First Nations person/peoples who experienced racism | | Witness of racism towards First Nations person/peoples | | Total | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | N | % | N | % | N | % | N | % |
| Don't trust the system | 4 | 13 | 7 | 29 | 9 | 18 | 20 | 19 |
| Lack of proof/evidence | 5 | 17 | 3 | 13 | 7 | 14 | 15 | 14 |
| Not sure what to do or say | 5 | 17 | 1 | 4 | 8 | 16 | 14 | 13 |
| Not worth it - nothing ever changes | 5 | 17 | 4 | 17 | 3 | 6 | 12 | 12 |
| Fear of backlash | 3 | 10 | 0 | 0 | 6 | 12 | 9 | 9 |
| Reported before and nothing happened | 2 | 7 | 2 | 8 | 4 | 8 | 8 | 8 |
| Might not be serious enough to report | 3 | 10 | 1 | 4 | 3 | 6 | 7 | 7 |
| Costs of making a complaint (e.g. legal costs, time) | 3 | 10 | 2 | 8 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 6 |
| Social/Emotional wellbeing or health reasons | 0 | 0 | 2 | 8 | 3 | 6 | 5 | 5 |
| Other | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 6 | 3 | 3 |
| Fear of other negative consequence (e.g. on relationships, loss of opportunities) | 0 | 0 | 1 | 4 | 2 | 4 | 3 | 3 |
| Fear of job loss or career impacts | 0 | 0 | 1 | 4 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 2 |
| **Total** | **30** | **100** | **24** | **100** | **50** | **100** | **104** | **100** |

Respondents N=42; Responses N=104.

*Data includes multiple responses for barriers to reporting racism.

^Limit of up to 3 responses only for barriers to reporting racism.